# AMONGST AUSTRALIAN ABORIGINES

By

E. J. TELFER

Charlie & Amy,

with love & Christmas wishes.

—

From

Em.

MJ & SE TELFER
UNGARRA 5610

The Rev. E. J. Telfer.

# AMONGST AUSTRALIAN ABORIGINES

Forty Years of Missionary Work.

---

The Story of

## The United Aborigines' Mission

By E. J. TELFER.

*"These forty years*
*the Lord thy God hath been with thee."*
*(Deuteronomy 2: 7).*

---

Registered at the G.P.O., Sydney, for transmission through the post as a book.

Wholly set up and printed in Australia by Fraser & Morphet Pty. Ltd., Registered Office 3 and 5 Eastbourne Street, Windsor, Melbourne, Victoria, for the Rev. E. J. Telfer, 140 Elizabeth Street, Sydney, New South Wales.

## CONTENTS.


| | | | Page |
|---|---|---|---|
| Title Page | | | 1 |
| List of Illustrations | | | 4 |
| Foreword | | | 5 |
| Author's Note | | | 7 |
| Preface | | | 8 and 9 |
| Chapter | I. | Formative Influences | 11 |
| Chapter | II. | Small Beginnings | 23 |
| Chapter | III. | Growth and Extension | 33 |
| Chapter | IV. | The Birth of a Magazine | 42 |
| Chapter | V. | North Coast Natives | 49 |
| Chapter | VI. | Challenging the Almighty | 63 |
| Chapter | VII. | Pioneering Work | 68 |
| Chapter | VIII. | Stations and Workers | 88 |
| Chapter | IX. | The Call of the West | 104 |
| Chapter | X. | Bomaderry and the Bairns | 131 |
| Chapter | XI. | The Far-flung Fields | 145 |
| Chapter | XII. | Gleanings of the Great Harvest | 154 |
| Chapter | XIII. | South Australian Beginnings | 167 |
| Chapter | XIV. | Proposed Work in Victoria | 176 |
| Chapter | XV. | "Mount Margaret" | 184 |
| Chapter | XVI. | "Arise and Build" | 191 |
| Chapter | XVII. | Stirring Stories | 212 |

## LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS.


| | Page |
|---|---|
| Rev. E. J. Telfer .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. Facing Title | Page |
| Old Woollahra Baptist Church .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 17 |
| La Perouse, showing Mission House .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 18 |
| First Mission Church at La Perouse .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 19 |
| La Perouse Mission House and Church before Demolition | 20 |
| Mrs. Timbery (Queen Emma) .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 37 |
| Mr. H. E. Hockey .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 38 |
| Mr. L. W. Long .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 39 |
| Miss Retta Dixon (Mrs. L. W. Long) .. .. .. .. .. .. | 40 |
| Miss Baker .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 57 |
| La Perouse Mission House .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 57 |
| Front Page of "New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate" | 58 |
| Mr. and Mrs. T. E. Colebrook .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 59 |
| Mr. G. E. Ardill .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 60 |
| Aboriginal Athletes .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 77 |
| Missionaries and Workers at Northern Rivers Conference | 77 |
| Wauchope Junior C.E. Society .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 78 |
| Burnt Bridge Church and Mission House .. .. .. .. .. | 79 |
| Purfleet Mission Hall and School .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 80 |
| Mr. Henry Bush .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 97 |
| Group of Missionaries .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 98 |
| Group of Missionaries and Workers .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 99 |
| Aborigines at Ulmara, Clarence River .. .. .. .. .. .. | 100 |
| Missionaries and Officials .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 117-118 |
| Rev. E. J. Telfer and Peter Wandy .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 119 |
| Camel Expedition .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 120 |
| First Building, Colebrook Home .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 120 |
| First W.A. Council .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 137 |
| Mrs. E. J. Telfer .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 138 |
| Bunny, Una and Lily .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 139 |
| Dulhi—Gunyah Orphanage .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 140 |
| Missionaries on the March .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 157 |
| Native Prisoners .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 158 |
| Bomaderry and the Bairns .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 159 |
| "Ken" .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 160 |
| Mr. and Mrs. Playford .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 177 |
| Mr. and Mrs. Jago .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 178 |
| Us Margaret Blackfella .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 179 |
| Mr. Schenk's Arrival at the Well .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 180 |
| The Motor Truck at Mt. Margaret .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 180 |
| Little Girls saved from becoming Child Wives .. .. .. .. | 197 |
| Prospective Husbands .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 197 |
| Mr. and Mrs. Wade .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 198 |
| Miss V. E. Turner, Rev. E. J. Telfer, Mr. T. Graham, Mr. G. L. Aitken, Mr. H. Rotherham, Mr. J. Jago .. .. | 199 |
| Mr. W. L. Wright .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 200 |
| Mr. and Mrs. Street .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 217 |
| Mr. and Mrs. Collier .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 218 |
| Mr. and Mrs. L. J. White .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 219 |
| A Native Family .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. .. | 220 |


## FOREWORD.

In response to repeated requests from the Federal Council of the United Aborigines' Mission, and from the Publishing Committee, I have, after considerable hesitation and much prayer, consented to write a brief history of the Mission from its inception to the present time. The story will cover a period of more than forty years, and will unfold some of the wonders of God's Abounding Grace amongst the despised and downtrodden aborigines of Australia.

From very small beginnings in a camp on the northern shore of Botany Bay, the work has developed and expanded so that the Mission has, at the time of writing, about 80 missionaries, besides native helpers and voluntary workers. These devoted men and women are scattered throughout the wide spaces of several States of the Commonwealth, from La Perouse in the South-east to the Kimberleys in the far North-west of the Continent; and through hazard and hardship they are preaching the unsearchable riches of Christ to the native people.

To all who are helping to make this record of the work possible, by supplying material, or defraying the cost of photographic blocks for illustrating the story, we tender our sincere thanks. Most of all we are grateful for those who are helping by continual prayer on our behalf; and it is only because we believe that we can depend on this prayer co-operation that we dare attempt the task.

## AUTHOR'S NOTE.

It seems necessary to explain that several years have passed since we first undertook to write this story. The chapters have, for the most part, appeared in the columns of "The United Aborigines Messenger," from time to time. The facts contained in this brief history have been carefully gleaned from the official records of the Mission. We realise that we have not in any sense done full justice to the great work that has been accomplished amongst the aborigines; neither have we been able even to mention some of the missionaries and other workers of recent years who have given of their best to the great cause. History is still being made, and at a later date it may be possible to gather up the threads of what has been accomplished in these later years. With all its imperfections we send it forth in the earnest hope that it will stir many of the Lord's people to a sense of their responsibility with regard to the aborigines.

We desire to acknowledge our indebtedness to many who have helped in gathering material for our story, and particularly to Mr. Henry Bush, who has kindly undertaken the final arrangements for publication. Without this timely help in the outline of contents, and the reading of proofs, there would have been further delay. May the record of what has been done in past years inspire every reader to do still more to bring the aborigines of Australia under the influence of the Gospel of Christ.

E. J. TELFER.

3rd February, 1939.

## PREFACE.

I have been asked to say a word respecting the publication of this record of forty years' work among the Aborigines of Australia. The Rev. E. J. Telfer has seen all sides of the work, which has been carried on throughout the Commonwealth. He has been in perils oft and trials many. As missioner, councillor and President, it says much for his physical constitution and his faith in God that he is able to publish this record of heroic service.

The book deserves a wide circulation among those who have at heart the cause of this much-neglected, and oftentimes ill-treated, people, to whom the white people, beyond introducing the vices, and communicating the diseases of civilisation, have done little to alter their condition. It should, however, be stated that the Government of Australia is now proposing to take a course of action in relation to the native Australian people, having for its object "the raising of their status so as to entitle them by right and by qualification to the ordinary rights of citizenship, and enable them and help them to share the opportunities available in their own native land."

It is the opinion of Professor Sir Arthur Keith, that "of all the races of mankind now alive, the aboriginal race of Australia is the only one which could serve as a common ancestor for all modern races. The common ancestor has to yield descendants which, on the one hand, might become the typical inhabitant of Central Africa, and, on the other, the fair-haired native of north-western Europe. The Australian native has those intermediate and generalised characters needed for such an ancestral form."

Dr. Chas. Pickering, who visited Australia as a member of the United States Exploring Expedition, commanded by Wilkes, says, "Strange as it may appear, I would refer to an Australian as the finest model of the human proportions I have ever met with; in muscular development combining perfect symmetry, activity and strength; while his head might have compared with the antique bust of a philosopher."

I trust the publication will have much success.

HENRY BUSH,
Vice-President, World's C.E. Union.

Sydney, N.S.W., 1st May, 1939.

## CHAPTER I.

## FORMATIVE INFLUENCES.

During the first century of Australian history many spasmodic attempts were made to establish missions amongst the aborigines, but little permanent good seems to have resulted. In more recent years determined and praiseworthy efforts have been made by several sections of the Christian Church, and, in some instances, valuable work has been accomplished, and still continues. All honor is due to the faithful men and women who have hazarded their lives for the sake of Christ and the aborigines. We cannot here tell their story or describe their work, but we must point out that while these Denominational Missions are doing good in their respective localities, they can touch only the limited number of natives who come within a circumscribed area; and many thousands of the people remain untouched by any Christian influence.

There was urgent need, therefore, for some comprehensive missionary undertaking in which all evangelical Christians could unite. While this need was felt by many, the task seemed too formidable; and then, quietly, God began the work in His own way. Here and there the hearts of earnest Christian men were being stirred, and they began to pray and work. Prominent amongst these were Mr. Daniel Matthews and Rev. J. B. Gribble. The writer has a vivid recollection of his first meeting with Mr. Matthews, and how the old pioneer's face glowed with enthusiasm as he spoke of his people and his work. This added fuel to the fire of missionary in-

terest already kindled through reading Mr. Gribble's book, "Black but Comely," published in London in the year 1884. This sturdy champion of the cause of the aborigines has long since passed to his reward. This morning the writer stood by his grave in the Waverley Cemetery, and read on the Gothic slab of Australian freestone this striking inscription:

In Loving Memory Of
THE REV. JOHN BROWN GRIBBLE, F.R.G.S.,
Founder of the Warangesda Mission,
And the Blackfellows' Friend,
Who Fell Asleep, June 3rd, 1893.
Aged 45 years.
"God Is Love."

There is also an inscription in memory of his wife, who died thirty-five years later. Here is a striking indication of the great and marvellous ways of God. J. B. Gribble, the blackfellows' friend, is laid to rest on June 3, 1893, and on July 3, 1893, before the grass is green on the champion's grave, four Christian Endeavourers meet in the vestry of the Petersham Congregational Church to hold the first official meeting of the Aborigines Committee. The minutes of that meeting disclose plans to give a "tea meeting" to the aborigines at La Perouse. An old school-room has been secured at Botany from a local butcher, who gives free meat galore. Tables, forms, lamps, etc., are loaned by the School of Arts; Mr. Trivett will lend cups and saucers and cook the meat; while Mr. William White, baker, of Redfern, is to be thanked for bread. Mr. G. E. Ardill has loaned a lantern and sheet, and Mr. Hargraves has supplied the slides, which would be shown after tea. This would be followed by an evangelistic meeting, led by a local minister. The reading of





these records reveals a splendid enthusiasm in the work of this Committee, under the leadership of their capable convener, Miss J. Watson, who was afterwards appointed missionary at La Perouse under the Aborigines Protection Association.

This lady, writing from Victoria under the date of June 25, 1921, makes special mention of the splendid assistance given in the work at La Perouse by members of the Woollahra Baptist Church, and of this we must now write.

One bright November morning in the year 1889, Mr. H. E. Hockey, an active Christian Endeavourer, and afterwards Sunday school superintendent and choirmaster at the above church, went to La Perouse to instal a cooking stove at the old Customs House. During the lunch hour he came face to face with some of the local aborigines, and after a brief conversation on general themes, he spoke to them about the Lord Jesus Christ. He was astonished at their replies to his questions.

The native people listened with rapt attention to the words of the visitor. This was a new experience for them. People sometimes came from the city to buy their goods, and many of them tried to lure the dark folk into sin. They brought cards and dice, and taught the natives to gamble, drink, and swear. Here was a man who, instead of grog, brought the Gospel. Instead of cards, he brought them Christ. He showed a kindly sympathy, and won their confidence.

The La Perouse natives were awake to a new interest. They invited Mr. Hockey to come again and tell them more. The assurance was given, and in due time he came again, bringing other Christians from Woollahra and Paddington. Occasional visits were paid by these and other friends, and Gospel meetings were held in the open air; while simultaneously, and altogether unknown to them, the tide

of missionary enthusiasm was rising amongst the Petersham Congregational Endeavourers, and important events were pending.

Reference must now be made to the work of the New South Wales Aborigines' Protection Association, a society formed some years earlier, having for its aim the social, moral, religious, and intellectual welfare of the aborigines, and having for its devoted secretary, Mr. G. E. Ardill. The reports at present in the writer's possession date from the year 1885. Valuable work was done at Cumeroogunga (late Maloga), Warangesda, and Brewarrina; and the published report for 1893 tells of work at La Perouse. Mr. G. Colton Smith, collector and ardent missionary worker for this Association, took an important part in this new undertaking. He paid a visit to Petersham Congregational Endeavourers, giving a lantern lecture on work amongst the aborigines. He then asked for workers who would go to the native camp at La Perouse to conduct services. A number of young persons became interested, and formed the nucleus of the Aborigines' Committee. Meetings were held on Sundays, and on Saturday nights suitable entertainments were arranged to keep the people together, thus preventing them from going into the city.

Miss Watson, before being appointed missionary, sometimes stayed in Sydney on Saturday nights and sought out the aborigines around Paddy's Markets, shielding them from temptation, keeping them from the hotels, and getting them home early. Some of the Christian men belonging to the committee were also there to assist in this good work. Sometimes, in order to avoid Sunday travelling, Miss Watson walked from Stanmore to La Perouse, a distance of at least nine miles, returning home in time for the evening service. These days of youthful missionary zeal brought their abundant recompense in rich blessing and much joy in service.





Tents were then procured, and the workers went out on Saturday and camped at La Perouse for the week-end. Soon after this, Mr. Walsh, of Botany, gave old wool bales, and the dark people helped the workers to sew them together as a covering for a large wooden frame that had been erected. This building marked a great advance, and was known as the mission tent. There was a fireplace, and a movable partition so that it could be used both as a dwelling and a meeting-room.

Other prominent workers in these early days were Mr. E. Livermore, Mr. A. Kendall, Mr. Ledger, and Mr. Nall (Rev. Percy Nall, of the Australian Baptist Mission). Miss Watson was also assisted in the work by her sisters, and the position of Gospel soloist was ably filled by Miss Edith Boore (Mrs. Colin Smith, of Waverley).

At this stage, the work amongst the aborigines at La Perouse received the official recognition of the New South Wales Christian Endeavour Union, and an appeal was made to all affiliated societies for help to erect a mission hall. The matter was taken up heartily, and up to December, 1893, the sum of £15/8/4 had been sent to the treasurer of the Association for this purpose. The following correspondence will demonstrate the enthusiasm of the Endeavourers in responding to this missionary call:—

The Manse, Summer Hill,
October 16, 1893.

Dear Miss Watson,

I am very delighted to hear of the good work you are undertaking for our aborigines. Of course, usually, we expect Endeavourers to do and support mission work through their own churches, but in this case, when so little is being done, and that so very distinctly of an interdenominational character, I see no objection why Endeavourers who are willing should not unite in carrying the

Gospel to our neglected natives, and I assure you of my entire sympathy and co-operation so long as the effort does not in any way interfere with church and denominational mission work already being done.—With kind regards, yours very faithfully,

President of the N.S.W. Christian Endeavour Union.

---

N.S.W. Christian Endeavour Office.
"For Christ and the Church."
Sydney, November 11, 1893.

Dear Miss Watson,

The following resolution was passed by the Executive Committee at its last meeting, and I have very great pleasure in forwarding it to you:

"That this committee very warmly commends the purpose of the Christian Endeavour Workers connected with the Aboriginal Mission to erect a building at La Perouse, for the use of the Mission at that place, and very heartily wishes them God speed."—Yours truly,

GEO. GRAY, Hon. Sec.

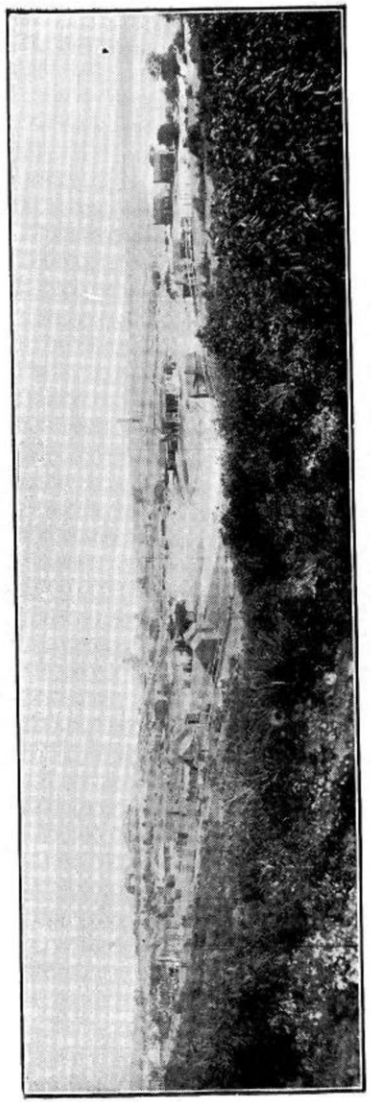
Armed with official authority, these earnest and eager Endeavourers at once issued a circular letter to every society in the State. This is a very business-like and convincing document, and on the back are printed the two letters appearing above. It reads.—

To the Christian Endeavour Societies of N.S.W.

Dear Fellow Endeavourers,

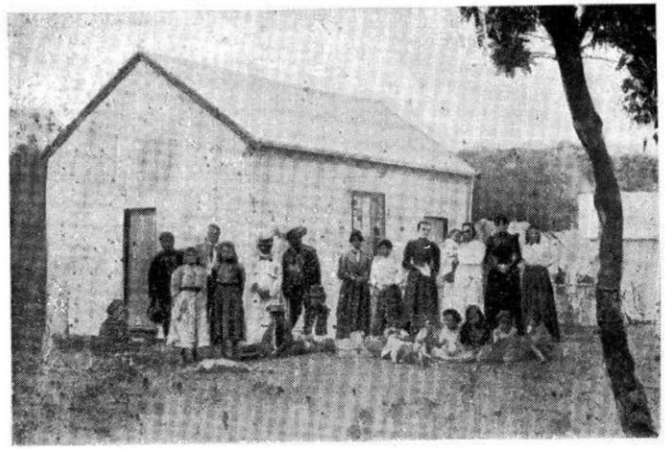
Permit us to bring under your notice a Mission being conducted by members of the Petersham Congregational Society of Christian Endeavour and other helpers, under the oversight of the Aborigines' Protection Association.

The Old Woollahra Baptist Church, from which Mr. Hockey and others visited La Perouse. A new church has since been built at Waverley, and for eight years the writer of this story filled the pastorate.

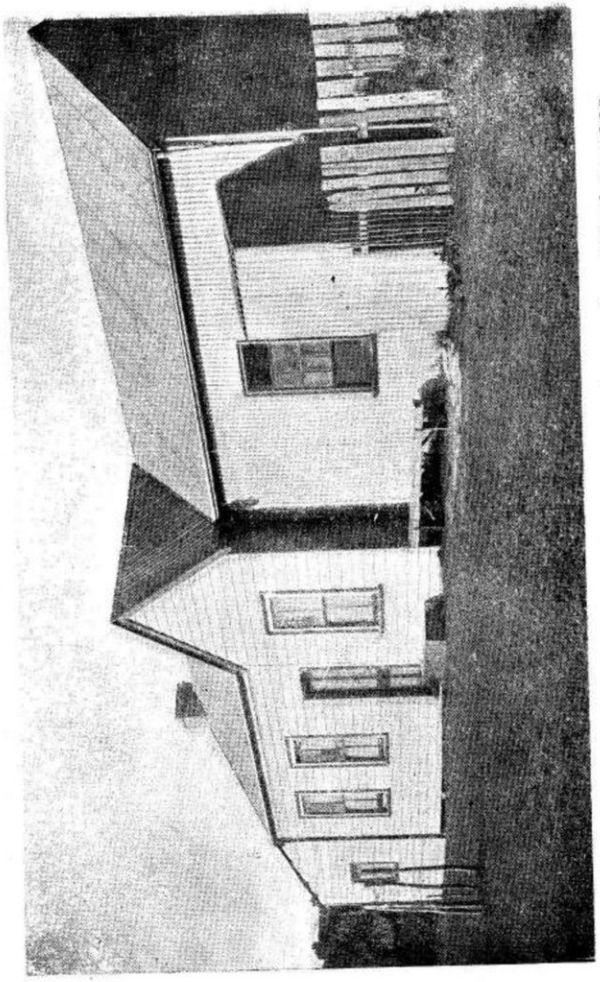


La Perouse, looking towards Botany Heads. Mission House in centre of sand-drift. Tall tree near centre top indicates the historic La Perouse Monument.





THE FIRST MISSION CHURCH AT LA PEROUSE.
Opened November 26, 1894.
Miss J. Watson and some of the La Perouse native people.



La Perouse Mission House and Church before it was demolished in 1933.



1



For many years a large number of aboriginals have camped at La Perouse, near Botany, but, until lately, no distinctly aggressive effort has been made to carry to them the glad tidings of a Saviour's love. However, about seven months since, a band of Endeavourers were induced by Mr. G. C. Smith, a worker of the Aborigines' Protection Association, to undertake Christian work amongst the people. Up to the present, much encouragement has been received by the workers. who usually visit the camp twice a week. So that more effective work can be accomplished, and the difficulty experienced in wet weather be overcome, it has been decided to erect a Mission House. (The Aborigines' Protection Board have kindly granted the necessary permission). It is estimated that the sum of sixty pounds will cover the cost of the erection of a suitable building. The committee desire to make it a Christian Endeavour House, and will therefore be glad of your earnest co-operation in securing the necessary amount. The building, when erected, will be utilised for religious services on Sundays and during the week, as well as for classes for training the people to habits of industry and thrift. If you would like to know more about the work, some of the workers will be glad to give an address on a suitable afternoon or evening. In helping this Mission you will enable the workers to fulfil one of our Lord's last commands—Matt. 28, 19-20.

Many of the societies responded generously to this appeal, and a substantial fund was gradually built up. At first it was intended to commence building immediately, and tenders were called. It was proposed to ask the Governor to open the Mission Hall, and suitable plans for the function were outlined. The committee received twenty tenders from various builders, but the prices submitted were

considered too high for the class of building required. This occasioned some delay, and for a time the mission tent was used. In spite of multiplied difficulties, optimism prevailed. One extract from the committee's minute book reads:—"The present mission tent has nearly caught fire two or three times, and once actually so, but as there was no wind it was put out, praise God! Our very beings should ring with praise."

In June, 1894, the La Perouse Aborigines' Christian Endeavour Society was formed, with seven active members. Officers and committees were appointed, and amongst other Christian service the Flower Committee visited the Little Bay hospital every week. There were many signs of a deep work of grace amongst the native people, and several striking cases of conversion.

November 26, 1894, was the occasion of great rejoicing at the mission station, for on that day the much-desired mission church was opened free of debt. The cost of this little Bethel was £43; in it was invested the money contributed by the Christian Endeavourers of New South Wales. Miss Watson laboured earnestly at La Perouse for about twelve months as a missionary of the Aborigines' Protection Association. At the end of that time financial support was no longer available. The missionary suggested continuing without guarantee of support, but as the strenuous work had impaired her health, her medical adviser insisted on a complete change. As a mark of continued confidence, the A.P.A. soon afterwards offered her a position as matron at Cumeroogunga, which offer was accepted. This ardent worker (now Mrs. Knowles) wrote some years ago from Victoria, giving much valuable information of the early days at La Perouse. Great things had been accomplished for Christ and the aborigines; the future held out a challenge for greater things, greater difficulties, and greater victories.



## CHAPTER II.

## SMALL BEGINNINGS.

The little band of faithful workers, who had tackled the task of evangelising the aborigines at La Perouse, showed splendid courage and dogged determination to succeed in spite of difficulties. They were resolved to see things through. The official records reveal an optimism that conquered all opposition. Disease and sickness had visited the camp, and several of the native people had been sentenced to imprisonment in Darlinghurst gaol, but the labour of love went steadily on. The minute book records: "Death of Archie Murray in Little Bay hospital. His remains were followed to the grave by two workers." "Death of Jimmy Sadler in Darlinghurst goal—IN CHRIST." "We are passing through trial, but there are lights along the way, the silver lining showing on many a cloud." Another minute reads: "A deputation from the A.P.A. visited the camp to see what could be done to make the mission house habitable. The result was that they decided that nothing could be done. Also, the A.P.A. had decided that they could no longer support the mission, which is therefore in a state of suspense."

After a period of prayer, it was decided to call together those they knew to be interested in the work for the purpose of deciding what could be done to prevent the closing of the Mission. In response to the appeal a number of devoted friends assembled, and an enthusiastic meeting was held in the Christian Endeavour office, Pitt Street, Sydney, on 1st of July, 1895. It was unanimously agreed to form a strong committee to carry on the work. This

was done forthwith, and at the next meeting the following persons were added to the committee: Messrs. J. Spencer, H. E. Hockey, J. Waddington, G. E. Bodley, J. Bonney, C. Bavin, J. Webster, and Miss Baker.

This meeting, held in the Sydney C.E. office on the 30th day of July, 1895, definitely marks the formation of the mission which was officially designated the

LA PEROUSE ABORIGINES MISSION COMMITTEE.

This committee, thus enlarged and strengthened, with a new name and a new hope, met on August 22 to adopt rules for future guidance, and to make plans for aggressive work. The following kindly and helpful letter was placed before the meeting:—

Aborigines Protection Association,
Temperance Hall, Pitt St., Sydney.
August 22, 1895.

Mr. A. Kendall,
Hon. Sec., La Perouse Mission.

Dear Sir,—I am directed by my Council to inform you that they have carefully considered the proposed rules for the working of the Mission, and are in perfect accord with the spirit thereof, but deeming the phraseology somewhat obscure, have altered it in some cases. I have now to submit the revised rules for the endorsement of your committee, and to assure them that in every way possible my Council will facilitate their work and render such aid as they may be able from time to time.

Praying for rich blessings from our covenant-keeping God upon every effort of your committee,
Yours in the Master's service,

G. E. ARDILL, Gen. Secretary.





These rules were now officially adopted as a definite basis for continuing the work. They read as follows:—

(1) That this Committee be called the La Perouse Aborigines Mission Committee, and continues its work under the auspices of the Aborigines Protection Association.

(2) This Committee will submit the names of its members, and furnish a quarterly report of its work to the Association.

(3) This Committee undertakes to raise sufficient funds to carry on the work on the conditions hereinafter mentioned.

(4) All monies collected or subscribed for the La Perouse Mission shall be paid to this Committee through its Treasurer, and by him handed to the Aborigines Protection Association.

(5) This Committee has control over the expenditure of such monies, shall pass all accounts of the La Perouse Mission after they have been submitted to the Association for approval. Such accounts shall be paid through the Treasurer of the Committee, who shall receive the money for the same from the Association as a refund.

(6) When sufficient funds shall have been raised, this Committee has the right of nominating the missionary at La Perouse for the approval of the Aborigines Protection Association.

The Committee then decided to change their place of meeting, and accepted the generous offer of the Rev. F. E. Harry to meet in the vestry at the Bathurst Street Baptist Church. This proved a very helpful arrangement, and the Committee met at Bathurst Street vestry for about twelve months, when, for the convenience of members, the meetings were held at Miss Baker's home in Darlinghurst. In the old days, the workers sometimes met at the street corners and transacted the business of the

Mission by the aid of the flickering gas lamps, but from this time onward there was no lack of suitable accommodation for the monthly meetings of the Committee.

The work at La Perouse was continued with renewed energy and effectiveness, and the Aborigines' Christian Endeavour Society was brought into closer touch with the Committee. It is recorded that Queen Emma (Mrs. Timbery) had been elected as vice-president of the society, and another of the natives as recording secretary. Mrs. Timbery was for many years an outstanding Christian character at La Perouse, and her faithful testimony and consistent witness brought many others to know the Lord Jesus Christ as a personal Saviour from sin.

The burning question now before the Committee was the appointment of a resident missionary at La Perouse. The Aborigines' Protection Association had suggested the name of Paddy Swift, a native Christian, who had received some training at Comeroogunga station. The official report of the Association publishes Paddy's photograph, with the following biographical note:—

> Paddy Swift is 52 years of age, yet he looks forward to many more years of service in the army of Him under Whose banner he has enlisted. Paddy was born on the Victorian side of the Murray, on the Hermitage station, on Ovens River. The age of six saw him separated from his people; when he was 15 he was earning his living by stock-riding. Horse-training and breaking, farming, as station hand—in these occupations he passed the early years of his life. About the year 1884 he was induced to visit Maloga Mission Station to see some friends. He gave himself a month to stay on the station, but, to use his own words, "before the month was up, I became converted."





Paddy was duly nominated as missionary, and the proposal was that the Committee should be responsible for his upkeep, on the understanding that the A.P.A. would find his board and travelling expenses when away from the station. This project was never carried into effect for several reasons. In the first place, the Aborigines' Protection Board declined to allow a residence to be built for a missionary at La Perouse, so that for many months nothing further could be done. Then the Committee came to the conclusion that this candidate was unsuitable, so that Paddy Swift was never officially appointed as missionary by the La Perouse Committee.

It should be mentioned that in these early days of the Mission a keen and practical interest in the work was displayed by the William Street Methodist Church, and also by the Petersham Baptists. We shall have occasion to mention some of the prominent workers from these centres as they come into the story, but at present we must emphasise the fact that from these two churches came a number of earnest Christian men and women who are still devoted to the cause, "but some have fallen asleep."

In the record of the minutes of a Committee meeting held on April 10, 1896, we read: "On the recommendation of Miss Watson, Mr. Kendall moved, and Mr. Waddington seconded, that Miss Retta Dixon, of Petersham, be nominated a member of the Committee." At the following meeting, Miss Dixon was welcomed as a member of that Missionary Band, and thus commenced a life-long association with the cause of the aborigines.

Some difficulty was experienced in obtaining the consent of the Government Board to erect a residence for the missionary at La Perouse, the Board at that time holding the view that the establishment of a mission station would encourage the aborigines

from country districts to settle near the city. It was therefore necessary that this matter should be deferred, but meanwhile the Committee continued in prayer for guidance, and at the same time faithfully carried on the work with visiting preachers.

The small, unlined, galvanised iron church was intensely hot in summer and cold during the winter, but in November, 1896, Mr. H. E. Hockey was requested to ascertain the cost of material for lining. This was done, and when some time later funds were available, this devoted brother himself carried out the work, and thus the "House of God" was made cosy and attractive.

A special meeting of the Committee was held on March 12, 1897, at Miss Baker's home in Paddington. A letter was received from Miss Retta Dixon, offering herself as missionary for La Perouse. Correspondence was also read from Miss Watson and from Dr. Thomas Porter, pastor of the Petersham Baptist Church, of which church Miss Dixon was a member. Both letters commended the candidate as being suitable. It was reported by Mr. Waddington that the native people at "The Camp" would welcome Miss Dixon with kindness and cordiality, and the Committee "expressed pleasure at the offer, firmly believing that God would soon open the way for the work to go forward."

The Aborigines' Protection Association had definitely ceased active work at La Perouse, but the consent of the Government Board to the settlement of a missionary on the reserve was still withheld.

In September, 1897, several new members were added to the Committee, and amongst these were Mr. W. Newman and Miss Barraclough (later Mrs. Calder). Both continued long as members of the N.S.W. Council. Other valuable members received at this time were Mr. and Mrs. J. Morton, and Miss Fanny Driver.





The time was now ripe for a definite decision in the matter of appointing a missionary, and at a meeting held on September 17, 1897, Miss Dixon was duly elected as missionary for La Perouse for a period of twelve months from the date of installation, which took place on November 9, 1897. It was a day of rejoicing and thanksgiving for answered prayer. The missionary was required to spend six days each week at the camp, and to make a point of being present on Saturdays, Sundays, and public holidays. A monthly report of all work done was to be made to the Committee.

Another occasion of rejoicing was the removal of the difficulty which prevented the building of a residence for the missionary. The consent of the A.P. Board was given in January, 1898, and the building was completed without delay. This was undertaken and faithfully carried out by Miss Dixon's father, the contract price being £40.

The monthly reports of the missionary, now settled in her new home, were very encouraging, and quite a number of the native people definitely accepted the Lord Jesus Christ as Saviour, and showed by their lives that they were truly born of God. Interest in the work spread, and cash came readily into the coffers of the Mission.

In addition to the work at La Perouse, Miss Dixon visited numerous churches and C.E. societies, accompanied by some of the converted natives, and much interest was aroused.

The work now began to spread to other localities. In March, 1898, a member of the Committee paid a visit to some dark people at Plumpton, between Sydney and the foothills of the Blue Mountains. In November of the same year this work was organised, and weekly open-air gospel services were conducted by members of the Committee. On January 2, 1899, a local Committee was formed, with

Mr. R. Iles as chairman. Valuable work in this centre was done by Miss Iles, Miss Bayliss, and Mr. and Mrs. Morton. Mrs. Morton was a very faithful and devoted member of the Central Committee until her death, which took place in September, 1905. Mr. and Mrs. Schroeder also proved loyal friends of the Mission in this locality. A church was opened at Plumpton on March 3, 1900, after which many of the native people were brought to Christ.

In January, 1899, nine camps along the South Coast were visited by Miss Dixon, and work was commenced at Illawarra Lake. A mission hall was opened here in June of the same year, and Mr. J. Vidler installed as missionary. After twelve months' work Mr. Vidler's health broke down, and he was obliged to retire, but frequent visits were paid by the missionary from La Perouse, and by members of the Central Committee.

Some time after this, work was begun at Port Kembla by Miss Kemish, of Wollongong (later Mrs. L. Burcher). In May, 1903, the local workers were formed into a committee, and a church was opened in August of the same year. Sunday school and church work was continued by Miss Kemish for about two years, when most of the natives were removed from the district.

Work was also commenced at Greenwell Point and Roseby Park, near Nowra, about 100 miles south of Sydney.

Sackville Reach, on the beautiful Hawkesbury River, was the next sphere of labour chosen. Here small companies of natives were settled along the banks of the river, and on the mountain-side. They were visited by the missionary and one of the native Christians in July, 1899, and a church was opened on January 10 of the following year. Some Christian effort had been made at Sackville previously, but the work was placed on a systematic basis, and much blessing resulted.





As the work amongst the aborigines grew and extended, many of the city and suburban churches showed deep and practical interest. Amongst these we must mention the William Street Methodist Church. From this active spiritual centre came a number of missionary stalwarts, and of these we should name Miss Baker, whose father was an honoured missionary martyr of the South Sea Islands; Mr. W. E. Cormack, Mr. Henry Bush, Mr. D. C. Butters, and Mr. L. W. Long.

Mr. Long became interested in the La Perouse Mission in the year 1895, and several years later was elected a member of the Committee. His keen and practical interest, combined with his deep spiritual life, caused him to be a brother beloved by all. He was business manager of "The Aborigines Advocate" for some years, and upon the retirement of Mr. Stanley Cooper from the position of treasurer of the Mission, he was elected to that responsible office, and continued to serve in that capacity until March, 1905. This brother also rendered valiant service in opposing the application for a liquor license at La Perouse.

Mr. Long was much beloved for his manly Christian character, and his untiring zeal in the service of his Master.

In some respects we are ahead of our story, but it has been necessary to briefly sketch the career of some of the valued workers mentioned in this chapter. Their names will often recur in the following pages, for their splendid service is interwoven with the early history of the Mission, and much that is yet to be told will have reference to their loyal labours of love.

We must now relate that in February, 1905, Miss Dixon tendered her resignation to the Committee of the Mission. The resignation took effect in April of the same year, after seven years and five

months of consecrated service. Although her connection with the Mission had been severed, Miss Dixon continued to work amongst the aborigines.

As already indicated, Mr. L. W. Long retired from the Mission about the same time. Shortly after this, Mr. Long and Miss Dixon were united in marriage, and under their leadership the "Aborigines Inland Mission" was brought into being. It is not within the scope of our story to tell of this work, but we recognise as co-workers in Christ all who are telling the dear dark people of Australia the story of Calvary.

In December, 1928, Mr. Long was called from earthly service into the presence of his Lord. The call came suddenly, but his faith in Christ was calm and serene. We were able to tender our deep sympathy to the sorrowing ones, although words on such an occasion are inadequate.

In order to rightly appreciate the guidance of God through these forty years of missionary labour, we must glance back again to the year 1899. The work had prospered, and new fields of service had been opening up on every hand. The meetings of the Committee were characterised by a deep spiritual tone, and, best of all, many of the aborigines were being completely changed by the uplifting power of Christ and His Gospel. The Macedonian cry is now coming from distant places. The day of "Small Beginnings" is passing. We must go forward.



## CHAPTER III.

## GROWTH AND EXTENSION.

As we proceed to record the development and expansion of the Mission, it is necessary to emphasise the significance of the two words that stand at the heading of this chapter. There is the inward growth and accumulation of spiritual energy as the outcome of much prayer, and the bringing together in fellowship of a band of spiritually minded men and women; and then there is the expression of that inward strength in the definite service of extending the Kingdom of Christ among the Aborigines, as yet untouched by the power of the Gospel. From available records we gather that the meetings of the Committee during the year 1900, and for some years following, were characterised by a deep devotion to Jesus Christ. Persistent prayer prevailed. At a meeting held on July 14, 1899, Mr. T. E. Colebrook was elected a member of the La Perouse Committee, and from that time onward the strength of his consecrated personality, coupled with his unfailing enthusiasm, was a decidedly helpful factor in the progress of the work. On December 8 of the same year, Mr. Colebrook was elected secretary, which office he held with credit for two years, when he was unanimously elected president. Mr. Colebrook was a keen battler for the cause of the Aborigines, and championed their rights from platform and in the public press. As a prominent alderman of a suburban municipal council, and editor of a local paper, his influence counted for much. In all his work he had the sympathy and support of Mrs.

Colebrook, and, as the years went by, their home became a true home for every missionary associated with the work.

The work had already been commenced in various centres, as indicated in the previous chapter, and it became obvious that the designation "La Perouse Aborigines' Committee" was no longer appropriate. At a meeting held on September 8, 1899, the name of the Mission was changed to "NEW SOUTH WALES ABORIGINES' MISSION." Reports were received of the work at La Perouse, South Coast, Rooty Hill, and Hawkesbury River. The first visit to the Macleay River took place in October of that year. A number of large camps were located, and Rev. R. Mowbray, of Kempsey, was asked to arrange for the formation of a local committee. During the absence of the missionary from La Perouse, Miss Deck, of Ashfield, supervised the work at headquarters. On New Year's Day, 1900, the new church at Sackville Reach was officially opened, and at the evening service one of the aborigines definitely decided for Christ. The native people in every centre seemed eager for the Gospel message, and there were some notable cases of conversion.

Remarkable talent was discovered in many of the dark people; their aptitude in arithmetic, writing, drawing, and music being a cause of surprise to many. At La Perouse, Nellie Timbury, one of the girls at the Mission, was appointed to the position of organist, and we find it recorded in the minutes of the Committee: "It was decided that a hymn book be purchased for Nellie Timbury in recognition of her services as organist." The writer of this record has often been impressed with the tenderness and pathos of her playing. She certainly had the "soul of music." An aboriginal boy at Grafton, on the Clarence River, won first prize in a writing competition which was open to every public school pupil, white or coloured, in the State of





N.S.W. Other accomplishments could be mentioned, but space will not permit.

During the year 1900, attention was focussed on the Macleay River district, where there were from 300 to 400 aborigines in five main centres. A prominent police officer, Sergeant Baker (afterwards Inspector), was in charge of the force in Kempsey. It became known to the committee that he was an earnest Christian worker, and deeply interested in the aborigines. His practical support and wise counsel was a great help to the Mission on the northern rivers, and, after his retirement to Sydney, he was associated with the Central Committee. That he was a man of much prayer is illustrated by the following incident, related to the writer by Johnnie Mosely, at one time police tracker with Inspector Baker. The Inspector and Johnnie were tracking a dangerous criminal through the dense bush of the North Coast. They knew the fugitive was fully armed, and he had threatened to shoot both policeman and tracker on sight. It was difficult and dangerous work, and the Inspector had asked the tracker to hold the horses while he himself retired alone into the bush. Johnnie was puzzled, till one day he asked the question: "Mr. Baker, why you go away by yourself into the bush?" The Inspector replied: "I go to pray, Johnnie, to ask God to take care of us and help us." Johnnie's answer came as a surprise and rebuke: "Why don't you let me go with you, Mr. Baker? I want to pray to God, too." Several times after that, in some lonely spot in the heart of the Australian bush, a strange and beautiful thing took place—police inspector and black tracker knelt side by side in prayer to the Great Father of all who believe. Inspector Baker was a strict but kindly officer, and was deeply loved by the native people.

In August, 1900, the Committee decided that a missionary should be sent to the Macleay River.

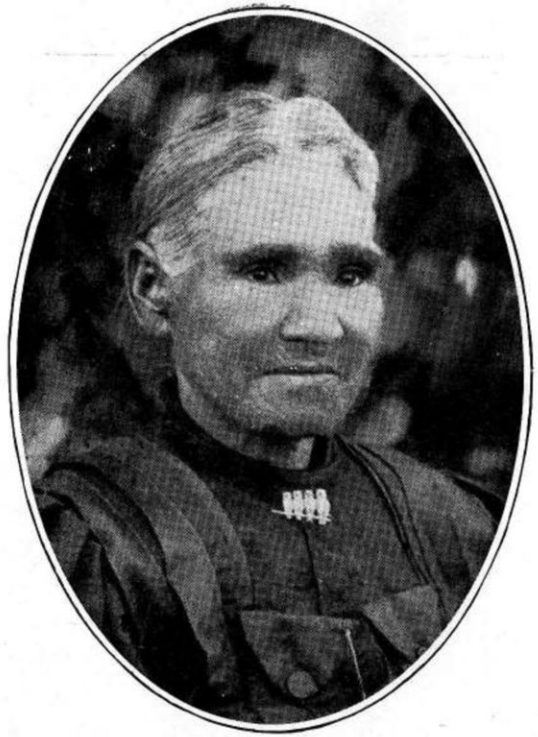
Letters were written to a number of Ministers in N.S.W., and to Rev. W. L. Morton, of Angas College, Adelaide, making enquiries for a suitable worker. Mr. Morton replied to the enquiry, and recommended the writer of this story, who had just completed his course of study at the College. One can never forget how the beloved Principal of the Training Home brought the letter he had received from the Council in Sydney, and suggested that we should pray together about it. Several months of definite waiting upon God for guidance followed, and the Lord indicated His will with unmistakable clearness. On February 8, 1901, the writer was accepted by the Council of the Mission as missionary for the Macleay River.

The farewell meeting at Angas College can never be forgotten. Two missionaries are being sent forth. Faithful Micah, the much loved Japanese student, is to carry the Gospel to the people of his own land, and the other worker has the same uplifting message for the aborigines of New South Wales. The voyage to Sydney, travelling steerage on the old "Wodonga," now safe in Davy Jones' Locker, was an experience to literally "bring out" all the good there was in a young missionary. The equinoctial gales were at their best (or worst), and even some of the officers and crew of the steamer suffered from "mal de mer." The compensation came when he entered the Sydney Harbour just at sunrise on the eighth day after leaving Adelaide.

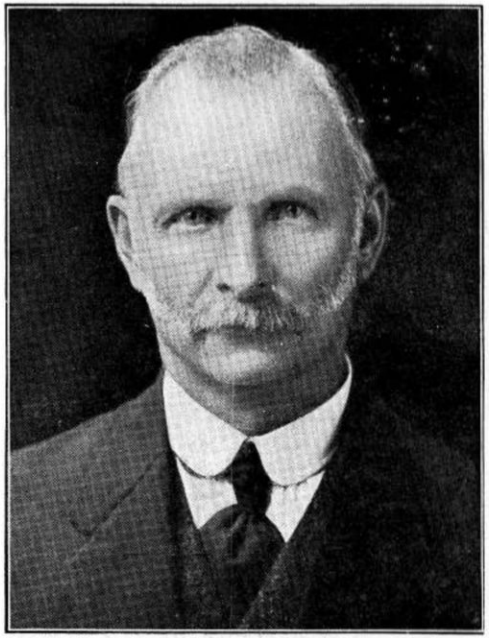
The induction of the missionary for the Macleay River took place in the Pitt Street Congregational Church on Tuesday, April 2, 1901. The chairman was Rev. E. T. Dunstan, and the speakers: Miss Dixon, Rev. W. M. Dill Macky, Dr. Thomas Porter, Rev. George Lane, Rev. Henry Martyn, and the outgoing missionary.

On reaching the Macleay River, an open door for service awaited us, but there were "many



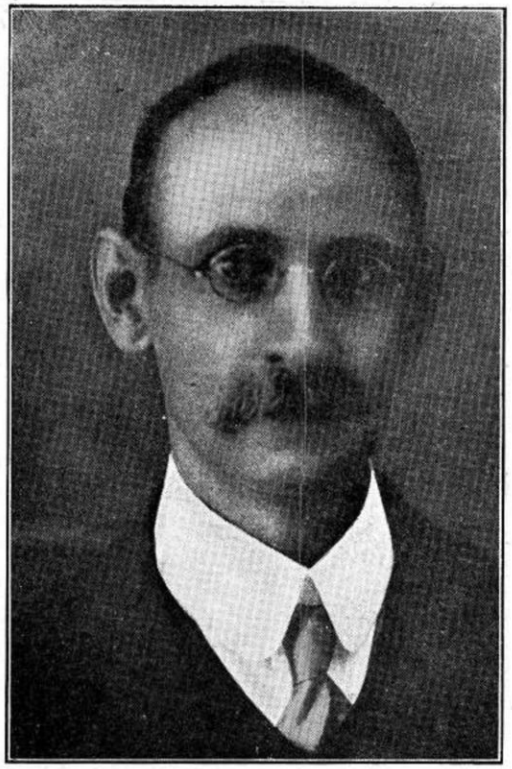


Queen Emma, Mrs. Timbery.

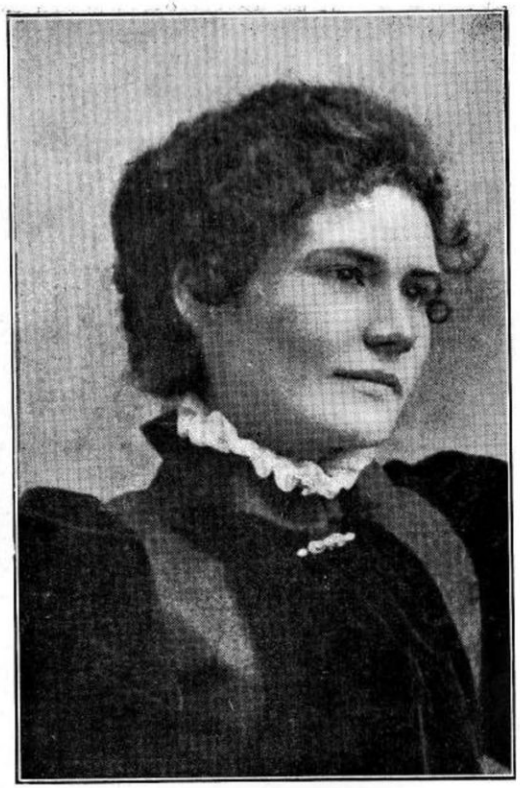


Mr. H. E. HOCKEY,
Treasurer of the Mission in 1895, and a member of the present N.S.W. Council, 1932.





Mr. L. W. LONG.
(Now with the Lord).



Miss RETTA DIXON.
(Mrs. L. W. Long).





adversaries." Many of the white residents, who had been benefiting themselves through the credulity and defencelessness of the aborigines, regarded the advent of the missionary with suspicion and aversion, realising, no doubt, "that the hope of their gains was gone." It was decided to establish headquarters at Burnt Bridge, four miles from Kempsey. Here the missionary lived for some time in a tent. A site was selected for the Church and Mission House, and missionary and people combed the surrounding bush to find suitable trees for splitting the slabs and squaring the posts for the building. Great enthusiasm prevailed, and in the meantime the Gospel was preached in the open air and in the huts of the native people, many being led to accept the Lord Jesus Christ as their personal Saviour.

## CHAPTER IV.

## THE BIRTH OF A MAGAZINE.

As the work of the Mission extended, and reports were coming to hand of aggressive work being carried on in different parts of the State, the Committee realised the need for some systematic method of recording the work of the missionaries and helpers, and of creating a wider and more intelligent interest in the cause of the neglected aborigines.

At a meeting held on June 14, 1901, an offer was made by the Secretary, Mr. T. E. Colebrook, to conduct a small newspaper under the auspices of the Committee, such paper to be devoted to the claims of the aborigines of the Commonwealth; the profits over actual costs to be given to the funds of the Mission. The paper was to be called "THE NEW SOUTH WALES ABORIGNES' ADVOCATE."

On the motion of Mr. F. R. King, seconded by Inspector Baker, the offer was accepted. The latter gentleman and Mr. J. Morton, Vice-President, consented to become bondsmen; and the editorial work was entrusted to Mr. Colebrook.

The work of launching the magazine was undertaken without delay, and the first issue of the "Advocate" appeared on July 23, 1901. It was a four-page paper, full quarto size, with three columns to a page. The matter was well chosen, and was attractively arranged by the experienced hand of the editor. We publish with this a reduced photographic reproduction of the front page of this first





issue. The paper set out concisely the aims and objects of the Mission, published pithy reports of the work at the various stations, and eloquently advocated the claims of the aborigines. With the increased publicity thus made possible, the Mission entered a new era of effective service, and many willing supporters of the work were added to the company of missionary enthusiasts who had adopted as their slogan: "Christ for the Aborigines, and the Aborigines for Christ."

For some little time after its first publication, the "New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate" was partly supported by advertisements in its columns, inserted by Christian business men, and in perusing these ancient files we are exhorted to try William White's bread, Charles Mihell's bibles, Searl and Son's seeds, and J. Marshall's 18 carat teeth.

Matthew Dixon will build you a house, J. Morton will do your plumbing, H. Turner your painting, Yarrow, or Simpson, will supply your groceries, and Frank Alexander will cut your hair. The writer well remembers how through the years these men and many others combined business integrity with zeal in Christian service and missionary enterprise. Advertisements of this kind were inserted in the "Advocate" until December, 1902, when a radical change in the policy of the Mission brought about their discontinuance. This will be fully explained in a later chapter.

The devoted editor of the paper made good use of his opportunities to advocate the claims of the aborigines and the Mission, as the following extracts from early editorials will show.

"Have the aborigines any claim upon us? We are afraid many of us think they have none, and that in suffering them to live amongst us we are doing a gracious act. By sheer force we have taken their land and have given them very little in exchange. Not content with this, many of them have

been wantonly destroyed by the early settlers. They have been driven from place to place in the country that rightly belongs to them.

But has the race that originally inhabited this fair land no claims upon us British people who pride ourselves on our own magnanimity to all native races under our flag? It does seem strange that we should treat well the Maoris, the Indians, and others, and yet allow the Aborigines of Australia to be worse than neglected. The Government Board is doing a good deal to alleviate their miserable condition, but its power is very limited. . . . The race is rapidly dying out. Already it is extinct in Tasmania, so that it is high time the people stirred themselves as to the claims of their dark brethren, and roused politicians (as their representatives) to a sense of their duty.

But the aborigines have another and a higher claim upon us who are Christians. We have been commissioned by Christ to preach the Gospel to them, and how sadly we have neglected this great trust! It is our duty as followers of Christ to lead these people to their Saviour. How can we enjoy the blessings and privileges of Christianity without inviting the aborigines to share them? We are very anxious that the heathen in foreign lands should be evangelised, but what about the heathen at our own door? Because the aboriginal has been driven into remote parts of the country so that we shall not be offended by seeing him every day, we are willing to try and forget him and our responsibility to him; but God will hold us responsible both as a nation and as individuals for having so heartlessly treated the poor blackfellow. We trust that our little newspaper may be, in the truest sense of the word, an 'Advocate' for the aborigines, and that the espousal of their claims may lead the Christian public to see their duty and do it. Let us bestir ourselves on their behalf. Let us rally round those who are trying to





carry the Gospel to them. Let our sympathy and our interest be practical. But what we do, let us do it **at once**, before it is too late."

The above extract, slightly condensed, will show with what earnestness and courage the claims of the native people were emphasised. We venture also to quote from the explanatory editorial (in the first issue of the paper), entitled "Ourselves."

"The world to-day is in a state of flux, and old ideas, traditions and prejudices are giving place in many matters to a newer, better, and more humanitarian conception of our duties and desires with regard to our less fortunate fellows. The proof of this may be seen in a thousand and one ways, and we earnestly thank God for such advancement. This, then, being the spirit abroad, we feel that there is no necessity for an apology on our part for the publication of 'The New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate.' That there is an opening and a need for such a paper is well exemplified by the fact that the original inhabitants of Australia are rapidly dying out. We, who have usurped their land, must take to them the Gospel of Christ, and in every other legitimate way make their hard and lonely lot happier, easier, and cleaner than it has been heretofore. We hear a loud cry to-day about 'Australia for the Australians,' a cry which, if carried to its logical conclusion, would considerably surprise and disconcert the utterers, for, whilst most of them claim to be ultra-democratic, they are sadly conservative in democratic practice, and un-Christian both in theory and in practice when they say that a native born Australian is not a man and a brother because his skin happens to be a few shades darker than their own. That their insistent attitude in this vital matter is more the result of want of thought than want of heart, we are convinced, and one of the missions of our little paper

will be to dispel the illusion that a black Australian is not as good a man as a white one, other things being equal.

That our black brother's mentality is not inferior to ours has been amply evidenced on many occasions in competition with scholastic examinations, and in some instances the black Australian children have proved their superiority. To those who may be willing to help in the laudable enterprise of uplifting the aborigines, we may say that positions in connection with the Mission are filled by persons who make absolutely no claim for payment. Two missionaries are out at present (July, 1901), and they are in receipt of merely nominal salaries. That our usefulness may be commensurate with our success, and that both may be phenomenal, is, we are sure, the hope and desire of everyone who believes in the Christ-like maxim that we are all our brother's keepers."

Other notes from early numbers of the magazine may be of historical interest.

"During a visit to the 76 aborigines at Port Kembla, their need of a shepherd was forcibly borne upon us. Gambling, drinking and immorality are rife amongst them. Many are old La Perouse residents, and, while some have succumbed to this impure moral atmosphere, others have stood firm, shining as lights in the world. Several said they were in misery, which is always the product of sin. One La Perouse woman goes from hut to hut, saying, 'It is Christ you want. I was once like you, but now I am satisfied.' "

One recorded incident is of aborigines on Pelican Island, Macleay River. Only on one previous occasion had a missionary visited the place, and on her return nearly two years later she was received by the people, and one native girl in





particular, with stolid indifference, which contrasted in a striking manner with the enthusiasm and affection shown on the previous visit. The change was due to lack of recognition, but as soon as the missionary's name was mentioned, all the kindly associations of the former visit returned to the dusky maiden's mind, and her face broadened into a beautiful smile of welcome as she exclaimed, "Oh! a long time since we see'd you fellow dis way again." The people were gathered together for a Gospel meeting, and eagerly listened once again to the "Old, old story."

There was need for championing the cause of the aborigines, for in many parts of Australia abuses were still practised. From the Victorian State came authenticated information of natives being brutally treated by paid floggers. It was alleged that slavery of the worst kind existed in many parts of the north-west, and that slaves were maltreated in the most revolting and disgusting manner, some being flogged to death, and others who revolted or retaliated being deliberately shot. One writer enumerates a few instances which came under his notice, and the cruelties perpetrated upon the unfortunate aborigines were blood-curdling to read, and were a gruesome satire upon a nation which boasts of its advanced civilisation.

A leading article in the Mission's paper on "Australian Slaves," concludes in this striking fashion. "Oh, Church of Christ, awake, and with united voice demand justice for the oppressed sons of Australian soil. The experience of the coloured people in the West is but an echo of that meted out to those of other States in the earlier days. The aborigines are a declining race. In the name of our Master we appeal to all who profess enrolment under the banner of the Cross to do all they can not only

to secure freedom for the slave, but also to assist our Mission in taking the Gospel message to every camp in Australia, so that the people, now despised, may be lifted to a higher plane of civilisation, delivered from the slavery of Satan, and raised to the glorious liberty of the children of God."



## CHAPTER V.

## NORTH COAST NATIVES.

The spiritual needs of the north coast natives had been for some time a matter of deep concern to the Council of the Mission, and when, on April 9, 1931, the S.S. "Macleay" steamed out of Sydney harbour with the long-looked-for missionary on board, it was felt that a new period in the work of the Mission had begun. The writer recalls with what eager anticipation he scanned the dark coast around Trial Bay, as in the gathering gloom of the oncoming night the steamer crossed the bar into the beautiful Macleay River. Steaming slowly past Pelican Island, we saw the smouldering fires of the aborigines, and heard their voices raised in animated dialogue, or in rebuking the domestic dogs.

It was necessary to spend some weeks in making a study of local conditions and the general outlay of the surrounding country.

The Kempsey Show had attracted several hundreds of aborigines from various settlements on the northern rivers, so that we had many splendid opportunities for service amongst them.

We found in the aborigines themselves many noble and praiseworthy characteristics. They were kind-hearted and appreciative, and were eager to do what they could for the one who had come to be their missionary. They also displayed remarkable ability in various forms of athletics. Standing by a deep swimming pool in the Nulla Nulla Creek, we watched the native boys at their aquatic play. In the crystal-clear water, outlined against the pure white sand

at the bottom of the pool, we could see their black bodies gliding to and fro, sometimes gripping one another and wrestling far beneath the surface. We saw a young native athlete deliberately dive into Darkwater Creek in front of a 7ft. shark, and afterwards rip the monster from beneath with a long knife. He then climbed nimbly climbed up the bank, and solemnly bowed to his dying enemy.

The Macleay aborigines were expert at football and cricket. In the latter game they scored a complete victory over teams of white men in the district. The costly silver trophy, offered by Mr. P. M. Hart, a Kempsey storekeeper, was keenly coveted, and many prominent teams competed, the conditions being that the game was to be won three times by the same team before the cup could be claimed. After a strenuous struggle, in which strong feeling was shown by some of the whites, who were jealous of the team they called "the darkies," the silver cup, beautifully engraved, and 21 inches in height, was won by the "True Australian Eleven" —the aborigines' team. The writer has seen this cup many times in one of the native homes, and they are rightly proud of it as a trophy of their skill in the realm of sport.

After a preliminary survey, we made an effort to gather the northern natives into a number of large settlements, and a mission station was established at Burnt Bridge, four miles from Kempsey. This became the headquarters of a "far-flung" parish, extending from the Manning to the Bellinger, and later on to the Tweed, and embracing all the territory between the Pacific Coast and the New England Mountains.

The chief centres of native population, apart from Burnt Bridge, were Pelican Island, Fatorina Island, and Kinchela on the lower Macleay; Bellbrook, on the Nulla Nulla Creek, 34 miles from Kempsey; Rollands Plains, on the Wilson River; and





Wauchope, on the Hastings. On the Manning River the main centre was at Purfleet, near Taree, and 22 miles further on a station was formed at Forster. Travelling northward, we found large camps at Bellinger Heads, Bellingen, and Bowral, and, as soon as the way opened, many groups were visited on the Clarence, Richmond, and Tweed Rivers.

The New South Wales Aborigines' Mission had at this time extended its influence throughout the coastal area of the State, from Nowra in the south to the Queensland border in the north.

Some valuable initial visitation had been made to several Macleay and Manning centres, but now the responsibility of organising and continuing the work fell upon the Missionary who had been called from Angas College to tackle this tremendous task.

A local committee of white citizens was formed in the town of Kempsey, and the valuable assistance rendered by this band of sterling men and women can never be forgotten. The first chairman was Rev. J. Taylor—wise, cautious and generous. When in committee we were considering a venture of faith in building a mission church at Burnt Bridge, he crystallised the discussion by saying, "Well, gentlemen, I have faith to the extent of a sovereign, and there it is" (placing the coin on the table). "How much faith have you got?" Others responded immediately, and before many months the church was being built. We must also mention the first vice-chairman of the Kempsey Committee, Rev. William Pearson, the minister referred to by Rev. Lionel Fletcher in his book, "Mighty Moments." Knowing Mr. Pearson as we did so intimately in those days 30 years ago, we can understand how he exerted such a powerful influence on the life of the young man who has now become the "Empire Evangelist" of the great campaign to win the young for Christ. Amongst other prominent members were Rev. L. Hurd, Mr. John Bryson, and Mr. J. Grant.

We soon found that effective work in this scattered district could not be done without the assistance of local helpers, who would undertake to visit the people in a voluntary capacity, conducting services and Sunday schools while the missionary was in another part of the circuit. Several valuable workers were soon set apart for this service. Mr. Alf. Cox, a member of the Primitive Methodist Church, undertook to visit several nearby camps, and, riding his sturdy pony, sometimes went as far as the Wilson River. Miss J. Gilmore was appointed to the charge of the Sunday School at Burnt Bridge, and for several years was able to render splendid service to both young and old at the Mission Station. During part of this time she was ably assisted by Miss Amy Lee. We prayed earnestly for a worker to be provided for the big settlement of coloured folk at Rollands Plains, 20 miles from Port Macquarie, where a cosy little church had been erected. The answer came with the offer of a consecrated young woman in the person of Miss Edie Johnston (now Mrs. A. W. Setchell). Miss Johnson, by her life and teaching, did much to win the dark people at "The Plains" from the evil habits of gambling and drinking. Many of them accepted Christ, and lived consistent lives, to the amazement of the white residents, who hitherto had despised them as outcasts. At Purfleet, on the Manning River, the Lord raised up a brave and devoted little worker in the person of Miss Mary Delves, who, after several years of active work amongst the aborigines, became an officer in the Salvation Army. Miss Delves laid the foundation of a deep spiritual life in the minds of many of the dark people at Purfleet, and also paid frequent visits to the settlement at Forster.

Thus throughout the whole district the truth of the Christian faith was faithfully taught and lived amongst the native people, and many were the evi-





dences of lives completely transformed by the uplifting power of the Gospel of Christ.

Memory floods the mind as we recall the events of those days. We think of Billy Williams, a native of unusual intelligence, but a man who, before his conversion, was the embodiment of every form of evil. He was deeply convicted of sin, but his strong will struggled against surrender. He stumbled on in the darkness, and sometimes seemed like one devil-possessed; till one day the transformation came, and he became subdued, gentle, and radiant. One Sunday morning in the Christian Endeavour meeting at Burnt Bridge, the missionary said, "Billy, tell us how the great change came to you." In the course of his testimony he said something like this: "I was wandering on in the devil's way, and it was all dark; but Jesus was tugging at my heart. It was like trying to find my way through a thick scrub, so thick that I could not see the sky or the sun. And then, when Jesus got right into my heart, it was like when you come to a clearing, and when you pull the bushes aside you see the light breaking through." And, indeed, the "Light of the World" did break into Billy's benighted heart, changing his gloom into gladness.

Granny Donohoe, seer of visions, and dreamer of dreams, was an outstanding personality amongst the native women. She lived with her "Ole Man" in a cozy hut on the hill beyond the wooded valley through which Burnt Bridge Creek flowed to its junction with the broad Macleay. She told the missionary strange stories of things that had been revealed to her about one she affectionately called "Our Father." She was lying awake listening to the noises of the night—the chuckle of the opossum, the clear cry of the curlew, the rustle of leaves by the kangaroo rat, the dismal dirge of the "mo-poke," the thump, thump, of the wallaby, and the weird wail of the distant dingo. The "Ole Man" was sleep-

ing soundly and snoring sonorously when suddenly the hut was filled with light, and at the same moment the snoring ceased. Granny sat up in bed, and saw that this soft, white light did not come from the smoky hurricane lamp that hung from the rafter, but from the face of a beautiful person in white who stood in the room. "I wasn't frightened," said Granny, "because I knowed it was 'Our Father.' He looked kind at me, and said: 'My daughter,' and I say. 'What you want me for, Father?' Then he say to me: 'My daughter, I want you to tell your ole man about Me, and tell your children and grandchildren the big Father loves them.' Then He just smile at me, and I not see Him any more, but I feel very happy. The ole man, he snore like thunder, but I not care; I sleep beautiful." Granny became a sincere believer in Christ, with a capacity far above the ordinary for understanding the "mysteries of the kingdom."

Did space permit, we could describe many other prominent persons amongst the native and half-caste people of the northern rivers. We think of Stewart Bullock, the runner; Tom Field, the axeman; and his brother, Bob, the carpenter. Jimmy Linwood, the farmer, took first prize in the Kempsey show with his maize; and George Davis, the bush lawyer, was said to have the ability to argue the leg off a cast-iron camp oven.

Bert Marr has been a faithful Christian for more than thirty years, and as a native helper has done yeoman service, chiefly on the Manning River, where he is greatly respected by white and dark people alike.

These, and scores of others, gathered together in the various centres for regular instruction in the truth of the Word of God, and some of them became consistent followers of Christ.

The building of a church for the aborigines at





Burnt Bridge created much interest throughout the whole district. Some of the native men guided the missionary into the bush to a monster gum tree they had selected. The missionary and the native axeman felled this forest giant, and from its straight-grained trunk were split slabs for the House of God. The coloured folk worked hard in preparing and carting the material, but most of the actual building was done by the missionary.

The Kempsey Committee provided iron for the roof, and many other requisites to complete and beautify the building. The Euroka Methodist Church presented a cedar railing for the pulpit, and other friends donated an organ.

The Burnt Bridge church was opened free of debt on May 27, 1903, and it was indeed a day of joy and praise. There were 112 aborigines, and 150 white people present, and as these could not be crowded into a building 22 feet by 16 feet, the building was opened by having a meeting outside. The chairman at that memorable gathering was the Rev. William Pearson, and addresses were given by missionaries and visiting ministers. The Macleay missionary was presented with two valuable books (Biblical biographies by F. B. Meyer) as an expression of the love of the native people.

The opening of this place of worship marked a definite advance in the work on the northern rivers. Many of the dark people had been converted, and were received into fellowship. A Christian Endeavour society was formed, and the meetings were full of spiritual power and fervour. Every Sunday evening an evangelistic service was held, and many more from amongst the native people accepted Christ. When it was necessary for the missionary to visit other centres, the meetings were taken by some of the workers mentioned above, assisted by Mr. A. Rudder, and later on by Mr. Vic. Rudder.

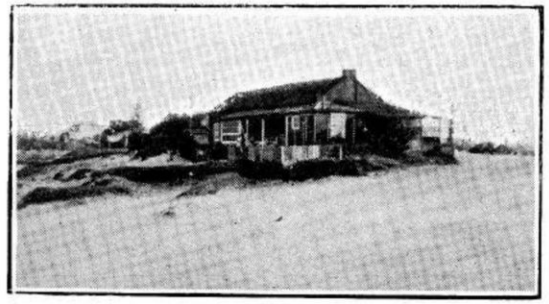
No record of the beginnings of the work on the

Macleay River would be complete without mentioning Miss McGregor and her aged father. Their home in West Kempsey was always open to receive stray missionaries who were in need of a good square meal or a bed. Miss McGregor afterwards herself became a missionary to the natives at Forster, where she was loved and respected by all; and she is now a devoted member of the New South Wales Council of the Mission.

The aborigines themselves took a keen interest in the work, and in their own church. Early every Saturday morning some of the women would scrub the floor and seats, and others would come from the bush with loads of wild flowers, and hours would be spent in decorating the interior of the church. It was never overdone, for the native people are gifted with a refinement of taste in such matters. They revel in the beauties of the bush, and are ever at home amongst the flowers and the trees and the hills. How different is the lot of the coastal tribes from that of the puny and ill-nourished natives of the arid interior of Australia. At Burnt Bridge, a mission house of two small rooms was attached to the church, and a local wag used to speak of the Macleay missionary as the man "whose house joined hard to the synagogue."

During the month of June, 1903, two other new mission halls were opened on the northern rivers—at Wauchope, on the Hastings; and at Purfleet, on the Manning. At the former place, Mrs. Wallace had been working amongst the dark folk for more than two years, assisted by her husband and her daughter. Frequent visits were also paid by the missionary from Burnt Bridge. Miss Ollie Wallace was instrumental in forming a healthy Junior Christian Endeavour Society amongst the native children, and her loving, sympathetic nature endeared her to these little ones, and some of them soon learned to

Miss BAKER,
One of the early members of the La Perouse Committee, and for many years missionary and N.S.W. secretary.



The Mission House, surrounded by sand.

# The New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate.

ISSUED UNDER THE AUSPICES OF THE N.S.W. ABORIGINES' MISSION

A Monthly Record of Missionary Work amongst the Aborigines.

No. 1 — Registered as a Newspaper for Transmission by Post — JULY 23, 1901. — One Shilling per Annum.

## New South Wales Aborigines' Mission.

### Its Aims and Objects.

The New South Wales Aborigines' Mission has for its supreme object the carrying of the Gospel of the Lord Jesus Christ to the Aborigines scattered throughout New South Wales. Believing, as we do, that Christ died for all men, we believe that He died for the Australian Aboriginal. But "how shall they believe in Him of Whom they have not heard? And how shall they hear without a preacher? And how shall they preach except they be sent?" (Rom. x. 14-15).

We do not wish to discuss here why the Churches have been so zealous in sending Missionaries to the native races of the South Sea Islands, India, China, etc., and yet have neglected the natives of their own country, but merely to state how this Mission came to take up its work. It commenced in a very humble way by visiting a camp of Aborigines at La Perouse, on the shores of Botany Bay. Under God's guidance it grew and prospered, and soon spread to other parts of the State. The Committee felt bound to follow it up, and in enlarging its sphere changed its name to that of "The New South Wales Aborigines Mission."

Of course we have had to adopt "methods of working" in carrying out our object. God works through human agencies, and consecrated hearts and heads and hands have to be employed in the accomplishment of His Divine purpose. But whether the work has been that of directly ministering to the people, or of organising the many ramifications of the Mission, the one aim (the evangelisation of these perishing people) is ever kept in view.

There is no denying the fact that the Aboriginal has learnt many of the vices of the white man; these added to their half-civilised mode of living leaves much to be desired. Filled with love for their neglected brethren, the Mission is working for their salvation from the chains of sin and darkness, and for their uplifting, by the power of God, to better and brighter lives. Where Christianity has been taught and practised the people have been ready and even eager to receive it. Many of them have accepted it, and their lives had been transformed by its operations. But it is a sad fact that many of the Aborigines living in New South Wales have not heard of Christ as their Saviour. The aim of this Mission is to send the Gospel Message to every one of them. But more help is needed,—more workers, more money. We pray that God will continue to lead us on until our whole object will have been accomplished,—when every Aboriginal in the State will enjoy the privilege of having the Gospel of Christ regularly preached to them.

### In Brief.

About ten years ago a picnic-party of Christian Endeavourers visited the Aboriginals' Camp at La Perouse, Botany Bay. That visit was the foundation of what is now known as the New South Wales Aborigines' Mission.

Systematic visitation to the Camp was conducted by a faithful band of workers until 1897, when Miss Retta Dixon was stationed there as a resident Missionary.

The religion of Jesus Christ transformed the lives of many of these blacks, who in turn carried the Gospel to their "fellow-countrymen" in other parts of the Colony.

The work prospered, and the little "La Perouse Committee" was led to enlarge the sphere of its operations and to change its name to "New South Wales" instead of "La Perouse."

Churches have been erected at La Perouse, Illawarra Lake, Plumpton and Sackville Reach. In addition to these places Mission Stations have been established on the Manning, Hastings, Wilson and Macleay Rivers, and at Wallaga Lake.

A Missionary has recently been sent to the Macleay River. Mr. E. J. Telfer, of Angas College, Adelaide, is the chosen person, and is working amongst the Aborigines of this and the Wilson Rivers. Pray for him.

As an instance of the eagerness of the Aboriginal to hear the Word of God let us quote from a letter recently received from Mr. H. E. Hookey, of Wallaga Lake. He says,—"We need a proper meeting house, 160 are willing to attend our meetings but we can only find room for 60; the remaining hundred must either stand shivering in the cold or go home disappointed. The meetings have to be held in the evenings, but the people will not wait until they have had tea, but throng the door in crowds as soon as it is dark."

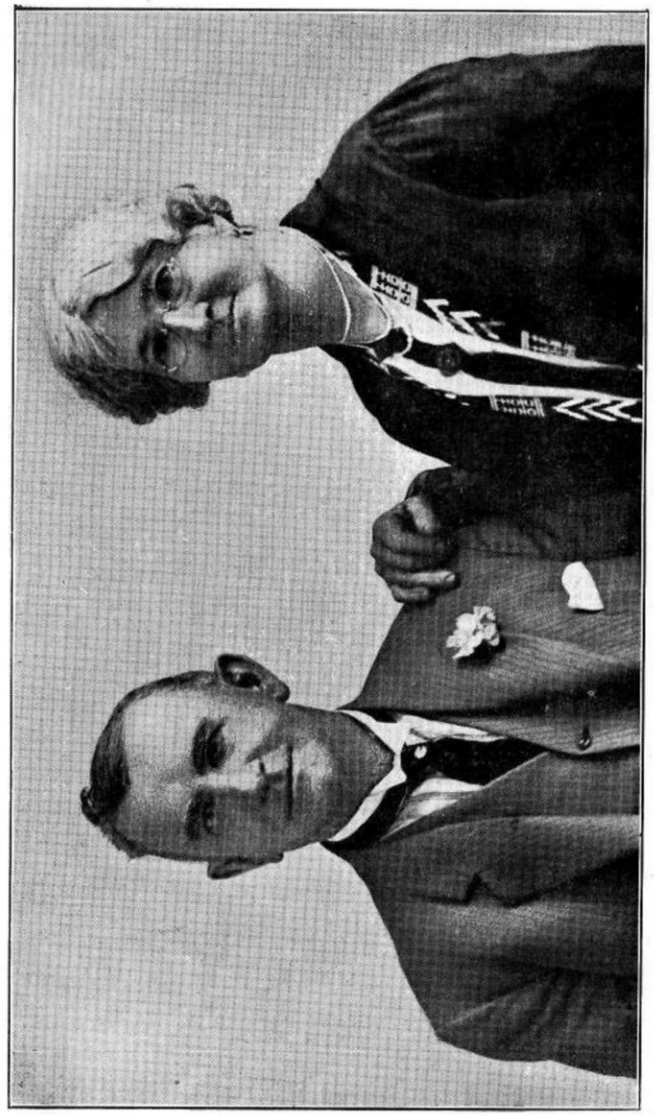
Mr. Telfer reports that about 60 per cent. of the entire black population of the Macleay and Wilson Rivers are regularly attending the services. This is a result of only three months' work amongst them.

The numbers of Aborigines in the Australian States are as follows:—Western Australia, 100,000 (estimated); Queensland, 75,000; South Australia, 24,000; New South Wales, 6000; Victoria, 443; Tasmania, extinct.

Several Aborigine girls and boys would be prepared to accept situations in Christian homes. Particulars will be cheerfully supplied by Miss Dixon, Missionary, Petersham, or the Secretary.

Reduced photographic reproduction of front page of first issue of the "New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate," published in July, 1901.





Mr. and Mrs. T. E. Colebrook.

# The New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate.

Issued under the Auspices of the N.S.W. Aborigines' Mission

A Monthly Record of Missionary Work amongst the Aborigines.

No. 1 — Registered as a Newspaper for Transmission by Post — July 23, 1901. — One Shilling per Annum.


## New South Wales Aborigines' Mission.

### Its Aims and Objects.

The New South Wales Aborigines' Mission has for its supreme object the carrying of the Gospel of the Lord Jesus Christ to the Aborigines scattered throughout New South Wales believing, as we do, that Christ died for all men, we believe that He died for the Australian Aboriginal. But "how shall they believe in Him of Whom they have not heard? And how shall they hear without a preacher? And how shall they preach except they be sent?" (Rom. x 14-15)

We do not wish to discuss here why the Churches have been so zealous in sending Missionaries to the native races of the South Sea Islands, India, China, etc., and yet have neglected the natives of their own country, but merely to state how this Mission came to take up its work. It commenced in a very humble way by visiting a camp of Aborigines at La Perouse, on the shores of Botany Bay. Under God's guidance it grew and prospered, and soon spread to other parts of the State. The Committee felt bound to follow it up, and in enlarging its sphere changed its name to that of "The New South Wales Aborigines Mission."

Of course we have had to adopt "methods of working" in carrying out our object. God works through human agencies, and consecrated hearts and heads and hands have to be employed in the accomplishment of His Divine purpose. But whether the work has been that of directly ministering to the people, or of organising the many ramifications of the Mission, the one aim (the evangelisation of these perishing people) is ever kept in view.

There is no denying the fact that the Aboriginal has learnt many of the vices of the white man; these added to their half-civilised mode of living leaves much to be desired. Filled with love for their neglected brethren, the Mission is working for their salvation from the chains of sin and darkness, and for their uplifting, by the power of God, to better and brighter lives. Where Christianity has been taught and practised the people have been ready and even eager to receive it. Many of them have accepted it, and their lives had been transformed by its operations. But it is a sad fact that many of the Aborigines living in New South Wales have not heard of Christ as their Saviour. The aim of this Mission is to send the Gospel Message to every one of them. But more help is needed,—more workers, more money. We pray that God will continue to lead us on until our *whole* object will have been accomplished,—when every Aboriginal in the State will enjoy the privilege of having the Gospel of Christ regularly preached to them.

## In Brief.

About ten years ago a picnic-party of Christian Endeavourers visited the Aboriginals' Camp at La Perouse, Botany Bay. That visit was the foundation of what is now known as the New South Wales Aborigines' Mission.

Systematic visitation to the Camp was conducted by a faithful band of workers until 1897, when Miss Retta Dixon was stationed there as a resident Missionary.

The religion of Jesus Christ transformed the lives of many of these blacks, who in turn carried the Gospel to their "fellow-countrymen" in other parts of the Colony.

The work prospered, and the little "La Perouse Committee" was led to enlarge the sphere of its operations and to change its name to "New South Wales" instead of "La Perouse."

Churches have been erected at La Perouse, Illawarra Lake, Plumpton and Sackville Reach. In addition to these places Mission Stations have been established on the Manning, Hastings, Wilson and Macleay Rivers, and at Wallaga Lake.

A Missionary has recently been sent to the Macleay River, Mr. E. J. Telfer, of Angas College, Adelaide, is the chosen person, and is working amongst the Aborigines of this and the Wilson Rivers. Pray for him.

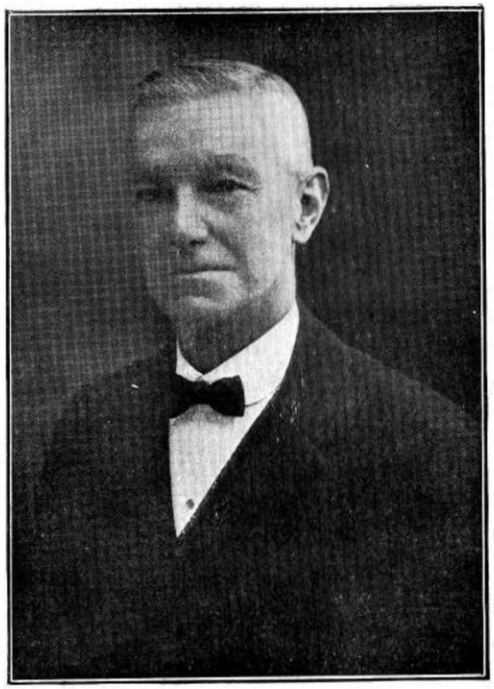
As an instance of the eagerness of the Aboriginal to hear the Word of God let us quote from a letter recently received from Mr. H. E. Hockey, of Wallaga Lake. He says,—"We need a proper meeting house, 160 are willing to attend our meetings but we can only find room for 60; the remaining hundred must either stand shivering in the cold or go home disappointed. The meetings have to be held in the evenings, but the people will not wait until they have had tea, but throng the door in crowds as soon as it is dark."

Mr. Telfer reports that about 60 per cent of the entire black population of the Macleay and Wilson Rivers are regularly attending the services. This is a result of only three months' work amongst them.

The numbers of Aborigines in the Australian States are as follows:—Western Australia, 100,000 (estimated); Queensland, 75,000; South Australia, 24,000; New South Wales, 6900; Victoria, 441; Tasmania, extinct.

Several Aborigine girls and boys would be prepared to accept situations in Christian homes. Particulars will be cheerfully supplied by Miss Dixon, Missionary, Petersham, or the Secretary.

Reduced photographic reproduction of front page of first issue of the "New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate," published in July, 1901.



Mr. G. E. Ardill, mentioned in these articles as Secretary of the Aborigines' Protection Association. Still actively engaged in Christian work.





love and trust the Saviour. Eternity alone will reveal the outcome of these years of loving labour by the loyal workers at Wauchope.

The Purfleet mission hall, to be used as both church and school, was opened on June 24. Miss Mary Delves had toiled with tireless enthusiasm to hasten the completion of the building, and her efforts were warmly supported by Mr. H. H. Kirton, the Taree photographer. The missionary from the Macleay River was privileged to give the first address in the new building.

The District Inspector of Schools, Mr. W. T. Reay, represented the Government Department of Public Instruction, and spoke words of hearty appreciation of the Mission's work. At this time a number of public meetings and lantern lectures were held throughout the Manning River district, large and enthusiastic audiences gathering to hear of the work amongst the aborigines.

Miss Johnston continued her faithful and successful work at Rollands Plains, and to this day her name is loved and revered by those amongst whom she laboured.

At a later date a Mission was started at Bellinger Heads, and services were held for some time at Nambucca Heads. At the latter place, the missionary came in contact with one of the old-time religious leaders of the North Coast aborigines, and from him learned much of their ancient lore. Frank Waddy was the wise old man of his tribe, and in his youth was no mean artist in rock painting and tree carving. In later life he journeyed from place to place copying these drawings into a book, parts of which he afterwards presented to the writer of these articles. Some of these have been photographed for use as lantern slides, as they reveal and explain a phase of the aboriginal mind that, in our judgment, is altogether unique. One remarkable drawing depicts vividly the aboriginal belief in a disastrous

flood that drowned the whole creation except "two blackfellow man, and two blackfellow woman, and one fellow bandicoot."

Another crude painting is of the Great Spirit, called in the "Djangattie" dialect "Wirroombraul." No devotee of any religious faith could be more reverent and respectful than was Frank Waddy at the mention of this awe-inspiring name. Many long heart to heart talks we had with this native theologian. He took us one day to a lonely spot on the North Coast, and showed us a strange excavation in the earth where he declared Wirroombraul buried His only Son. "And is He down there now?" we enquired, and Frank replied: "Oh, no, boss, Him jump up big, strong fellow—never Him die any more." That night we told the old man the inspired story of the death and resurrection of our Lord, and as he listened, the big tears rolled down his face and hissed amongst the embers of the tiny camp fire over which we sat. For many a day afterwards, Frank gathered little groups of his countrymen together and repeated faithfully the messages he had received from the missionary.

Thus the work continued to spread until, in most of the main centres along the North Coast, the native people had heard the grand old story of Redeeming Love.



## CHAPTER VI.

## CHALLENGING THE ALMIGHTY.

The nomadic instinct of the natives proved to be of great value in the rapid extension of the work. Visitors to centres where missionaries had been stationed moved to other localities, and soon from near and far came the "Macedonian cry." Other missionary candidates were offering themselves for the work, and these were deemed to be in every way suitable, but the Committee could not, under existing conditions, accept the responsibility. Two missionaries were in the field, and in sending them out, the Committee had guaranteed a certain amount of support; and although the salary promised was merely nominal, and appeals for funds were constantly being made through the churches and by individual collectors, the amount required was not forthcoming; and the debit balance continued to grow month by month, to the embarrassment of the treasurer, and the consternation of the whole Committee. To accept another worker under these conditions was unthinkable, and yet from the aborigines in many distant camps came the urgent cry: "Send us a missionary." What could be done? The members of the Committee did the only thing possible—they fled to the place of prayer, and cast their care upon God. The minutes of that period tell of many special meetings for prayer, and waiting upon God; and in that prayer atmosphere was born a "new idea," that proved to be God's way to a bigger and a better work.

Many members of the Committee became

deeply and independently convinced that there should be a radical change in the policy of the Mission, in regard to the method of obtaining the funds needed to carry on the work. In other words, it was felt that the Mission should launch out in entire dependence upon God, and that, in future, the work should be conducted on the principle known as "Faith Lines."

The matter was definitely brought before the Mission in a letter from Mr Jay, a member of the Central Committee; and almost simultaneously came messages from the two missionaries in the field, urging the adoption of the faith principle, and offering to forego the accumulated arrears of salary. This occurred in July, 1902, but in order to avoid a hasty decision, the matter was deferred for three months, during which time the members of the Committee studied carefully all available literature on the subject, and waited constantly upon God for guidance. The record of what God had wrought through George Muller, Hudson Taylor, Lockhart Morton, and other men who dared to believe God, brought inspiration and encouragement.

It was felt with increasing force that the work was at a standstill, as suitable workers were being turned away because the Committee could not secure funds to send them forth; but spiritual vision had been clarified, and faith had been strengthened by persistent waiting upon God; and on the 9th of October, 1902, it was decided to send out the missionaries, and to CHALLENGE THE ALMIGHTY to supply their needs. The resolution was moved by Mr. T. E. Colebrook, and seconded by Mr. W. E. Cormack. Thus the Mission launched out into the deep in absolute dependence upon God, and after thirty years' experience we can declare that, although there have been times of severe testing, "there hath not failed one word of all His good promise."





The new Constitution of the Mission contained the following:—

> The needs of the Mission shall be laid before God in prayer, no personal solicitations or collections being authorised. No more money is to be expended than is thus received, going into debt being considered inconsistent with the principle of entire dependence upon God. The Committee, therefore, cannot promise or guarantee any fixed amount of support to the missionaries. The Committee shall seek faithfully to distribute the funds available to meet the need of each missionary, but he (or she) is expected to recognise that his (or her) dependence for the supply of all need is on God, Who has called him (or her) to labour, and not on any human organisation.

Then began a new period of aggressive work. The Lord honoured the faith of His servants. Old debts were wiped out. New workers offered and were accepted, and God supplied their needs. An election of officers was held on 11th December, 1902, when Mr. Colebrook became President of the Mission, and Miss Baker was chosen as Secretary, which position she has held for (at the time of writing) nearly thirty years. Early in 1903 several new workers were received. Miss Duggan was accepted and appointed to assist at La Perouse. Miss Mabel Timbury, of Newcastle, was also sent to La Perouse for her probationary period, and afterwards did good service at Roseby Park. Miss Maud Oldrey, a Christian worker of some experience, and a member of the Committee, was accepted in September of the same year, and was appointed to Sackville Reach, where she carried on a very successful work. During the same month, Miss Annie Lock was accepted as a worker on probation. Next came Miss Florrie Pain, another Newcastle recruit, who rendered splendid service at Greenwell Point on the South Coast.

The esteemed Secretary of the Mission, Miss Baker, then offered herself as a missionary, and it was resolved that she be appointed resident missionary at La Perouse, with the understanding that she continue her secretarial duties. Mr. L. Railton, an elderly local preacher from Goulburn, was the next candidate, and, although his age caused the Committee to hesitate, his qualifications and Christian experience outweighed any objections, and for a number of years he served the Mission faithfully. On 23rd May, 1905, Mr. Donald Caldwell, a student from Mr. Henry Martin's Training Home, was accepted. He proved to be a loyal and lovable brother, whose interest in the aborigines has never flagged. Mr. Railton has long since been called to his Eternal Reward; and Mr. Caldwell, or, as we lovingly call him, "Donald," holds a position of trust with the Aborigines Protection Board at Quirindi. In July, 1905, Miss Ethel Black was accepted, and a little later was stationed as missionary at Greenwell Point. Some years later, Miss Black and Mr. Caldwell were united in marriage, and at the Government Station mentioned above they continued their sacrificial service. [While this was passing through the press they both within two or three weeks have gone to their reward.] Miss Emily Buttsworth then entered the work, and, after a term at Sackville Reach, was placed in charge of a station at Bellinger Heads. Still more workers were coming forward, and toward the end of 1905 Miss Elsie Jelbart entered the field. At a later date this respected worker was appointed to the responsible charge of Burnt Bridge, on the Macleay River. After a long period of faithful service, Miss Jelbart was married to Mr. Vic. Rudder, of East Kempsey. Both these friends continued their interest in the work amongst the aborigines. Thus it will be seen that God abundantly honoured the faith of the members of the Committee, who in





their hour of extremity cast themselves without reserve upon Him. The Almighty accepted the challenge. "They who trust Him wholly find Him wholly true."

## CHAPTER VII.

## PIONEERING WORK.

In April, 1906, the writer was definitely set apart by the Council of the Mission to do pioneering work throughout the State. This work was of a two-fold character: Searching out the scattered camps of native people, in order to tell them the story of Christ, and where possible arrange for the establishment of a Mission Station; and also to enlist the sympathy of the white residents, and particularly to encourage Christian people associated with the various churches to do something definite for the salvation of the aborigines.

The following descriptive account was written as we journeyed from place to place, and was published in the "Advocate" from time to time, under the title of

"Through Cities and Villages Teaching and Journeying On."

After completing arrangements for the settlement of the succeeding missionary at Burnt Bridge, and having seen Brother Caldwell off to his lonely but hopeful toil at Bellbrook, we journey northward. Lantern talks are given at Kinchlea and Unkya en route. At the latter place there are upwards of thirty coloured people who need spiritual help. Our impression is that were a missionary stationed at Pelican Island (Lower Macleay), this place could in conjunction with others be worked as an out-station. There is urgent need for this partially worked territory to be occupied in the near future.





Now onward to the little town of Macksville, on the Nambucca River, where we engage the public hall for a missionary meeting early in the following week. Eight miles further and Bowraville is reached. Here we are welcomed by former friends —Mr. and Mrs. Notley, at whose residence we make our headquarters whilst working the district. The dark people, living just on the outskirts of the town, impress us as shepherdless sheep in the most pathetic sense of the term. Many of them were away working for neighbouring farmers, so that the number attending the meetings was necessarily small. But those present listen eagerly to the Gospel story. We feel that we would fain continue with them, but remember Christ's words: "I must preach in other cities also, for therefore am I sent."

On Sunday afternoon we are accompanied to the camp by a number of Christian workers and children from the Sunday School, who help us with the singing. One fact that comes under our notice, and which we think speaks volumes for the residents of Bowra, is that the dark children are welcomed as scholars in the public school. (Others schools please copy). We find a warm and sympathetic friend in the Rev. C. McAlpine, Presbyterian minister, who, taking a keen and practical interest in the cause, assisted us by manipulating the lantern both at Bowra and Macksville, afterwards expressing willingness to help in any way within his power.

Farewelling native people and friends, we proceed to Nambucca Heads, where a lecture on the work is given in the Presbyterian Church. Here we also find friends, who extend hospitality. The coloured people have an island reserve near the Heads, which appears to be the headquarters of the district. There is another settlement four miles toward the Bellinger River, at Deep Creek, and scattered ones along the road between the Nambucca

Heads and Bowraville. Everywhere the people are without spiritual succour, and plead for aid.

"What will you do for the aborigines on the Bellinger and Nambucca?" "Will you establish a Mission?" With these and similar queries we are repeatedly plied as we journey up and down the rivers, and invariably we answer dubiously, as did the Jews to the questioning of our Lord, "We cannot tell"; but adding that, "By the grace of God, what we can do to help and uplift them, that we will do."

Great is the need for timely, definite action. Though apparently insurmountable obstacles confront, God "commands," and will therefore "enable."

On the Nambucca, our dark people number 86 in all, and resort to four localities, viz., Bellwood Island, Taylor's Arm, Deep Creek, and Bowraville. Excepting the latter, at each place they occupy Government reserves, which are utilised for cultivation or grazing. Bellwood Island, containing about 100 acres of land, adapted for the growth of grass, vegetables, fruit, and perhaps corn, would obviously be the most suitable locality in which to promote centralisation.

Passing on to the Bellinger, 16 miles further north, we find a similar number of coloured folk, equally widely dispersed, though, as on the sister river, the principal colony is near the ocean. Here is another island reservation, partially covered with waving corn crops—a tribute to the industry of the original occupiers of the soil. This low-lying territory is not, however, suitable for habitation, and the actual settlement is on the mainland, at the back of the little town of Bellinger Heads. One coloured man has built himself a comfortable house near the public school, where his children attend and excel. This man is recognised to be a worthy citizen and a faithful workman. We hire the local hall for a lantern talk, but "the rain descended," so that at





meeting-time the place is surrounded by several inches of water. A few white folk face the elements, including the local police officer, by whose assistance we are greatly helped. The dark people are not to be baffled by rain or storm, and soon after nightfall upwards of 30 are waiting admission, which is straightway granted. During the evening five of the coloured girls sing sweet selections in a very pleasing manner. After the meeting, these folk return home, momentarily gratified, but inwardly eager for Gospel light.

Here is a field for labour, without a labourer; useful material, without a workman; sheep without a shepherd; immortal human souls, without a human friend; yearning for spiritual light, without a spiritual guide to say, "Behold the Lamb of God which taketh away the sin of the world." "Won't you stay and teach us?" "No, I cannot!" "When are you coming again?" As soon as I can, but that may be a long time, for there are many others who have not been visited once." "Why don't you send a missionary?" "We haven't a missionary to send!" "Why don't some church people come?" What can we reply to such a question? Let whom it may concern answer.

We next proceed to Bellingen, 10 miles upstream, where the Rev. W. H. Jones "showed us no little kindness." With the Sunday come opportunities for preaching the Word in local churches, and on the two week-nights following lectures are given at Bellingen and Fermount respectively, the former being of an encouragingly enthusiastic character. Another illustrated talk is planned, and duly eventuates at Raleigh, where we again discover hospitable friends. We journey on, still northward bound. Again it is Sunday, and three preaching appointments are fulfilled, the evening services being in the thriving little village of Coffs Harbour, at which place a lantern talk is given on the Monday night.

Tuesday finds us with a like gathering in the homely country district of Karangi, on the Orara River, where friendly farmers rally round. Being unsuccessful in securing an audience at Nana Glen, we hasten towards the Clarence, but not unhindered, for the motor cycle (which is a good servant, but a bad master) begins to show sure symptoms of a complaint we might call "relaxation of electrical energy.". After pushing and pedalling some eight miles, an appliance obtained from a friendly passing motorist meets the need, and in a few hours we reach the city of Grafton.

We are glad to be able to visit the Grafton Aborigines' Home, controlled by the Government Board, and situated several miles from the town. Here about 60 aborigines are living, the settlement consisting of about 13 homes, besides the residences of the manager and the school teacher. A visit to the school, attended by both coloured and white children, shows us that faithful teaching and apt learning go hand in hand. The dark children read fluently, and when catechised spell correctly such words as yacht, fuchsia, chrysanthemum, etc. Their writing also is excellent. On the farm there are 300 acres of land. Part is used for cultivation, and the balance for grazing about 75 cattle. The home appears to be in a satisfactory condition under the management of Mr. Warrington.

It is a pleasure to explain our lantern pictures in the little school house, and we believe all who attended were also pleased. We cannot speak too highly of the kindness and courtesy shown us by Mr. and Mrs. Warrington.

There are many remote camps of our people along the Clarence, and so far as we are yet able to ascertain, though in a Christian land, environed by Christian communities, they have not had extended to them the hand of Christian brotherhood.

A journey of 28 miles from Grafton brings us





to Copmanhurst, where we enquire as to the whereabouts of the aborigines, and discover that the majority have temporarily sought "fresh fields and pastures new" at Yugalbar, or still higher up among the mountains.

Realising the improbability of finding the scattered sheep in any one place, we devote a little time to those remaining at the almost deserted camp near at hand, where upwards of 50 sometimes congregate. After giving a lantern talk in a private hall, we proceed, via Grafton, to the Lower Clarence, and from the convenient centre of Lawrence work the district. A large native settlement is discovered midway between South Grafton and Ulmarra, and here the entire population, numbering 58, eagerly gathered on Sunday afternoon, and for 35 minutes listened to the Gospel story with unflagging attention. Returning a week later, we find the number increased to 65, and again they drink in the simple truth, that "CHRIST RECEIVETH SINFUL MEN." While farewells are being said, four of the native people arrive from the Macleay, and promise to procure Testaments and Hymn Books, and teach their countrymen what they themselves know of the Word of God. Other groups of coloured folk are to be found at Lower Southgate and Lawrence. At the latter place the Christian Endeavourers of the Presbyterian and Baptist churches are shouldering their responsibility, and we have been much encouraged by the receipt of a letter, from which the following is an extract: "We feel the need for such work being done amongst our coloured people, and you, by your arrival here, have made our desire to work amongst them become a settled purpose. Nearly a year ago we tried, but somehow failed. It may have been because we were not humble enough, or because we had not faith enough in God. Yesterday we commenced in real earnest. As you say, the

people are hungering to hear about God. We love them already, and are so thankful to be able to tell them of Him."

Christian workers and Endeavourers who read these lines, and who have companies of the despised within your reach, will you, also, go in the spirit of the compassionate Christ, who supplemented His injunction, "Pray ye, therefore," with the command, "Go your way, behold I send you"?

The workers who have taken the leadership of the work at Lawrence are Miss L. Jaggers and Miss M. Drummond.

Still lower down the Clarence, below the town of Maclean, and surrounded by a broad expanse of water, is Ulgandahi Island, another aboriginal colony. Here we observe unmistakable signs of industry, and of a desire for self settlement. The greater portion of the territory occupied is a field of waving sugar cane, while the little huts on the higher extremity of the island are hidden from view by numerous clumps of banana trees. The permanent residents would not number more than 60, though many others could probably be induced to resort thither. This would be an ideal spot for a centre of missionary enterprise, and God only knows how great is their need. We reach the island, accompanied by Rev. Scott Neil and other friends (our means of transport being the police boat, kindly placed at our disposal by Inspector Johnston), and as we enter the settlement what a scene meets our gaze—a scene most pathetic, and deepening in pathos with closer inspection. A few small huts, and several rude camps, from the shelter of which appear men, women and children. One of the men is a cripple, both legs being withered and useless. Yet he is smart and intelligent, and, in moving about, walks on his hands in a most peculiar fashion. In one of the nearest of the dwellings lies an aged woman, blind and deaf, and ill, constantly watched





by her son and daughter, all of them (not living, but existing) in poverty, dirt, and despair.

One of the men we had known elsewhere calls us to come and pray for his wife, who is ill. We find her lying on the ground beneath a sheet of iron, with a new-born child beside her, and another tiny girl clinging to her clothes. After doing what we can to increase their comfort, and holding a short meeting, we leave them until Sunday morning, when another visit is paid, and a service of Gospel song and story is held.

Lantern talks to the Christian public are given at Lawrence, Ulmarra, Brushgrove, and Maclean, as well as missionary addresses where opportunity offers. We cannot but mention the personal kindness of Revs. E. G. Hockey and Scott Neil, and other friends who are "given to hospitality."

A hilly, dusty ride of 50 miles brings us to Casino, on the Richmond River, where several small camps are situated. Another 20 miles northward, and we sight the rapidly rising town of Kyogle. The aborigines in this locality are numerous, but are now being centralised on the Runnymede Home, controlled by the A.P. Board. Here a row of small huts has been erected, also several sheds and a meeting house. The manager takes a keen interest in the temporal, intellectual, and spiritual welfare of the people on the station, and recently, on information supplied by him, a white man was prosecuted for supplying them with liquor. We are able to give a lantern talk at Kyogle, and the interest of the Endeavourers being aroused, a band of workers agreed to help in the spiritual work both at the Home and the surrounding camps. After a lantern service in Casino, we go to Lismore, where, a few miles from the town, is a reserve containing 420 acres, but the coloured folk are mostly living elsewhere in small companies. A few earnest young people from the Church of Christ C.E. society are interesting them-

selves, and, besides visiting their homes, persuade the coloured people to accompany them to the church. We think this is what Jesus would do, and what He would like other Church members to do. Having by aid of the lantern illustrated the Mission's work and the people's need to a Lismore audience, we pass on to the Tweed, where a similar gathering is arranged in Murwillumbah. Here we are pleased to meet a former member of the Central Council, Mr. R. F. Jay, who provides us with a temporary home. There are not so many of our people on the Tweed River as we have been led to suppose, most of the coloured folk being Kanakas. There are several tribes along the Queensland border, which we hope (D.V.) to visit before returning to organise the work in several centres through which we have passed.

The Mission having appointed Mr. J. Reeve to the Inverell district, we set out in that direction, for the purpose of assisting in the establishment of this new station.

After giving lantern lectures in Merewether and Adamstown, we continued northward by bike. Opportunities for advocating the claims of the work arose, but no public meetings were held until we reached Tamworth. We received a most cordial welcome at the home of the Baptist pastor, Rev. G. M. Bull. Although this brother was himself absent, the kindness of Mrs. Bull and Mr. S. A. McDonald (pastor's assistant) will not soon be forgotten. Meetings were held in the Tabernacle, and in Tamworth and West Tamworth Methodist Churches. By the kindness of our proven friend, Rev. A. Graham (late of Port Macquarie and Gladstone), we were able to give a lantern talk at Manilla, 28 miles west from Tamworth. We discovered a small settlement of dark people at Bora Crossing, 12 miles from Manilla; and another about thirty miles north-east from Tamworth. Our next stopping place was Ar-

Aboriginal Athletes.

The True Australian Eleven.
Winners of the Silver Cup.

Missionaries and Workers at Northern Rivers Conference, 1902.

Left to right, front row: Miss Edie Johnston, Miss Retta Dixon, Miss Mary Delves, Miss J. Gilmore.
Standing: Mr. E. J. Telfer, Mr. Alf. Cox.

Wauchope Junior Christian Endeavour Society.
Composed of Native Children.
With their Superintendent, Miss Ollie Wallace.
At this settlement on the Hastings River a Mission was opened in June, 1903.

Burnt Bridge Church and Mission House
On the day of the official opening, 27th May, 1903.
Gathering of Missionaries and Natives.

Purfleet Mission Hall and School.
On the day of the official opening, 24th June, 1903.
In centre of group—Miss Dixon, Miss Delves, Mr. Telfer, and Mr. Cox.
Native people and children who composed the first congregation.



7



midale, where we told, with the aid of the lantern, the needs of the cause to a large audience. Cycling 23 miles northward to Guyra, during which distance we rose more than 1000 feet, or to 4330 feet above sea level, we had further opportunities for service; and a lantern lecture was given in the Union Church. The natives occasionally frequent Guyra, but their nearest reserve is 20 miles to the north-west, at Oban, where a considerable area of second class land is allotted to them. It is only during the summer months, however, that they remain on the highlands; and, during the bleak New England winter, they scatter to the Macleay, towards Inverell, or elsewhere.

It is comparatively easy thus to write of our journeyings from place to place, and there is a tendency in so doing to obscure the "actual" behind the "descriptive"; but, for the glory of God, we feel it is necessary sometimes to reveal the "actual." The chilling apathy with which even Christian people view the work, the unexpected rebuff often received from "those in high places" to whom we have gone for sympathy and help, the failure, from the human side, of many projects—these would oft dishearten, had not the Lord taught us at such times to look to Him with the prayer: "Give us help .... for vain is the help of man" (Psalm 108: 12).

We have had occasion to look to the Lord alone for daily and hourly supplies, and it has sometimes seemed as if God's test were severe; and yet, in every instance, when we had reached our own extremity, God interposed, and took the opportunity to show us that "The Lord God of Elijah" is the same to-day.

It has been necessary, many times, to sleep by the roadside, with the trees of the forest, and the stars overhead, reminding us of the watchful care of One Who never slumbers. When the suggestion has been made that this should not be necessary,

we have been reminded that "the Son of Man had not where to lay His head," and "the disciple is not greater than his Lord"; and we have been led to praise God for the privilege of (in some small degree) having fellowship with Christ in His sufferings. Often have we been alone in the midst of a crowd, or in the thronged mart of a busy town, and at such times the thought has come: "What must have been the 'ALONENESS' of Christ?" It is not easy to write in this strain, but for the glory of His name, that His people might be reminded that He is still the Covenant-keeping God, we are constrained to do so. "There hath not failed one word of all His good promises," and "They who trust Him wholly find Him wholly true."

In a secluded spot five miles out from Guyra, on the banks of a mountain stream, which rises at Ben Lomond and flows into the Macleay River, we found the 24 aborigines. Having met a number of them previously, all seemed overjoyed to see us. We stayed for several hours talking with them, and before leaving a service was held.

The following day a ride of 42 miles brought us to Tingha, and another eight to Bassendean Station, where, on our previous visit, we had received such marked kindness from Mrs. Brown and family. During our stay we were again shown the most cordial hospitality; and also several times visited the coloured people at Stoney Creek. They were indeed pleased to see us again, and in the evening flocked to the station house to see the lantern views of the Mission, and the work amongst the aborigines in other places. A service was also held with about 30 aborigines, who were tin mining about four miles from Tingha. In this town a lantern service was held, the Salvation Army officers, at much personal sacrifice, placing their hall at our disposal, and the Anglican Minister taking the chair. Discovering that some days must elapse before Bro. Reeve's





arrival, we visited the aborigines at Pindari, 21 miles toward Emmaville, and then rode upwards of 60 miles northwards, crossing the Queensland border at Bonshaw. Small companies of our people were living along this route, and it was our object to secure their settlement on the new station at Pindari.

The following morning we set out to choose the site of operations, our friend, Mr. Norman Miller, driving us to where we were met by one of our people, who, faithful to his word, had driven 10 miles to convey the missionary to the station. We were given hospitality for the night at the home of Mr. Jas. Campbell, who the following day loaned us horses to ride over to inspect the ground, with a view to choosing the best spot for the settlement. Escorted by the venerable King, "Schoolmaster Jack," we rode most of the day, and finally pitched camp at New Hut Creek, three miles from its junction with the Severn River.

On the following Monday the first detachment of coloured people came and settled near us, and others followed.

This station is surrounded by mountains, and the wild bush country is frequented by a variety of beasts, notably the dingo, whose plaintive howl breaks the stillness of the night. Yet, amidst all, we have the consciousness of God's presence; and as the little band of coloured people assembled each morning and evening, we noted how eagerly they listened to the Old Story that to them was new, and we were encouraged. While returning to the settlement at Nullamanna, we had an unpleasant experience—the bicycle suddenly collapsed, owing to defective workmanship in recently effected repairs. The bicycle was then converted into a wheelbarrow, and in this unique fashion we trudged along mile after mile, until we reached the home of

a settler, who kindly supplied us with a horse for the remaining 12 miles of the journey. On Sunday the whole population of the settlement attended the meetings held, and on Monday the first meeting of the Inverell local Committee took place. Lantern talks were held in several centres, and at one such meeting, held at Nullamanna, a large and sympathetic audience assembled. As soon as these meetings were over, and our bicycle repairs effected, we commenced another long and strenuous journey to reach the aborigines in the far west, who know nothing of that salvation wherein we rejoice.

Arriving at Moree, a lantern lecture was given, and visits paid to the local aborigines. Their condition was needy in the extreme. The largest settlements were at Boomi and Mungindi (northward near the Queensland border), and at Terry-hie-hie Station. We also discovered and ministered to groups of natives at Woolabra, Narrabri, Boggabri, and Gunnedah, and at each of these towns a lantern talk was given to the white residents. Leaving the north-western line at Gunnedah, we travelled across country to Coonabarabran, this time by the old horse coach, owing to the condition of the roads. Eighteen hours' continuous coaching brought us to the settlement at Fawkett Mountain, where we were surprised to find about 60 coloured folk assembled in one of the houses, and Mr. Erskine, of the Brotherhood of the Good Shepherd, preparing to hold a service. "Here's a seat, young man," said one old coloured woman as we entered. Someone else passed us a hymn book, and the service proceeded. At its close we were given an opportunity of addressing the people, and afterwards adjourned to Brother Erskine's tent to enjoy Christian converse and conference upon methods of work. We shared this brother's tent for several days, and on Sunday a united service was held, the whole community attending. On Monday our illustrated talk was





given to a large audience in the public hall, much interest being aroused.

From Coonabarabran, a rough bicycle ride of 80 miles against a head wind brought us to Coonamble. Native camps were visited, and lantern talks were given at Gular, Gilgandra, Girilambone, Coolabah, Coonamble, Dubbo, and Nyngan, and we had many opportunities of visiting camps of aborigines and bringing to them the glad news of the Gospel. Another dreary and strenuous ride of 80 miles against a hot westerly wind brought us to Byrock, where we found a group of dusky craftsmen busy making spears and boomerangs of mulga. From Byrock to Brewarrina there was no road where a bicycle could be used, so we rode for 67 miles over the railway sleepers between the rails. and when one of the fettlers described our journey as "a bumpy ride enough to shake the liver out of a kangaroo," we felt that we could not disagree. From Brewarrina we rode eight miles up the Barwon River to the Government station, where we were welcomed at the home of the Mission's old friend, Mr. H. E. Hockey. There were about 200 aborigines on the station, and the work appeared to be in a prosperous condition. During our stay we performed a double marriage ceremony.

Again wending northward, we set out across the dreary, treeless plain, through which, at some distance from the black soil track, we could trace the course of the Bokhara River. Eighty miles of incessant pedalling brought us to Goodooga, where we found 50 aborigines in the rudest possible camps. After some conversation, we enquired, "Do you ever have any Gospel meetings?" An abstract look is the only response. "Does anyone ever come and preach to you?" "Only policeman come when some fella get drunk and fight—lock 'em up." "Do you ever have church?" "No, boss, these blacks never go church in their lives, parson never come near us,

only white fella go church." After tending to some who were sick, we proposed a meeting, and everyone came to the selected spot except the king, who excused himself thus, "Me cookum meat, boss; if leavum, dog cookum quick." Eagerly the people listened to the story of Christ the Good Shepherd, and then they were left, as far as human help is concerned, shepherdless sheep.

We discovered other camps on the Culgoa River and at Brenda Station, where we again crossed the Queensland border. Thirty-five miles east of Goodooga is Angledool, and here we found two large camps, with a united population of considerably over 100 natives. On Sunday morning they gathered for a Gospel meeting, and we were informed by one of the oldest white residents that it was the first service they had ever had. In the afternoon we met them again, and then said farewell.

Threatening storms interfered with our visits to Collarendabri and Walgett, so we returned by another route towards Brewarrina. Eighty-five miles' rough riding the first day, a fireless camp on the bleak open plain with no shelter and very little food, with lightning flashing and thunder crashing, and a heavy hailstorm just before dawn—the memory of these experiences does not readily fade from the mind of a travelling missionary. At 5 a.m. we were on the road again, and then came another storm of wind and rain. In ten minutes either riding or pushing the bicycle over the black soil was impossible, so, lifting it on to our shoulders, we trudged along through the wet and slippery mire, and after four hours' toiling we discovered that we had travelled nearly five miles. We plodded on till nightfall, faint, yet pursuing, and fortunately found a camp with friendly teamsters. There were three wagons loaded with wool, but one of the drivers had ridden into Brewarrina for the mail, where he "got on the booze," and forgot all about his team and





his stranded mates. My coming to the camp solved their difficulty, and next morning the bicycle was placed on the wagon and the missionary drove the wool team to Brewarrina. After again visiting friend Hockey at the Government station, we returned to Nyngan, via Gongolgon and Monkey. The aborigines at Dubbo were again visited, and then we rode on to Wellington, where we found a native settlement on the western bank of the Macquarie River. On Sunday afternoon we conducted a service with 96 natives present. Some Christian men and women from the churches in Wellington were present also, and promised to continue the work until a station was established and a missionary appointed. Later we returned, and a strong local committee was formed in the town, and a missionary installed to minister to the neglected aborigines of the Macquarie River. Our brother missionary, Mr. D. H. Caldwell, was greatly used in organising this committee, and placing the work on a sound footing.

Continuing the journey cityward, we found that Mr. G. Caldwell, of Inglewood, had arranged a lantern lecture for us in Molong. Much interest and enthusiasm was manifested at this gathering, and the next night a similar meeting was held in the Congregational Church at Orange. Finding that a projected lecture in Bathurst was impracticable, we rode on to Blackheath, where Mrs. Wilkins had organised a splendid meeting in the parish hall. Next we visited the dark folk at Katoomba, and then hastened on to the metropolis, where service of another kind claimed our attention.

## CHAPTER VIII.

## STATIONS AND WORKERS.

While the writer was engaged in the pioneering described in the previous chapter, vigorous and successful work was being carried on at many previously established stations in New South Wales. New workers were coming into the field, and those already at work were making spiritual history amongst the aborigines.

Mr. E. O. Woolford was elected President of the Kempsey local Committee, and it proved to be God's own choice, as for many years this dear devoted brother gave himself without reserve to the cause of the aborigines throughout the Macleay River district. His godly and consistent life was constantly blended with sacrificial service, and the native people at Burnt Bridge, as well as white residents throughout the district, still hold his name in loving reverence. Through sunshine and storm, through evil report and good report, Mr. Woolford "stuck to his job," until God called him to higher service and eternal reward.

Miss Jelbart did much solid service at Burnt Bridge, and from the time of her welcome meeting in April, 1906, to her departure in July, 1909, worthily represented the Mission at this station. The report of her farewell meeting contains the following: "The president, Mr. E. O. Woolford, presided. Addresses were given by Miss Telfer, Mr. V. Rudder, and Mr. J. E. Ingram. Kindly reference was made to the good work accomplished by Miss Jelbart, the result of which Eternity alone would





reveal. Mr. Billie Williams, one of the native people, presented the missionary with a beautiful work basket, and in a few very sincere words asked her to accept it as a token of their deep love for her." Shortly after this, Miss Jelbart was married to Mr. V. Rudder, and both these good friends continued their practical interest in the Mission and the missionaries.

The work on the Manning River continued to prosper under Miss M. Oldrey, and her name will ever be lovingly associated with Purfleet station. Miss Oldrey retired from active missionary work in 1911, and later was married to Mr. Breckenridge. Her interest in the aborigines did not cease, and although the hand of death removed her husband some years ago, she remained a prominent and helpful member of the Taree Local Auxiliary.

Miss A. Lock continued for several years at Forster, in the Cape Hawke district, where many of the people were brought to Christ. When the work was opened up in Western Australia, she was removed to that State, where she was associated with the work at the Orphanage, and later at Katanning. After some time in the West, Miss Lock came into the work in South Australia, and was stationed in the far northern areas of Central Australia, which work will be referred to at a later stage.

Miss E. Buttsworth did valuable work at Sackville Reach, and afterwards at Bellinger Heads until her retirement in 1908.

The venerable brother, Mr. L. Railton, did splendid service over an extended period. At Rollands Plains, on the Wilson River, he toiled incessantly, and faithfully witnessed for Christ amongst the aborigines in this and other localities, and afterwards, for a lengthy term, ably filled the position of Secretary for the Mission. When the call came, it took him from the thick of the fight. He entered the work at a ripe age, and toiled to the end.

We have referred to the valuable work of Mr. D. H. Caldwell. He laboured abundantly in many centres, notably at Burnt Bridge, Bellbrook, where he built the first Mission House; and at Pindari, afterwards called Nacoorima, in the mountainous country north of Inverell. This station was commenced by the writer in the virgin bush land near the Severn River. Mr. Caldwell also did valuable pioneering work. Mr. A. W. Setchell, after years of hardy toil on the Northern Rivers, took up the work of Mr. Caldwell at Nacoorima, where he utilised his practical knowledge as a builder in the erection of a fine set of Mission buildings; with equal thoroughness he built up the spiritual work. The writer recalls with pleasure many long journeys by bicycle with Mr. Setchell or Mr. Caldwell as companion.

The late President, Mr. T. E. Colebrook, sometimes accompanied us on these long treks, and hereby hangs many a tale with an intermingling of pathos, tragedy, and comedy. The President, riding on ahead, bought bread and other necessities at a wayside store, but left the parcel with the storekeeper, with instructions to stop the two young fellows coming along behind and to give them the provisions. Probably the storekeeper had the best intentions to be honest, but brother Setchell and the writer came by at 20 miles an hour, and, if he shouted, we neither heard nor heeded. Perhaps 10 miles further on we found the weary President with the billy boiling. "Where's the parcel?" "What parcel?" "The bread and stuff I bought!" "What bread and stuff?" Then followed explanations, stern looks of disapproval, then mutual laughter, and finally an aching void, which became more acute as the afternoon ride continued.

We dare to mention the time when Mr. Setchell arrived at the spot on the banks of the Macleay River, opposite his station on Fatorina Island. It





was nearly midnight, and he was tired and worn from a long journey. Though he shouted loud and long for the natives to bring a boat, there was no response, and finally, in spite of the wet and the cold, he had to divest himself of his clothing and swim the dark, shark-infested tidal waters of the lower Macleay.

Another station where the work was encouraging was Roseby Park, near Nowra. Here work had been carried on by local helpers, then by Miss Timbery for a short time. In November, 1905, when Miss Ethel Black began at this station, the work was improved in many ways. The little church was well filled for the Sunday evening services, native Christians showed signs of growth in grace, and helped the missionary in the work. Amongst those who assisted in the spiritual work was our native helper, George Longbottom, who, taking his Bible and hymn book, gathered the people at the adjacent camps, and gave to them the Gospel message.

At this station, Miss Florrie Pain worked for a time, prior to her going to the strenuous and difficult work at Bellbrook, where she laboured until August 10th, 1908, when she attended the Lower Macleay Mission Anniversary, intending to return to Bellbrook on the following Saturday. But God willed otherwise. Whilst at Kempsey, her health gave way, and on Wednesday, September the 16th, she went to her reward. Writing to the "Advocate" of this worker's "Home-going," Mr. V. Rudder says:—

"It is barely eighteen months since our Sister Pain came amongst us on the Macleay, and when we saw her first we wondered that one so weak in body could so unfalteringly go forward to take up work on a lonely Mission station with none but strangers near. But only a short time in her company was needed to show that she had learned to trust for strength in Him Who 'fainteth not, neither

is weary,' and Who says to His trustful, obedient children, 'For I the Lord thy God will hold thy right hand, saying unto thee, fear not, I will help thee.' "

As we came to know her better, when at intervals of months she came to us for a few days, we learnt not only to admire her faith and courage, but to love her as a dear friend, an able helper, and a true sister, related to us by the unspeakable ties of spiritual kinship. Bodily weakness was ever present with her, but it failed to crush her bright spirit, and in "the time to laugh," she was the cheeriest of us all. When she left the station for the last time, one thing after another happened to delay her return. Then the body, which she never spared from any possible service, grew alarmingly weak; the doctor's unfavourable verdict and the removal to the hospital followed. Then came days of patiently borne suffering, and of increasing weakness for her, and of anxious waiting for us, till our Father in His mercy sent His minister, best of all on earth for her, her mother—made strong in His strength, to serve her and to suffer with her—tender to soothe, bright to cheer.

Next came removal from the hospital to the little home which loving hands had prepared, and the subsequent days when the suffering had abated, and the hopes of keeping her revived. Thus lovingly did the Father of mercies allay our anxieties, till in the stillness of a fair morning, as she lay restfully in her mother's arms, the consciousness of her coming change came to her, and characteristically her first thought was for others: "Mother, are you all alone? Hadn't you better call one of the neighbours?" And then, "Oh, mother, I believe I'm going Home!"

Another loyal and faithful worker now came into the field in the person of Miss Ethel Hamer, of Newcastle. This zealous servant of Christ laboured at La Perouse, Roseby Park, and Ulgundahi Island,





near Maclean, on the Lower Clarence River, and afterwards did work of a very important character in Western Australia. Miss Hamer married Mr. J. W. Fryer, another missionary of whom we must write more hereafter.

Mr. W. Newman was a member of the first Committee of the Mission, in the year 1901, and the perusal of the minutes reveals the fact that through all the period of his work as a committee-man, he took a keen and practical interest in all the affairs of the Mission.

Mr. J. W. Boden, another member of the Committee, was elected manager of the "New South Wales Aborigines' Advocate" in November, 1907, and his thoroughness and business-like methods did much to help in maintaining the efficiency and increasing the usefulness of this silent messenger. Early in the year Mr. Boden was elected as Treasurer of the Mission, and for some time held the dual office.

As the field extended, and new stations were being opened up by the pioneering missionary, more workers offered, and many of these were sent forward by the Council. Miss E. Thompson, after a period of probation, was placed in charge of the station at Plumpton. A most enthusiastic welcome meeting was held, at which Rev. J. Worboys and the writer were the speakers. Miss Thompson did valuable work at this station, and afterwards on the Hawkesbury River; then in October, 1908, she was appointed to the position of Sister-in-charge of the newly-acquired Children's Home at Bomaderry. Her practical interest in the work has never failed.

Early in 1908 three other missionaries were accepted—Miss Parker, who had been for some time a member of the Sydney Council; Miss Dunning, who laboured loyally at Greenwell Point, Cape Hawke, and the Macleay River; and Mr. J. W. Fryer, who served the Mission faithfully for many years. Mr. Fryer worked with Mr. D. H. Caldwell at Nucoo-

rima, in the wild bush country north of Inverell. "Nucoorima" is the native name for "wild apple tree, and was so named because of a clump of these trees near the Mission House. Here, Mr. Fryer shouldered the responsibility of teaching in the native school. Other fields where this brother toiled faithfully were at Coraki, Richmond River, Nymboida, Upper Clarence River, and, some years later, ably assisted by his faithful wife, at Katanning, Western Australia.

The next probationer was Mr. R. A. Nossiter, who held the fort, and fought the fight at Fatorina Island, and who was for some time the missionary at New Angledool, in the far north-west of the State. On April 10th, 1911, Mr. Nossiter was united in marriage to Miss Parker (mentioned above), the officiating minister being Rev. R. B. S. Hammond. After their marriage, they did much valuable work at the above station, and also in other centres in New South Wales and in Western Australia.

Still other missionaries were entering the field, and in December, 1908, the Council accepted Miss Caldwell, sister of Mr. D. H. Caldwell, and also Miss Bertha Telfer, sister of the writer. Miss Telfer had received her training at Rev. Lockhart Morton's College in Adelaide, and was sent to the old station of many memories—Burnt Bridge, Macleay River. Miss Caldwell was located at the Bomaderry Home as assistant to Miss Thompson.

The scope of this history will not permit the recording of all the valiant services rendered by these faithful workers, and in this chapter we cannot do more than briefly mention some who devoted years of strenuous service to the cause of Christ amongst the aborigines.

Miss Smith came from North Sydney, and was sent to the Manning River. Mrs. Clarson laboured with Miss Baker at La Perouse. Mr. Foster next joined the missionary forces, and was designated to





Nucoorima, where he laboured with Mr. Setchell, and at a later period had charge of Ngoorumba Station. For some years he has held a position as manager and teacher under the Government Board. Miss Duggan was sent to the Clarence River, Mr. Huxley to the Macleay, Miss St. Heaps to the Manning, Mr. Terry to the Hawkesbury, and Miss Earle to Ulgundahi Island. Mr. Terry and Miss St. Heaps were joined in matrimony on August 3rd, 1910, and a few days later took charge of the Mission at Fatorina Island.

Miss McGregor, of Kempsey, had been intimately connected with the work for a number of years. Her home was a free boarding-house for wandering and worn-out missionaries. When the "Lord of the Harvest" opened the way, she entered fully into the work, and her name first appears on the official list of missionaries in September, 1910. Her work at Forster made a deep and permanent mark for good upon the lives of those amongst whom she laboured.

Miss Wheeler was appointed to Tangoa, near Glen Innis; Mr. Dickson to Wellington, Miss Mantell to La Perouse, Miss Hagan to Cabbage Tree Island, and Miss Johnston to Bellbrook. Later in the year 1911, Miss Duggan was married to Mr. Allen Cameron, a well-known and respected resident of Maclean, and one who had for some years been a valued helper in the work. These friends remained on the list of missionaries who hold positions under the Aborigines' Protection Board.

The "Australian Aborigines Advocate" of April 30th, 1912, makes the following announcement: "A new worker, Miss Fowler, is entering the Mission, and has been set apart for the work at the Children's Home at Bomaderry." For more than 20 years Miss Fowler filled the position of Matron of that institution. We must reserve for another chapter the story

of the splendid work that has been accomplished amongst the native children by means of the Bomaderry Home.

But what of the actual work at these various stations to which the missionaries have been sent? The available space will permit only casual glimpses at what God has wrought amongst the aborigines.

We have previously mentioned Billy Williams, but as we write of transformed lives we can see again, in fancy, his radiant face. There he sits in the little church at Burnt Bridge, his eyes fixed on the face of the preacher, his whole personality an inspiration. An opportunity is given for a personal testimony, and Billy begins to wriggle, and then slowly rises to his feet. "Yes, I have a testimony, and you can find it in John 9 and 25. 'One thing I know, that, whereas once I was blind, now I see.' I was born in Queensland, and in my young days mixed with the roughest; tramping, droving, shearing, and bullock-driving. I learned habits of sin, and began to drift on the downward course. It was in Wauchope that I first got mixed up with Christians. Here I saw a converted coloured woman holding a meeting, and then I felt that I was not right; yet I would not give in, but lived on in sin for about ten years before I was converted. What impressed me most was to see such a quiet, earnest plodding worker as Mrs. Wallace, daily sacrificing herself for the sake of Christ and others. Then I went to Rollands Plains and Burnt Bridge, and got more help there. For a long time I had been feeling that I wanted to be good and do good, but how or where to start I did not know. I often prayed in my blindness for God to show me the way. One day I was reading in the 37th Psalm that God would give me the desires of my heart, and then I went along to the meeting in the little Burnt Bridge church, and there He did it. I was full of joy, and a fresh desire to do good came to me. Next day I

Mr. Henry Bush.

**Group of Missionaries.**

Happy Moments after all night at prayer.

Back row, left to right: Mr. Railton, Miss Oldrey, Miss Black, Miss Lock, Mr. Caldwell.

Centre row, seated: Miss Jelbart, Miss Baker, Miss Buttsworth.

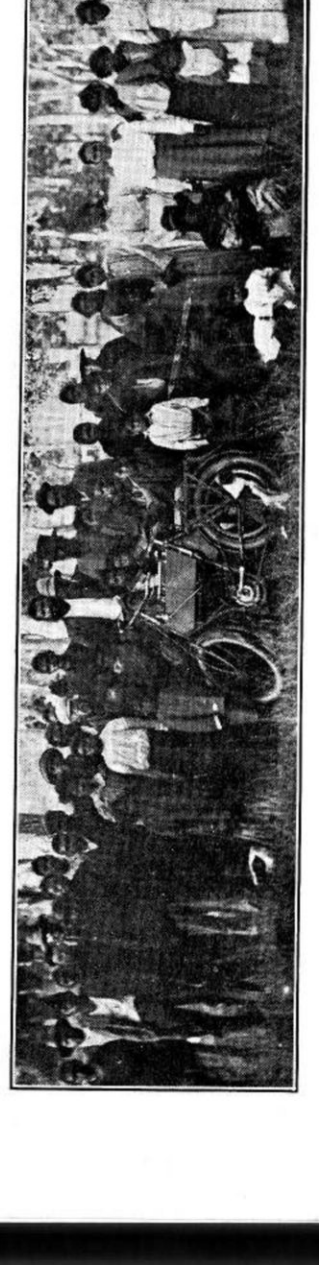
Front row: Miss Pain, native girl, Miss Baker's charge.

**Group of Missionaries and Workers.**

Left to right, standing: Mr. and Mrs. Chambers, Mrs. Corbett, Mrs. Metzger, Mrs. Morwick, Mrs. Hewlett, Mrs. Huxtable, Mr. Davey, Mr. Foster.

Sitting: Mrs. Colebrook, Miss Fisher, Miss V. Turner, Miss Baker, Miss Albert, Miss Malcolm, Mrs. Jago.

Seated on ground: Mr. L. Railton, Mr. T. E. Colebrook, Mr. J. W. Boden, Mr. J. Morton.



Aborigines at Ulmara, Clarence River, with Mr. Telfer's motor cycle in the centre. This is a typical group of natives as they gathered to hear the Gospel from the pioneering missionary.





was driving bullocks. They were a contrary lot, and I had a funny feeling that I ought to be careful how I spoke to them. It was just like Someone saying to me, 'Be careful what you say.' Since my conversion my experience is that, no matter how I feel, downcast, miserable, tempted, when I just take my Bible, and pray about the trouble, I find comfort and help. Some passages in the Word I could make nothing out of, I might as well look at a stone; but, after praying, the Lord has just thrown light on it. I am happy in the Lord, and I find it best to spend as much time as I can with Him. In His strength I will do what I can for the fallen."

In a letter to the "Advocate" of March 31st, 1906, some unknown writer, under the name of "Wanderer," records a visit to the Macleay River as follows:—"Never shall I forget this Sunday morning. It will be a red-letter day at Burnt Bridge—the birth of the church, and the first celebration of Communion. How the Mission workers must have rejoiced. First, the Christian Endeavour consecration meeting was held, and a goodly number publicly renewed their vows. A short address from the visitor, and then Mr. Telfer explained in what Church membership consisted—what was required of them, etc. Then followed a hallowed time of prayer and communion with God, after which six were received into Church fellowship. That looks cold and statistical, but it was soul-stirring to hear the questions asked, and the confessions they made of Christ. Then the Communion service was indeed a feast of love and remembrance. Even in these solemn moments, however, one was struck with the absence of all conventionality; so that we were not shocked when a woman, taking her piece of bread, looked up at the missioner, smiled, and bowed her thanks. It was just in keeping with the hallowed unceremoniousness which pervaded the whole service. The work that is going on impressed me deeply. I no-

ticed these people from the Mission moving about the town on Saturday evening, and at the Show, where there are so many temptations, and was struck with their uniformly good behaviour. This in itself must be a great encouragement to the workers, and when so many are, according to their light, followers of Christ, it must be a joy indeed. May God hasten the time when all the Australian natives shall be brought to a saving knowledge of the truth."

Some illustrations of the faithfulness and loyalty of the native Christians may be helpful. Some years ago a native man came to his missionary and in a humble and thankful spirit told how God had given him the victory. A man with plenty of this world's goods came to him and wanted to buy some shell work on the Lord's Day, and, notwithstanding continued protestations, threw down the money on the table, and, telling the native man to send the goods along, turned and left the house. He (the native Christian) just shut the door and prayed for guidance. His decision was soon reached, and, picking up the money, he ran after the man who had left the order, and handed him the coins he had left. The man was angry, and said, "You are a fool to throw away your living like that." "I can't help it, sir," he replied, "it would be all the same if you had left £5." This man was true to his convictions of right in the face of strong temptation, and for many years he stood by the missionaries and faithfully witnessed for Christ. Another Christian native, when similarly urged to sell on Sunday, turned away from the would-be buyer, saying, "The Lord has provided for me all these years, and I am not going to begin selling on His day again."

A Christian woman at a far distant mission station gave her testimony thus:—"It's like this with me. I see a plough, and someone comes along and





yokes the bullocks to the plough. Then the plough can do the work. So it is with me. When I get up in the morning, God takes hold of me, and then I can do my work because God is going before me. If I am washing dishes or scrubbing floors, I just talk to God, and it is all right. Sometimes I work more than I pray, and that is like putting the plough in front of the bullocks, and the work won't go. But when I put God first and pray to Him, the work goes quick."

We cannot close this chapter on "Stations and Workers" without making pointed reference to two much-loved helpers of the early days of the Mission. We refer to Mr. and Mrs. J. Morton, of Petersham Baptist Church. Mr. Morton was an honoured and much-loved vice-president of the Mission, and he and his devoted wife were active members of the Sydney Council until the Lord called them to Himself for higher service. The writer recalls how, on one occasion, when weary and worn with the strain of the work, and not knowing where to turn for the much-needed rest, Mrs. Morton gently pressed into his hand an envelope, which, on investigation, was found to contain £11. This was a gift from herself and a few other friends. Her gracious manner and refined speech were but the reflex of a life of communion with God. Mr. Morton devoted himself with great earnestness to the work, and was ever on the alert to help the missionaries or the native people in a practical way. He was deeply interested in the Bomaderry Children's Home, and also in the work at La Perouse and Plumpton.

## CHAPTER IX.

## "THE CALL OF THE WEST."

The thirteenth Annual Conference of the Mission, held in Sydney in November, 1907, marks the beginning of a new period of progress. Missionaries from all parts of the State were present, as well as many voluntary workers, and members of local committees from country centres. Twelve days were spent in prayer and conference, and some vital decisions were made. It was decided that the name of the Mission should be changed from "New South Wales Aborigines' Mission" to "Australian Aborigines' Mission"; and that work amongst the aborigines in other States of the Commonwealth should be commenced at once. For years we had heard the call from the western State, and our hearts had been deeply stirred from time to time as we heard of the deplorable condition of the natives, and the cruel ill-treatment meted out to them in some parts of the State. Much prayer had been offered that the way would open for missionaries to be sent to this needy field, and now at last we heard the Master's call to "go forward." By the unanimous decision of the Conference, the writer was set apart to proceed at once to Western Australia and establish work in that State. This was the substance of our marching orders, but we knew that in undertaking this difficult and dangerous work we were upheld by the prayers of hundreds of God's people throughout the Commonwealth. We were relying entirely on the Lord for our financial need in this undertaking, but the One Who had given us the command





could be depended on to supply every need, and step by step He opened the way and led us forward into this new field. Some were perturbed at the thought of the missionary going forth alone, but, in response to the many prayers that were ascending on behalf of this new work, the Lord of the Harvest provided a companion in the person of a young native Christian—born in the West, born again in the east, and now filled with a passionate desire to carry the Gospel message to his own people.

When it became known that the writer was proceeding to the West, this would-be native missionary came timidly one day to the President of the Mission, his face all smiles, and in faltering words intimated that he had some urgent request to make. The President drew him aside, and asked him to tell all that was in his heart: "What is it, Wandy?" With tears glistening in his eyes, and his voice trembling with emotion, Wandy replied, "Me go West Australia with Mr. Telfer?" Mr. Colebrook replied kindly that he would pray about it, and that if it were the Lord's will the way would open. By some this offer was regarded as the answer to many prayers. Wandy knew the western State, and how much his people there needed Christ. His companionship would help the pioneering missionary in opening up the work. It would, of course, double the expense, but, as Wandy said, "The Lord, He got all the silver, and all the gold, and if He want me go He send it along. I not frighten to go when I got a rich Father like that." Wandy laughed and went away whistling.

The story that Wandy told is full of romance, as well as tragedy. He was born about one hundred miles north of Coolgardie, and lived his early life in the wilds of the interior, wandering with the tribe, and learning the native language. One day, while in company with his father and mother, a string of camels appeared. Knowing something of the

habits of white men, the father and mother took refuge in flight. They were pursued by two of the men, and when they were hard-pressed in making their escape, following the native custom, they hid the baby boy in the bushes, and, running in different directions, evaded their pursuers. The white men found the boy crouching with fear in the place where he had been hidden. They captured him, and carried him back to the camp. He tried to run away, but they lifted him on to the back of a camel, and, passing a rope underneath the camel, tied him in that position by his feet. In telling the story, Wandy said: "I cried all day, for I wanted my mother and father. When they made camp, they tied me to a tree, and I cried all night, for I was cold. They kept me with them for a long time, and made me do all the dirty work about the camp. They made me mind the camels, and threatened to flog me or shoot me if I tried to run away. I was with them all the trip, and was their little black slave until they got back to Coolgardie. Then they said, 'We don't want you any more, Wandy, you can go and look after yourself.' I didn't know what to do, but I wanted my father and mother. I didn't know where to find them, and I never saw them again. They might be dead; perhaps some white fellow shoot them, I don't know. By and bye I got a job at the pub in Coolgardie. They give me plenty to eat, and plenty beer to drink, and I think I drunk nearly all the time. Then some white fellow come along and want me to go with him to New South Wales to look after cattle. He tell me he be good to me, give me plenty money, plenty tucker, so I tell him I go with him. He take me to Fremantle, and we get on a steamer, and by and bye we get to Sydney, and he take me away up into bush on farm. When he get me there, I say to boss, 'What about money you give me?' He only





laugh at me, then he swear and say, 'I not give you any money, and if you don't work hard I'll flog you with a stock-whip.' When I tell him that not right to treat me like that, he thrash me with a rope till blood come. Then he kick me and send me away, he flog me every day, and make me work too hard all the time. One day I make up my mind to clear out, so when it get dark I watch big house till all light go out, then I take blanket and run away. I go nearly all night, then see a train and jump in truck under tarpaulin, and go to sleep. When I wake up, train in Sydney, and I crawl out and run away."

Wandy found his way to the Domain, where he slept every night amongst the papers in the rubbish bins, begging his food by day, and going back to his hiding-place at night. "One night," said Wandy, "I just get to sleep and big fat policeman get hold of me and shake me and say, 'What you doing there?' I say, 'Can't you see what I am doing?' He pull me out and send me away. I watch him till he get out of sight, and then I go back and have another sleep. One day I meet a policeman and he talk kind to me, and tell me to go to La Perouse. When I get nearly there I get frightened, and think perhaps strange native might spear me. Then missionary come along and I alright—not frightened any more."

Wandy had at last found that in this hard world there was such a thing as love—true human love, the outcome of Love Divine. He learned to read and write, and before long his life was yielded to the control of Christ. He became a sincere Christian, and his life was a joy and a strength to the La Perouse missionaries. Communion with God awakened in his young heart fervent missionary desire, and when the call came he responded to the prompting of the Holy Spirit and said, "Me go West Australia."

On Friday evening, 13th December, 1907, the little mission hall at La Perouse was well filled with friends anxious to bid God-speed to one of their own number, who had volunteered to accompany the writer to the West. Mr. W. Cormack, a member of the Council, presided, in consequence of the enforced absence of the President. Peter Wandy spoke a few earnest words of testimony, telling of what the Lord had done for him, and what a joy it was to be able to go amongst the wild natives of his own land to tell them the glad tidings of salvation. The following morning La Perouse was all excitement, and quite a contingent was at the tram terminus to wave Wandy farewell. Grandmother Timbury, with tear-filled eyes, said, "Wandy, if I was young I would go, too." A small party of well-wishers was on the wharf, and bade Wandy God-speed. The Mission's magazine published that month contains the following comment:—"So history is made. God grant that, in the coming years, the 14th December, 1907, may long be remembered as the day on which the first native Christian from La Perouse went forth to the wilds of the far West to help to carry the tidings of great joy which shall be to all people." Wandy and the writer proceeded direct to Adelaide, the Lord having graciously supplied the need for that portion of the journey. We had planned to spend some time in South Australia for the purpose of telling of the need of the native people amongst the churches. We travelled into the far north, and spent several months at the writer's old home near Hawker, about fifty miles north of Quorn. From this centre we were able to visit many churches and Christian Endeavour societies, and enlist their sympathy in the great undertaking to which God had called us. We also discovered a small camp of aborigines a few miles north of Hawker, and it was a joy indeed to tell to these South Australian natives the precious truth of Christ and





His salvation. In some of the towns we visited we came in touch with a few natives, and on one occasion held a meeting with a small group of these nomads, who had come from Oodnadatta. During a portion of this time, Wandy undertook to mind a flock of sheep on a far northern station, and thus earned sufficient money to purchase a bicycle for his work in the West.

In due time the way opened for us to resume our journey. Travelling by steamer from Port Adelaide, we disembarked at Albany. Like Jonah, we had "paid the fare," but, on landing, our united wealth amounted to 2½d. We were strangers in a strange land, but we had a mighty Lord, and He did not fail. After giving a lantern lecture in Albany, and having our first Gospel service with the aborigines of the western State, we proceeded by bicycle on our journey to Perth, visiting the natives' camps, and preaching in churches of various denominations en route. At Katanning we found a large camp of aborigines, and were able to arrange for some of the local Christian people to undertake evangelistic work amongst them. It was a joy indeed to be amongst these people for whom we had prayed so long. Wandy, on every occasion, gave a clear and telling testimony, and his words always deeply impressed his own countrymen, who seemed to regard him as a special messenger of God.

When Wandy and the writer arrived in Perth, we at once got in touch with a number of Christian men and women who were interested in the aborigines. The "West Australian" newspaper showed a keen interest in the proposal to open up Mission work amongst the natives on interdenominational lines. The editor requested an interview, and the following week published a long article, with photographs, explaining the object of our mission, and the methods we purposed to adopt. We interviewed the ministers of the various churches throughout the city and

suburbs, and were also introduced to a number of prominent Christian laymen. We discovered a camp of aborigines at Guildford, a few miles from Perth, and another small camp near Leederville, and to these we ministered from time to time while preparing for a crusade of meetings and lantern lectures throughout the metropolitan area. These meetings were largely attended, and a great deal of interest was aroused. Wandy was a great help to the missionary at all these gatherings. He proved to be an excellent lanternist, and soon mastered the mechanism of the lantern and the manipulation of the slides. His presence at the meetings was a great attraction, and his musical items played upon the gum-leaf amazed those who had been accustomed to think of the aborigines as a useless and degraded people. How vividly we recollect the great meeting held in the Queen's Hall, and how the audience listened in breathless silence and with evident emotion while Wandy played with tender expression that beautiful hymn.—

"Saviour, Thy dying love Thou gavest me,
Nor should I ought withhold, my Lord, from Thee;
In love my soul would bow, my heart fulfil its vow,
Some offering bring Thee now, something for Thee."

The next step was the formation of a State Council in Western Australia, to work in conjunction with the Central Council of the Mission in Sydney. After much prayer, and numerous interviews, we succeeded in getting together a band of consecrated men and women, who pledged their allegiance to Christ and the aborigines. The first meeting of the W.A. State Council was a time of great blessing, and after a season of prayer, the following were elected to office:—The Rev. William Burridge, Methodist minister of East Perth, was chosen as President, while Rev. Silas Mead, Baptist pioneer, and Rev. F. V. Dowling, Congregationalist, were ap-





pointed Vice-Presidents. Mrs. Fox Angelo, of Cottesloe, became Secretary; Mr. H. T. Haynes, city engineer of Perth, Treasurer; and Mr. E. Radford, press correspondent. Other prominent councillors were Rev. Donald McLean (the author of "The Man from Curdie's River"), Rev. G. T. Pittman, Mr. C. A. Hall, Mrs. J. Selby, Mrs. Z. H. Sanders, and Miss Roach. Meetings were held monthly for business, and much more frequently for prayer. In our interviews with the Chief Protector of Aborigines, the need for a Home for neglected native children was deeply impressed upon us, and after much prayer it was decided to establish an Orphanage near Perth. The "Australian Aborigines' Advocate" for January, 1909, contains the following note:—"The initial work in Western Australia has taken rather longer than was expected, but the State Council is desirous that the foundation be solidly laid before extension work is undertaken. A photograph has reached us of a building selected for a Children's Home." The following issue of the paper continues the subject: "The building mentioned last month has been secured from February 20th. The missionary is in residence, and with help from the Council is getting the place in order."

During these days we had the joy of renewing our friendship with Rev. W. L. Morton, of Adelaide, who was conducting an Evangelistic Mission in Perth. The writer is deeply indebted to this "man of God" for inspiration and guidance when facing difficulties in the work. We were highly privileged to be associated for a time with Rev. Silas Mead, also of Adelaide. Both these beloved fathers are with the Lord, but the influence of their Christian culture and missionary fervour is with us still.

On 24th February, 1909, the writer was married to Miss Florence Nicholas, of Boulder City, and the following day we commenced work at the Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage, in East Perth. The building

had been prepared and partly furnished, and soon the first orphans were taken in and given the shelter they so sorely needed. Then, at the request of the Chief Protector of Aborigines, we received three little girls from the interior. Captured by the police, to save them from a life of shame, they were brought, on foot, by pack horse, by camel and by train, a journey of nearly nine hundred miles. Shall we ever forget how we met them at the Perth station, just before midnight, and trudged home with them through the rain? A pitiful sight indeed: ragged, wretched, filthy and frightened. They had never known love, or kindness, or care. The warm bath and the clean beds they could not understand, and, perhaps fearing treachery, they were out at daybreak, and we found one of them slithering down the iron verandah post from the balcony of the Orphanage. Asked why she wanted to run away, she gave a significant reply, which expresses the sentiment of thousands of the natives from the wilds: "Never trust white fellow; you never know what —— thing he do next."

What a transformation a few months later. Their outlook on life, and consequently their whole demeanour, had completely changed. Their bodies are clean and healthy; they have become happy, loving, and trustful, and, instead of coarse language that came so readily to their lips, they are reciting the Psalms, and singing the sweet, noble hymns of the Christian Church.

We must tell the story of the naming of the Orphanage. Determined to find a suitable aboriginal name, we hit upon the plan of connecting two words from the Djangattie dialect, the speech of the North Coast natives in New South Wales. "Dulhi" is the word for child; while "Gunyah" means shelter—hence Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage means Shelter for Children. After coining and advertising the name, and carefully painting a sign-





board, which may be seen in the accompanying photograph, we were standing across the road, admiring our handiwork, when an old West Australian aboriginal woman passed by. Being interested in learning the local language, I asked her to tell me what "Duhli-Gunyah" meant in her speech. Her reply was alarming and altogether disconcerting. "In my language," she said, "that means, 'Hold your tongue, you're a big liar."

In answer to prayer, many gifts were sent to the Home: furniture, bed-linen, groceries, and various kinds of food. There were times of stress and severe testing, and we were compelled to "lean hard." Sometimes the writer travelled inland to various country districts, visiting aboriginal camps and making enquiries concerning neglected children, while Mrs. Telfer remained in charge of the Orphanage. We took every opportunity of visiting churches and kindred societies for the purpose of telling the story of the work, and much interest was aroused. Just prior to the opening of the Orphanage, Wandy had returned to New South Wales, where he assisted in the work at La Perouse. About this time it was decided by the Central Council that Miss Annie Lock should be transferred from Foster to Western Australia. For a time she assisted at the Orphanage, but at a later date it was arranged that the writer should carry out his long anticipated journey into the far north-west of the State. For some time missionaries and councillors had been praying earnestly for the means to be provided for this expensive and dangerous trip to be undertaken. At last the way opened, and it was decided that the writer should attempt to reach Derby by travelling overland. This meant a journey of at least two thousand miles. A travelling companion was provided in the person of Mr. E. V. Radford, who for some time had been press correspondent, and a very active worker in the West Australian Council. During the

writer's absence, Mrs. Telfer remained in Perth, and Miss Lock was appointed Matron of the Orphanage. Miss Baker had paid a visit to the West, and various conferences on the work had taken place with the West Australian Council. As time went on it was decided to transfer the Orphanage from East Perth to a suitable building that had been secured on the other side of the Swan River, near Victoria Park. Here the native children were further removed from the influences of the city, and the workers were able to exercise more thorough supervision. We were grateful indeed to our God for enabling us to establish Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage for the uplifting of these dear, despised little ones in the West.

After the work at the Orphanage had been well established, we felt it to be imperative that, without delay, something should be done for the neglected aborigines in the far north-west of the continent. Mr. Radford and the writer were in Wagin, on the southern railway, when the way opened for us to undertake our long-desired trip. Through the generosity of a friend who wished to remain unknown, a limited amount of money was placed at our disposal. We decided to make the trip overland with our bicycles, although many declared such a journey to be impossible. By the route we would have to travel Derby was at least two thousand miles distant, and there were no proper roads for any part of the journey. We were told that as we neared Derby there would be hostile natives, that there would be long stages without water, and that on account of the "three-cornered jacks" it would be impossible to do the journey with bicycles. Even some members of the Council thought we were attempting the impossible, but having set ourselves to the task, we were determined to see it through. Arrangements were made for Mrs. Telfer to stay in Perth during our absence, and several special meet-





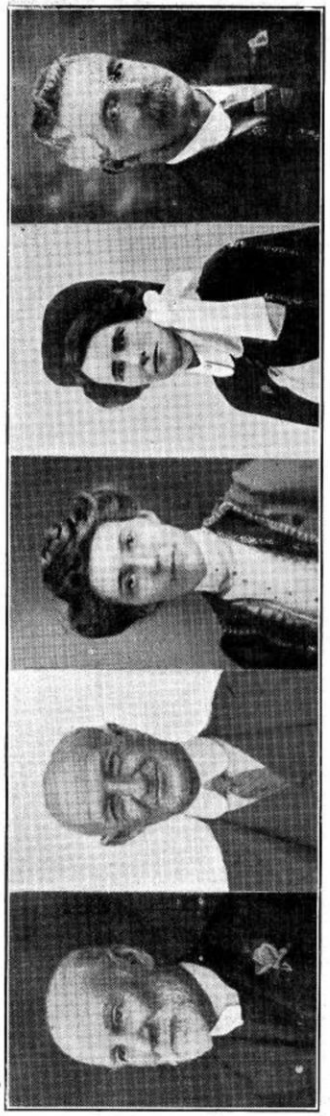
ings for prayer were held. We decided to make the first short stage of the journey by steamer, and accordingly booked our passage on the S.S. "Koombana," one of the most beautiful and up-to-date steamers in the Australian trade. Now, alas, she lies in Davy Jones' locker, having been overwhelmed in a terriffic willey-willey some months later. On May 4th, 1910, we left Fremantle, and were pleased to have as our companions in travel two Presbyterian missionaries, Dr. Yule and the Rev. Rankin. These brethren were also going north with a view to beginning work amongst the aborigines. Leaving the steamer at Carnarvon, we visited small companies of aborigines in the locality, and also a number of native prisoners in the Carnarvon gaol. We were not favourably impressed with the treatment of native prisoners, who were compelled to work in chains. Every morning, chained in pairs, they were marched to work guarded by an armed trooper.

Here we heard much of the lock hospitals that had been established by the Government on Bernier Island and Dorrie Island, the object being to isolate natives who had contracted disease as a result of their contact with degraded white men. These two islands are about thirty miles from the mainland, and through the courtesy of the officials on the Government launch, we were able to visit the settlement. The trip was rough, and the landing intensely amusing. We had to get ashore on an open beach in a deluge of rain. The writer accepted the invitation of a burly native to carry him ashore, and according to a pre-arranged plan, the native man poised himself on the bow of the boat, saying that as soon as the boat touched the beach he would jump overboard and that was to be my signal to jump on his back. It so happened that the boat struck the beach with a terrific crash which sent the poor fellow headlong into the water on all fours. Thinking it necessary to fulfil his part of

the contract, the writer immediately jumped on the back of the native; then, seeing the poor fellow was nearly drowned, it was necessary to jump into the water and help him ashore. We found that the Government was doing a very praiseworthy work on Bernier Island. The resident doctor and matron received us cordially, and gave us every opportunity to examine their work for the sufferers. About eighty women were being cared for, and many of them had been successfully treated. Those who were cured were allowed to return to their friends on the mainland, and the fact of their return removed the prejudice that had existed in the native mind against the Government scheme. We secured a number of interesting photographs on the island, and after gaining all the information available, we returned to the mainland. We made an attempt to visit Dorrie Island, but were not able to arrange for transport.

The writer arranged a lantern lecture in the public hall at Carnarvon, and a fine audience gathered and listened with surprise and evident interest to the story of the Mission's work amongst the aborigines. Before leaving Carnarvon we were introduced to Mrs. McLeod, of Manilya Station, and received a cordial invitation to spend some time at the station house. This we arranged to do, and we were glad indeed to find in the far north-west a godly Christian woman giving her time and talent to the training of a number of native girls. Several of these young women were splendidly trained in every kind of domestic service, and many other useful occupations. Also they had been given a musical education, and after tea at the station house we were entertained by a programme of classical music, one of the native girls playing the piano and the others singing. Best of all, they had been taught

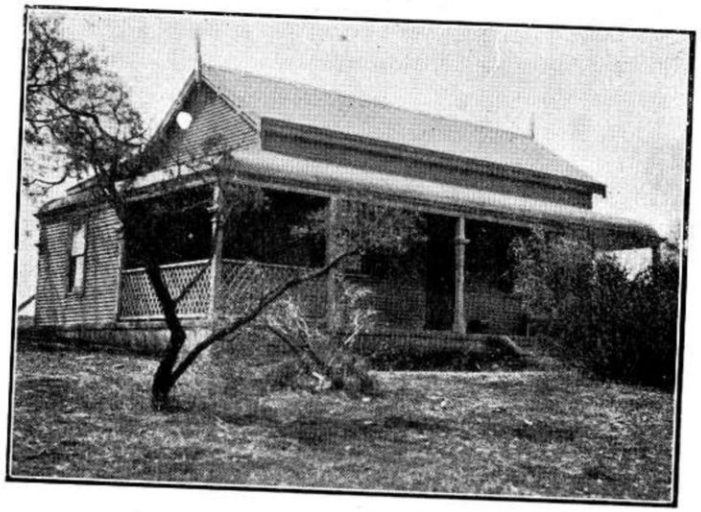




1. 2. 3. 4. 5.

Left to right: (1) Mr. L. Railton, Missionary, and afterwards Secretary; (2) Mr. W. W. Newman, Councillor, and Vice-President of State Council; (3) Miss Ethel Hamer, afterwards Mrs. J. W. Fryer, Missionary; (4) Miss L. Fowler, Matron of Bomaderry Children's Home, New South Wales; (5) Mr. J. W. Boden, Treasurer, New South Wales State Council.

Camel Expedition, 1927, Oodnadatta, W.A. Border.



The First Building, Colebrook Home, Quorn, S.A.





the precious truths of the Word of God, and some of them had yielded their lives to the Lord Jesus Christ.

As we started on the long, long trail from Carnarvon to Derby, we were warned again and again that such a journey was impracticable. About three miles out of town we met a mounted police constable, who informed us that we were the biggest fools on earth. In less than twenty-four hours we were convinced that he had spoken the truth. Our machines were very heavily loaded, the equipment including a large canvas water-bag, a fifty pound bag of flour, a small rifle for shooting game, a camera, and a few cooking utensils. We had conceived a plan for guarding against punctures from the three-cornered jacks, or double-gees, as they are sometimes called. We had our machines fitted with extra large tyres, and between the tyre and the tube we folded many thicknesses of heavy unbleached calico. The device was effective, as we accomplished the whole journey without a single puncture. After crossing the Gascoigne River, we had some long stretches of rough, dry, road, and twelve miles further on we made our first camp, the earth for our couch, and the sky for a canopy. Heavy rain fell that night, and the Gascoigne River, just behind us, was soon in full flood. It appeared that the heavy rains had just begun; indeed, to us it seemed like a cloud-burst, for in a few hours nine inches of rain had been registered between Carnarvon and Point Headland. We waded mile after mile through water and slush about knee deep. Sometimes for a few hundred yards there would be dry, sandy patches where we could ride, but late in the afternoon the water became deeper, and several times we were struggling through water nearly four feet deep. Then we came to some higher ground, and succeeded in finding sufficient wood for our camp fire. For this provision we were

indeed grateful to God, as we had been in cold water most of the day.

The next morning we encountered more flooded country, and about noon came to a creek of unknown depth, with the water flowing swiftly. It was impossible to cross, and we had to make a detour of nearly thirty miles through shallow water. It would be monotonous to describe our journey day by day, but for the first fortnight it was water most of the way. We were not dismayed, however, and by this time we began to enjoy it. Being wet through and covered with mud, we could not get any wetter or dirtier, so day after day we paddled on. Manilya Station was indeed a haven of rest, and glad indeed were the weary wayfarers to accept the generous hospitality of Mr. and Mrs. McLeod. Three days later we were on the road again, and we had better travelling to Winning Pool Telegraph Station. We now discovered that further north there had been no rain, and now, instead of the water, we had to traverse heavy sand for fifty miles. The first part of this stage was fairly level, and then came mile after mile of climbing over steep sand hills from thirty to forty feet in height. Our biggest day's journey after toiling from 4 a.m. to 8 p.m., was twelve miles. By night we slept on the soft sand, making our fires with spinifex—the only herbage in this inhospitable region. Then we entered some beautiful country covered with grass, and abounding in every kind of game—kangaroos, emus, turkeys, and cockatoos by the thousand.

Between Carnarvon and Onslow we met with numerous small companies of aborigines, and spoke to them concerning Christ. They seemed entirely ignorant of the Gospel, and when I asked one old aboriginal, who worked on a neighbouring station, if he knew anything about Christ, he replied, "That's what my boss say when he swear." Some of the native men in these parts were a fine physical type,





one man in particular being about six feet three inches in height, and proportionately broad and muscular. We met with genuine hospitality at most of the sheep and cattle stations, and many of these outback folk seemed to count it a privilege to replenish our food supplies, and help us in any way possible. At Onslow we stayed for a day to develop a number of negatives and clean our bicycles. Then we struck out for Roeburne, deviating from the telegraph line in order to escape the sand. Beautiful country this, covered with luxuriant grass, and supporting thousands of cattle. Here, too, we had better roads, but the disadvantage of a strong head wind which was constant for ten days. More aborigines were encountered at Peedamulla, Yarribilla, Murdie and Balmoral stations, and as often as possible we told them of God's Redeeming Love. Further on, the road was again very rough, and in places almost impassable, and there were long stretches without water. On two occasions we were in danger of perishing from thirst, and when one hot afternoon we threw ourselves down in the shade of some bushes, we were horrified to see, in less than half an hour, hundreds of crows drawing closer and closer to where we lay, some of them coming within a few feet, evidently anticipating a feast. We continued the journey, followed by "the cruel, carnivorous crows." They followed us till dark, then flew away to roost, while we roosted on the bare ground, with a tussock of spinifex for a pillow. At daylight the next morning we discovered that we had camped within a few hundred yards of a beautiful, broad stream, with ample wood for fires. At this "Elim" we camped and rested. Next day we met a number of aborigines engaged in a spear-throwing contest. We photographed them, and then held a brief service, some of them, we believe, hearing for the first time of Christ. They assured us that they always got "plenty tucker" and sometimes work for

"white fellow." Nearing Port Headland, we spent five hours one day pushing our bikes through ankle-deep sand against a thirty mile-per-hour gale. That night we slept on a spinifex couch at the base of Peewah Hill, a remarkable mountain of loose rocks, some two hundred feet in height; then for several succeeding days we travelled through a forest of ant-hills, which covered the plain for hundreds of miles, many of them from ten to fifteen feet high. More heavy rain brought a series of troubles. One evening, after wading through seven miles of water, we camped on a small bare patch, evidently provided by the One Who guided and guarded our course. Next day we had to wade through five rivers, waist deep, and in one of these we were almost overwhelmed. Through all this we were able to keep the camera dry, and we took several interesting photograhps of each other in embarrassing circumstances. Beyond Port Headland, the aborigines were more numerous, and we had many opportunities for getting in the Gospel message. No observer could look into the eyes of these unfortunate folk without being convinced that there is a sadness caused by something more than bodily hunger; a sadness which can be removed only by the comforting touch of Christ.

Continuing our journey northward, we arrived at Broome, called by some local residents "The Pearly City," on account of its main industry, that of pearl fishing. After the bare and desolate country surrounding Port Headland, the tropical vegetation in and around Broome was a delight to the eye. We spent a little time in resting and replenishing our supplies of food, then started on the last long stage of the journey to Derby. Once again we had difficulty in pushing our bikes through the heavy sand. We passed many miles of marshy country, where the mosquitoes were almost beyond endurance. On one occasion we were chased by a large herd of wild





cattle. Whether they were actuated by idle curiosity or had evil designs, we could not decide, but as they drew nearer we looked for a way of escape, but none was to be found, and we were just considering the possibility of climbing the telegraph poles when something startled the cattle and they rushed off in another direction. A little further on we came across a company of aborigines, and, finding they could speak English fairly well, we spent some time in talking to them about Christ and His power to save sinful men. To them it was a new, strange story, but as they listened their eyes glowed with interest, and we trust the Holy Spirit made plain the message. One evening we stopped to boil the billy beside Taylor's Lagoon, and were about to prepare our camp close to the water's edge when we remembered we were nearing the country where all the swamps and lagoons were infested with alligators. Therefore we went back several hundred yards into the forest and there settled down for the night. All through the night could be heard the cry of the plovers and the splashing of ducks in the lagoon; and towards morning a dingo came within a few yards of where we were lying and gave us his mournful greeting. Mr. Radford jumped up suddenly and fired the rifle while he was still half asleep, and, needless to say, the visitor escaped unscathed. Although it was near the middle of winter, the days were very hot. Long stages had now to be traversed without water, and one day an accident to one of our machines cost us the loss of our whole supply, so that before night we were well nigh famished. The timber in this region was different from anything we had seen below Port Headland, the most remarkable tree being the baob or baobab, which grows plentifully throughout the north of Australia.

Our next adventure was the crossing of the Fitzroy River, though fortunately the flood waters

had abated and the tide was running out. We had been warned of the danger from alligators, but still we had to cross, and, committing ourselves to God's care, we commenced to wade through the stream. Although the tide was running out, in one place the water was about three feet deep; and we now know that only a watchful Providence saved us from disaster, for at the same crossing a few days previously an alligator had seized a horse and so mutilated him that the poor beast had to be killed. Just beyond the Fitzroy River we came to Yeeda Station, and found we were within twenty-five miles of our destination. The remainder of the journey was a pleasant ride over almost level ground, and we were grateful indeed to God for His goodness in bringing us safely through. Many happenings by the wayside are still vivid in the memory. At one stage of the journey we were sorely tempted to abandon the trip and return by steamer to Perth, but that night, as we slept out under the starlit heavens, we seemed to have a token of God's promise that He would not forsake us. Awaking about 4 a.m., we saw the beautiful sight of Halley's Comet, and in that tropical region its brilliance was beyond description, and it appeared to fill the sky almost from horizon to horizon. That night to us the heavens declared the glory of God, and we felt assured that God would see us through to the end of the journey. Near Derby we found several large camps of aborigines, and these we gathered together in suitable centres. We are sure that many of them now heard the Gospel for the first time, and they eagerly received the message. Our next move was to arrange for an interview with Mr. Sid Hadley, who put before us a proposal that we should take over from him the work on Sunday Island. This project was prayerfully considered, and at a later date the transfer was effected. We decided to investigate the practicability of several schemes that had been pro-





pounded for work in the far north. Accordingly Mr. Radford returned with Mr. Hadley to Sunday Island, while the writer made several ventures into the territory north and east of Derby.

On one occasion about twenty aborigines, dressed only in war-paint, suddenly made their appearance among the trees, their spears pointing menacingly in my direction. Guided by some inspiration, the writer called out to them in the native language as used in the coastal districts of New South Wales, "Gnyndah warringah gniah boongittah binghi?" ("What are you going to fight your brother for?") The language in North-western Australia is totally different from that spoken in the eastern State, but we found that the word "binghi," meaning "brother," was understood by the old chief, who immediately called to his followers to lower their spears, which they did, and in less than half an hour they were gathered around in a ring, listening to the story of the One Who came to proclaim liberty to the captives, the old chief gesticulating and trying to explain to the others the meaning of the message. Several weeks later this old man came to a meeting near Derby and definitely accepted Christ as his Saviour. We were much impressed with the need of the natives in the various centres visited. They were very numerous in the vicinity of the De Gray River, and on Mr. McKay's station near Port Headland. We made plans to organise an expedition to travel with pack horses through to Wyndham, but this project did not materialise. We also investigated the possibility of work in the region of the Prince Regent River, Mount Barnett, and Hall's Creek. We were told that at Mount Barnett there were probably one thousand natives; they were very hostile, and cattle stealing on adjacent stations was prevalent. We discovered that there were several suitable spots for the establishment of a mission just beyond the King Leopold Ranges, but the

way did not open for us to penetrate into this locality. Mr. Radford spent about five weeks on Sunday Island with Mr. Hadley, after which he returned, and for some time carried on work amongst the aborigines at Derby. Services and classes were regularly held, with a good attendance. Every Sunday night the writer held a service for the white residents of Derby in the local School of Arts' hall, which was placed at our disposal without charge. In many places in the mid north-west the aborigines were badly treated by white settlers, one outstanding instance being a man who, posing as a protector of aborigines and receiving Government rations for old and helpless natives, used the rations himself and terrorised the aborigines with his revolver. In addition to this, he was convicted of revolting immorality, and in the public court at Derby, during our stay in that town, he was fined £50, which, in our judgment, was far too mild a punishment for one who treated defenceless natives in such a manner. The aborigines had a true champion and friend in Inspector Sellinger, the chief police officer in the north-west; he did much to better the conditions of the aborigines. As the way did not open for us to go further afield, we returned to Perth by steamer, and laid proposals for future work before the Perth Council.

In the meantime, the work at Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage was progressing, and from time to time neglected children were sent to the Home and cared for. A little later on it became necessary to secure a still larger building, a few miles from Victoria Park, where the work continued to prosper for several years. An extract from Miss Lock's report in November, 1910, reads: "The Lord is providing for and blessing us in the Home. We now have 16 orphans, and Miss Phillips and myself. We have just received into the Home a young woman with two children, a girl and a boy. The mother is but





17 years of age, and her little girl is four. Oh, how they need someone to help them! During September and October donations to the Home amounted to about fourteen pounds." In May, 1911, Miss Mantell was recognised as a fully accredited missionary, and proceeded immediately from Sydney to Western Australia, where she assisted in the work at the Orphanage. Other workers were added to the staff from time to time as the work extended. The new orphanage, still bearing the old name, and costing £530, was opened by the Premier of the western State, who spoke in the highest terms of the work of the Mission. "It is right," he said, "that the Government should allow the natives, who had been the original owners of the country, to spend the remainder of their days in good living conditions. Looking around at the happy faces of the Orphanage children seated near me, I cannot help remarking on their well-fed, well-dressed, and thoroughly well-cared-for condition. The work is God's work, and I wish the workers God-speed with it." The Chief Protector of Aborigines gave Miss Mantell a free pass to bring five additional neglected children from Busselton to the Home, and thus the work grew and prospered. Early in 1912 Miss Lock retired from the work at the Orphanage, and Miss Bertha Telfer, who had been missionary at Burnt Bridge, N.S.W., was appointed to fill the vacancy. Miss Lock visited a number of camps in the southern part of the State, and finally took up work at Katanning amongst the natives previously visited by the writer and Wandy.

Plans were being made for the settlement of missionaries on Sunday Island, and in March, 1912, Mr. H. Smith and Miss C. McQueen were united in marriage with a view to their undertaking work at this station. The wedding was celebrated in Adelaide by Revs. W. L. Morton and E. Bungay. Mr. and Mrs. Smith proceeded at once to the West, and

before the end of April were at work on Sunday Island, where they laboured for some time with Mr. Hadley. The work in the West, in spite of the initial difficulties, was launched at last, and in at least three centres was strongly established.



## CHAPTER X.

## BOMADERRY AND THE BAIRNS.

The title of this chapter is suggested by the remark of an old Scotch pioneer the writer met many years ago in Southern Queensland. "If your Mission wad tak the wee black bairns that are running wild in the bush and gie them a gude hame, I'd sell my swag and my auld socks and gie ye a donation." This kindly philanthropist went on his way along the bush track, carrying his swag and wearing his socks, but his words have lingered with us through the years. We prayed for the bairns, and the Lord gave us Bomaderry. In the recorded minutes of a meeting held in Sydney in August, 1908, is the following item:—"The president reported the completion of arrangements for Children's Home, a place having been secured at Bomaderry, Nowra district." Brief quotations from the "Aborigines' Advocate," published during succeeding months, indicate the progress and development of this new work. "The Home at Nowra is to be opened shortly. Seven children are waiting, others to follow. Miss Thompson, one of the missionaries, has been led to offer for work amongst the neglected children." "The home for children at Bomaderry will need to be increased in size if all the children within our reach are taken." "These little ones have to be fed, clothed, and trained for useful service, and our sisters, as they enter upon their new duties, fully realise the responsibility of the position, and earnestly solicit the prayerful sympathy of all who love the children's Friend." "A little lad, anxious to help in the new

work, nervously approached the president of the Mission and proffered sixpence, the reward for some service rendered. This was his gift to aid the work amongst the dark-skinned children. A little later the same lad emptied his purse, containing 10½d., into the hand of one of the workers, saying, 'That's for the Children's Home.' "

The first Home consisted of a cottage containing four rooms and a kitchen, with two and a half acres of land, but, as the work grew, other buildings were added. During the first year the Orphanage was firmly established, and much interest and practical sympathy was shown. The Nowra Municipal Council made a track from the main road to the Children's Home, and many valuable gifts were sent. Amongst those who took a deep interest in the work were Mrs. Hewlett, Mrs. Morwick, Mrs. Dobbie, and Mrs. Wilson. As the Christmas season approached, abundance of food, clothing and toys came to hand for the little ones. On one occasion there was great danger from a bush fire which raged nearby throughout the night, but a band of willing workers kept the devouring element from the Home.

In March, 1913, the Home sustained a great loss in the death of Rev. W. Dobbie, the honoured president of the Nowra Committee. His kindly presence and helpful messages to the workers and to the children were sorely missed. Prominent Christian men and women from Sydney visited Bomaderry from time to time, and mention is made in one report of the presence of Dr. Thomas Porter, Rev. Straughan, Messrs. Simpson, Morton and Tanner, and Mrs. Davey, from the Petersham Baptist Church. These friends were keenly interested, and, following on their return to Sydney, some useful gifts were sent to the Home. At one time the children did beautiful raffia work, but those in charge decided that it must be discontinued, as the little ones were only school children, and could not supply the demand





without being overworked. There were, by this time, two cottages at Bomaderry, with ten rooms in all, and people who seemed almost blind to the claims of the adult aborigines, had a warm place in their hearts for the native children.

The report presented at the third anniversary of the Orphanage emphasises the generous financial help given to the work by Mrs. Morwick, and points to the great possibilities of this new departure of the Mission's enterprise. Miss F. Caldwell, sister of Mr. D. H. Caldwell, was appointed in December, 1908, to assist at the Home, and here she laboured faithfully and fruitfully for several years. In March, 1912, Miss Caldwell was married to Mr. Harold Dixson, who had also been appointed as a missionary at Bomaderry. After their marriage they continued to render splendid service in the work at the Home until October, 1915, when they retired from the work of the Mission. The official report published under the above date contains the following reference:—"We regret that Mr. and Mrs. Dixson are leaving the Home. Our prayers are with them, and we trust they will always be in Christian work. We will miss them very much. Every thing around us speaks of the love and labour of these two workers, and we have found in them a proof that 'true worth is in being, not seeming; in doing each day that goes by some little good; not in the dreaming of great things to do by and bye.' "

In April, 1912, Miss L. H. Fowler began her work at Bomaderry, and on January 15th the following year was publicly set apart as a fully accredited missionary.

The annual report of the Home given at the third anniversary mentions the kindness of the Aborigines' Protection Board in giving half rations to each child, material to be made up for clothing, and supplying a little cripple inmate with a costly pair of boots. Additional accommodation was needed,

and one urgent necessity was a large dining-room. More beds were required to accommodate other children who were waiting to be taken in. In February, 1915, Miss Fischer came to assist in the work. At this time there were nineteen children in the Home, nine boys and ten girls, their ages ranging from fifteen months to fourteen years. About this time it was decided that the Home should be known as the "Hugh Morwick Aboriginal Children's Home," but at a later date, by the special request of Mrs. Morwick, the name was dropped, and the institution was again designated the "Bomaderry Children's Home." From time to time friends were interested to learn of the splendid accomplishments of the native children. They excelled in drawing, writing, arithmetic, and needle-work. On one occasion the eldest girl in the Home received a special prize at a show in Nowra for home-made bread. This prize was a 25lb. bag of flour, and, coming at a time when supplies were low, it seemed to be the Lord's provision for the little ones. A report of the work written in December, 1916, contains the following:—"The sweetest thought that comes to us as we look back is that during the year eight of the children have accepted the Lord Jesus Christ as a personal Saviour. We believe their names have been recorded in the Lamb's Book of Life. Some of these have been inmates since the opening of the Home." It is truly interesting to study the psychology of the children. Their intelligence cannot always be gauged by the volubility of their conversation, as the following incident will indicate. A little full-blood boy, nine years of age, for some time after he came to the Home, could not be persuaded to speak a word to any one; but evidently he had a store of knowledge, obtained during his brief life in the bush. The Matron and some of the elder children were speaking about a certain kind of wood they were using for the fire; and, noting it was hard to





burn, and went black as soon as taken from the fire, the Matron had a piece of the wood in her hand, and said to the children, "I wonder what kind of wood this is?" Instantly the little nine-year-old bushman found his tongue, and this is what he said, "Blood-wood, Misses, you goat." A tiny girl, who had never known her parents, asked the Sister, "Was my mother black or white?" The Sister replied that she could not tell her because she did not know, to which the little mite replied, "I don't mind what colour she was so long as I meet her in heaven." A native mother far away in the bush died, and left a wee baby a few hours old. The husband, having the care of three other little ones, never came to claim the baby. The missionary in charge of the Children's Home was sent for, and the little one became an inmate. She was very delicate for some time, but later improved wonderfully. Her favourite chorus was, "Hallelujah, He's my Friend, what if sorrow comes to-morrow, Hallelujah. He's my Friend." One day she was taken very ill, and her first request was to be carried in to prayers, that she might hear her favourite chorus. It is indeed worth while to win these little ones for Christ. Many of them come to us from the camps of sin, and from homes which cannot be called home.

There were many faithful helpers whose names should be recorded. Mr. McArthur, at one time local secretary, was a firm friend of the Children's Home, and never failed in his loving ministry to the workers and the children. Mr. James Morton, vice-president of the Central Council, was a frequent visitor, and was dearly loved by the children. Many friends who visited the Home first became interested through Mr. Morton. Mr. and Mrs. Calder were untiring in their work at the Home. Mr. Calder was never happier than when doing something to improve the buildings. Mr. Mark Morton presented the Home with a corner block of land,

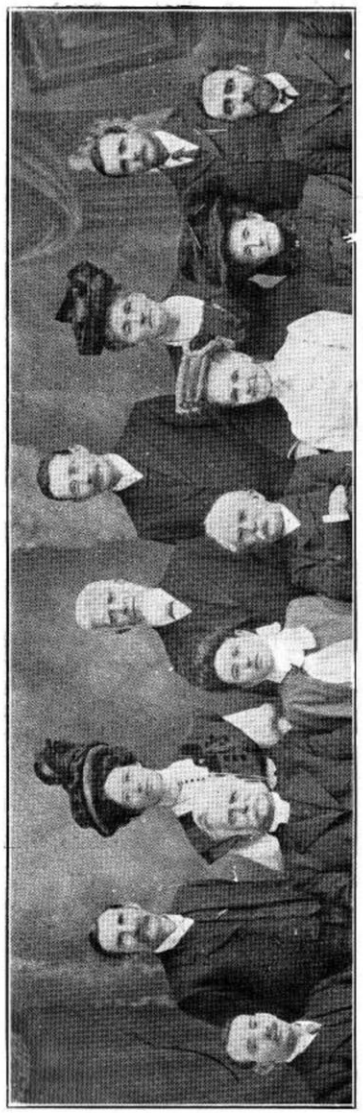
facing the point where the two roads met, and in many other ways assisted in the work. In October, 1917, Miss Finlayson, of Tasmania, was accepted as a worker, and stationed at the Home. It was at once evident that she was suited for the work amongst the children, and for many years the influence of her sterling Christian character has been felt by all who have come in contact with her in her ministry of love.

As the work amongst the children grew and continued to prosper, much valuable service was rendered by the local visiting committee, and the reports of the Home contain many references to goods provided for the various needs of the Home through the instrumentality of this band of earnest workers. The reports published from time to time in the Mission's magazine reveal the fact that a widespread interest was taken by churches and C.E. societies, not only in Sydney, but in country districts throughout the whole of the State. We read of numerous parcels of clothing, bed-linen, groceries, meat and vegetables being received from various localities. One report speaks with gratitude of a special donation of £66 as part of the purchase price of one of the cottages; then we read of another small cottage being purchased for £175. A Christian lady, deeply interested in the work, sent along a substantial cheque monthly, and, in addition, a special donation of £40. Five years after the establishment of the Home, twenty-five children were being cared for.

Some of the children sent to the Home were in a very weak condition, suffering keenly from malnutrition. One report reads: "For seven weeks we were privileged to have the care of a little motherless baby, who, from the first, crept into the hearts of all. We loved him dearly, but on January 13th God took him. Although missing his sweet little presence, we know it is better so."

In 1914 a disused Mission House was brought from Roseby Park to Bomaderry, and utilised as a





THE FIRST WEST AUSTRALIAN COUNCIL.

**Left to right: Front Row**—Rev. Donald McLean, Rev. Lockhart Morton, Miss Oldray, Rev. W. Burridge, Mrs. Fox Angelo, Mrs. Z. H. Sanders, Mr. C. A. Hall.
**Back Row**—Rev. S. T. Pittman, Miss Roach, Rev. Silas Mead, Mr. E. J. Telfer, Mrs. Selby, Mr. E. V. Radford.

**Mrs. E. J. Telfer.**
First Matron of the Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage.
**Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage, East Perth, W.A.**

**Bunny, Una, and Lily.**
As they appeared when they first came to Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage from 900 miles inland.

Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage, removed to Victoria Park





boys' dormitory. About this time, attention was publicly drawn to the capabilities of the native children by an aboriginal boy from the Wellington district winning a much-coveted gold medal, awarded for the composition of an original story. The story reads as follows:—

**"The Eagle and the Crow."**

"The aborigines say that two hundred years ago the eagle had webbed feet, and that the crow was white. The eagle envied the crow because he was white, and the crow envied the eagle because he could swim. One day an eagle and a crow were travelling together, and about dinner-time they got hungry. Then the eagle said to the crow, 'Look, there is an opossum in that tree.' The crow said, 'How shall we get him?' The eagle said, 'You are the smallest; do you see that hollow in the tree where the opossum is? You go up in that hollow, and when the opossum jumps out I will kill him.' So the crow went up the hollow, and when the crow was inside the tree the eagle gathered up bushes and bark and lit a fire in the hollow, and then went away. When the crow had come out of the hollow, the smoke had turned him real black. For twelve months the crow went round about looking for the eagle, and at last he found him. Then the crow said to the eagle, 'You know twelve months ago, you got me to climb up into a hollow tree for an opossum, and when I was in the hollow of the tree you lit a fire. Now look at me, how black I am; but I hold no grudge against you—we are still friends.' So night came on, and the eagle went to sleep; then the crow got up, and went into the bush, and he saw a kangaroo rat's nest, and he got some sharp bones and stuck them into the middle of the nest, leaving the sharp points sticking up. In the morning the crow said to the eagle, 'I know where there is a kangaroo rat's nest.' So he took him to the place. Then the eagle said, 'How shall we get the kangaroo

rat?' The crow said, 'You have the biggest feet, you jump on the nest.' So the eagle jumped on the kangaroo rat's nest, and the bones stuck into his feet, and tore the webs into pieces. Then the crow walked away, saying, 'Ah, you know, twelve months ago, what you did to me.' So since that time the eagle always has long claws, and all crows are black."

It will be helpful here to quote the story of "Ken" as told by Matron Fowler. It reads as follows:—

"One would not think, to look at the accompanying photo of little Ken, that there was anything pathetic about his babyhood. But Ken was not always the bonny boy he is now. In July, 1927, we received a letter from the wife of the manager at Ulgundahi Island, on the Clarence River, asking us whether we would take a motherless baby boy into the Home. The young father, though loth to part with him, was unable to give him the necessary care. Yes, we could take him, arrangements having been made with the Aborigines' Protection Board, and it was agreed that the writer should make the journey and bring back the baby. One feels that it would not be out of place just here to voice our appreciation of the Aborigines' Protection Board in the matter of transport of native children, whether to situations, hospitals, or homes. All expenses are met by them, and every consideration shown to escort and charges.

**A Frail Mite.**

"Never shall I forget my first look upon that little wasted form and pinched face. I had seen some sick, wasted babies, but never one like that, and a swift, silent prayer went up for grace and guidance. A week was spent in happy fellowship with the matron and manager, and we were glad to get this insight into station life; then, the baby being slightly improved, the journey back was un-





dertaken. Twenty hours by car and train—a trying journey with a sick baby, but the presence of the Lord was with us, and friends were raised up for us along the way. Upon arrival in Sydney we went to the home of Mr. Colebrook, which was, and still is, at the time of writing, a home in the truest sense of the word for missionaries. All through Sunday we watched and nursed the frail wee baby, Mrs. Colebrook giving us advice and encouragement from her own experience. On Monday morning we travelled the ninety-two miles to Bomaderry, taking our little charge straight from the train to the doctor. When he remarked that the little bundle in our arms, two months old, weighing scarcely 5lbs., looked like a person seventy years of age, we could not contradict him. As the days went by, we were often told, and indeed we ourselves thought, that we had brought him home to die; but God ruled otherwise. One night our hearts were just lifted up to Him in prayer for money to supply special needs for the child. Next day the answer came—a letter from the junior members of the Boomerang Club. 'We were so interested,' runs the letter, 'when we heard of little Ken a month ago, that we have sent ten shillings to buy something special for him; and we will send 10/- each month as long as he needs it.' Three years ago, and Ken, now so well, no longer needs it; but that love gift is still coming for other little needy ones who have followed on. Interest in the Master's work is thus created and maintained. Praise His name!

"Much more could be told of the gracious hand of God in the life of this little one, but the question comes to us, 'Why has this little life been spared? What is the future of this jolly, brown-eyed, dark-skinned Australian laddie, who has a very just claim upon Australia, and yet is likely to be despised and looked down upon because he is an aboriginal child? Has God saved him to be a blessing to his own

people? We are believing to this end. Ken is only one of many who are crying from all parts of this fair land of Australia, 'Come over and help us.' Christian reader, what are you doing to help on the work of rescuing and evangelising the native boys and girls of Australia? What will you do to help and save them?"

The workers at the Bomaderry Home have been of the highest character, and most efficient. It would of course be impossible to name all who have rendered service in this direction, but Miss Fowler was for very many years the mainstay of the work, and filled the position of Matron in a most capable manner; when her mother became ill and required her services in 1933, she had reluctantly to relinquish the position.

Miss A. V. Darby entered the service of the Mission in January, 1931, at La Perouse, and was afterwards transferred to Bomaderry; she was appointed Acting Matron of the Home in October, 1933, and later Matron, and has retained the position with much ability, up to the present.



## CHAPTER XI.

## THE "FAR-FLUNG" FIELDS.

At this stage of our story the work had spread to many widely-separated fields throughout the continent, and self-sacrificing workers were strenuously toiling at their individual tasks. The work in the West had been firmly established. Initial work had been undertaken in South Australia, and in this latter State great developments were soon to take place. Throughout New South Wales missionaries were toiling in the various centres of Aboriginal population, and many of the dark people had been won for Christ. Christian Endeavour societies and other kindred organisations had been established in many centres, and on some stations the aborigines themselves were contributing liberally to the support of the work.

In March, 1911, the writer and Mrs. Telfer resigned from the missionary staff, and although the request to continue came to us several times, we felt we were acting in the will of God. Shortly afterwards the writer entered the Baptist ministry, and accepted the pastorate of a church in South Australia; and at a later date held several charges in Tasmania and New South Wales. We are glad to say, however, that the interest in the work amongst the aborigines did not decline, for once one knows and loves the native people the sympathetic interest must continue.

The work in the West continued to grow, the number of children in Dulhi-Gunyah Orphanage increased rapidly, and several times the Home had to

be enlarged. Other workers were sent from New South Wales, and aggressive work was undertaken in several centres along the great Southern railway line to Albany. In New South Wales the work at the many stations previously mentioned went steadily ahead. The station at Ulgundahi Island, on the Clarence River, became the centre of a splendid work amongst the people. Workers from the Maclean Presbyterian Church were constant in helping and inspiring the missionaries for many years. At Lawrence. Miss Drummond continued her work after her companion and helper, Miss Jaggers, had entered mission work in India. Only Eternity will reveal the value of the faithful work of these voluntary workers. At Cabbage Tree Island, on the Richmond River, Miss Black (afterwards Mrs. D. H. Caldwell), continued her loving ministry. Another station which should be mentioned is Ngoorumba, near Stoney Creek. Excellent work was accomplished amongst the children, and the Sunday school was an example of what can be done for these bright, intelligent, dusky boys and girls. At Nucoorima, Mr. A. W. Setchell demonstrated the advantage of consecrated thoroughness in every part of the work.

In this chapter we must record briefly some definite facts with regard to the changed lives of the native people as a result of their acceptance of Christ and His Gospel. We must mention Mrs. George Timbury, for many years one of the brightest of the La Perouse Christians. For about twelve years she demonstrated her practical faith in Christ by following closely in His footsteps. She is described by one of the missionaries who was intimately associated with her during the period as "one who ventured her all upon Jesus and never once turned back." Another of the native Christians, speaking of Mrs. Timbury's life, said, "Janie was always a good girl. She and I gave our hearts to the Lord about the same time, and since her conversion she





has never lost sight of Jesus. Her prayers always touched me deeply, for she always cried out to her Heavenly Father for the salvation of the neglected natives of Australia. She mourned over the sin of the unsaved ones, and was grieved at those who looked for their own pleasure and profit on the Lord's Day. Janie was a real Christian." For years she was secretary of the La Perouse Christian Endeavour Society. This testimony was confirmed by missionaries and native people alike. She witnessed a good confession before many witnesses. In a quiet, confident way she talked to God, and many times the missionaries have been inspired and uplifted as a result of her simple pleading. Just one instance may be recorded to show the intense reality of her Christian life, and the passion that possessed her soul for the salvation of her own people. Speaking of their condition in God's sight, she exclaimed, "I would willingly die if by my dying the people at La Perouse would accept Jesus." Her utterance seemed to be prophetic, for soon after this the Lord took her to Himself, and her Home-call was most certainly the means in God's hands of bringing a number of the dark people to Christ. During her brief illness she had no fear of death. She dearly loved her husband and her two children, and just before the call came, in February, 1912, she sent him a farewell message. Much more could be said of the genuine Christian work of this dear soul. She walked with God, and God took her.

Illustrating the lack of consideration for the aborigines in some quarters, we quote the following extract from the Mission's Magazine of March, 1912, under the title of "Buried Coffinless".—"A telegraphic par. in Monday's Sydney 'Morning Herald' tells that an aboriginal died at Byron Bay recently. He was wrapped in a blanket (the report says), buried in the sand, with sand for his pillow. Not

worth a coffin. Some day human bones will be unearthed, and an enquiry by a coroner necessary. Probable verdict: 'Only an aboriginal.' "

From one of our mission stations a dark woman recently went to the city, taking with her a little gift of her own handiwork for one whom God had led to be kindly disposed to Australia's native people. On leaving again for her home, the dark woman was given a present by this friend, as a token of love. The gift was expressly stated to be for herself, but she quietly determined in her own heart to share it with the missionary, and perhaps others on the mission station. Returning home, she found things all wrong and unexpected trouble everywhere. She felt discouraged and lonesome, but was led to prostrate herself before God in prayer, giving thanks for the gift she had received, and asking for comfort and cheer. She arose from her knees with her heart filled with peace through her communion with God. Visiting the house of another native Christian, she shared the gift she had received, and then went to the mission house. That day the missionary was ill, and had retired to her room, where she was found by the dark woman referred to. "Here, sister," she said to the missionary, "is something nice I brought for you to eat." The missionary was too ill to take the food, so the dark woman waited quietly by her bedside for a time, and then rose to leave. "Before I go," she said to her missionary, "I would like to pray with you," and suiting the action to the word, she fell upon her knees by the missionary's bedside, and offered a beautiful prayer for the restoration of God's servant. The missionary was deeply moved, and dates a richer Christian experience from that moment.

The following is an essay by an aboriginal girl published some years ago in the A.B.M. Review. The Bishop of Carpentaria had sent a letter to the native children describing the Coronation service. The





letter was read to the children, and the lesson given. Six months later they were asked to write an essay on the subject of what they had previously heard. One little aboriginal girl of twelve wrote as follows: "The Coronation is a religious service which is conducted by the Archbishop of Canterbury, and all the men belonging to the British Empire, from India, Canada, South Africa, and Australia, came to the service, which took place in the oldest church in London, Westminster Abbey, where all the Kings of England have been crowned. First of all, the Archbishop takes the King and presents him to the people, north, south, east and west, and all the people cry, 'God save King George.' Then the King takes a solemn oath to rule his kingdom in the right way. Then the Archbishop anoints the King on the head, breast, and hands, as the kings of old were anointed. Then the King is dressed in an ancient dress of a bishop to show that his work is a sacred one. Then he receives the orb and sceptre, as the sign of his kingship, and then a sword is taken from the altar and given him so that he may govern in the right way, and do justice. Then he is given a ring to show that he is married to his work for life. Then the crown is put upon his head, and all the people cry, 'Amen.' The Queen is then crowned by the Archbishop of York, and the King and Queen come to the Holy Communion, first taking off their crowns, and all the people sing the Te Deum, and the great service comes to an end."

Although this description may not be correct in every detail, it is an illustration of the keen intellect and marvellous memory of the aboriginal children. Instances of this kind could be multiplied indefinitely.

As an instance of the enlightenment of mind that has come to the aborigines through the preaching of the Gospel, we invite the reader to contrast

the following episodes connected with the aborigines of the Clarence River, N.S.W. In March, 1898, there appeared in "Science" an article by John F. Small, of the Clarence River, whose father was one of the first squatters in that district, and was distinguished for his friendship for the aborigines, who on two occasions saved his life in a remarkable manner, at the risk of losing their own. It is a true description of their ignorance and hopelessness with regard to death and the future life, and we have ourselves seen the same weird practices in other localities.

"When a man dies, he is immediately tied, hands and feet, slung on a pole, and carried away to the chosen burial place. On the way to the grave, the 'Yooloorie' (old men and tribal teachers) walk beside the corpse, and instruct it how to act in the world of spirits. This realm of disembodied spirits is an article of faith, and to that Elysium they believe that the soul departs after sojourning on earth for three nights, assuming various forms of birds and beasts. This strange doctrine of metempsychosis is a portion of the creed of many aboriginal tribes. On arrival at the grave the corpse is placed in a sitting position, covered with saplings and bushes, over which earth is piled and made perfectly smooth, the mould being reduced to the fineness of flour. The grave is then encircled by a length of native string, to prevent the spirit escaping and visiting the camp. For three mornings the grave is visited and carefully examined, and the smallest crevice is filled in so as to imprison the spirit while sojourning on earth. During these ceremonies, and for several days afterwards, the women engage in the most dismal lamentations, and inflict wounds on head and body until covered with blood. If a woman dies there is no mourning, and no nightly crying, for they believe that women have no souls, and for them there can be no resurrection. After the period of mourning





for a dead man, the camp is removed, and all weapons and trinkets of the dead are consumed by fire."

The writer has a very vivid memory of another scene in which the principal actors were members of this same Clarence River tribe. For several years they had been resident at one of the mission stations, and had gained an experimental knowledge of Christ as Saviour, Friend, and Guide. They had learned from the Word of God, through the teaching of the missionary, that there is Eternal Life for all who are in Christ, and that death has no sting for the believer. They had learned that men and women alike were dear to the heart of God, and that concerning the children, the Lord Jesus Christ had said, "Of such is the Kingdom of Heaven." The occasion was the burial of a little aboriginal girl who had died suddenly under sad and tragic circumstances. A week before we had all heard her baby laughter ringing through the camp. There was no hysterical crying, and no wild, weird wailing at night, as had been their custom a few years before. The whole settlement seemed to be pervaded by the hush of quiet grief, for this attractive little child had been loved by all; yet they did not sorrow as those without hope. The missionary, Bible in hand, led the way to the spot where a little grave had been dug in the shade of a spreading gum-tree. The tiny coffin, pure white, and heaped with garlands of the beautiful bridal blossom gathered from the surrounding bush, was carried by four native girls from the mission Sunday school, their dark hair falling over the shoulders of the white frocks they wore. Immediately following the bearers came the native father and mother, walking, we remember, hand in hand, and behind them perhaps a hundred of the local aborigines. The little coffin now reposed above the open grave, and the dark people are assembled. Breathlessly they listen to those matchless words of Scripture, "I am the Resurrection and the Life: He

that believeth in Me, though he were dead, yet shall he live." Presently the little casket is lowered into the grave, amidst the stifled sobs of many who stood by. Suddenly the voice of the mother is heard, not the hopeless wail of former days, but a simple request to the missionary, "Mr. Telfer, let 'em sing the song you taught us about 'precious blossom.'" The tune was started, and many of those around the grave joined in, the rich soprano voices of some of the native women giving a new touch of expression to the sublime words:

"When we see a precious blossom that we tended
with such care,
Rudely taken from our bosom, how our aching hearts
despair;
Round its little grave we linger till the setting sun is
low,
Feeling all our hopes have perished with the flower
we cherished so.
We shall sleep, but not forever: there will be a
glorious dawn;
We shall meet to part—no, never, on the Resurrection morn."

As we are writing this story, news comes to hand of the home-call of one of the native people who stood by that little grave and joined in that triumphant song thirty years ago. We saw her recently, and her faith was firmly fixed in Christ alone. Now, we believe, she joins in the triumphant song of the redeemed.

It was the writer's intention to close this chapter with the above story, but there comes insistently before the mind another picture from our own experience among the aborigines. It is horrible and repulsive, but it is true. Another little baby girl, about the same age as the "precious blossom" referred to above. In a filthy camp in the far north, lying upon a damp sheet of bark, her emaciated





body speaking eloquently of starvation, she died, we believe, in a spasm of croup. The old medicine man of the tribe, who must be obeyed at all costs, hearing the noise she made, declared that she was full of "debil, debil," and must "stop alonga camp." The camp was moved to a place some miles distant, the mother being compelled to abandon her dead child for the reason given above. Hearing of what had happened, early next morning a more enlightened member of another tribe went to investigate, and found a number of the camp dogs had returned, and were fighting over the remains of the body.

Why tell these revolting things? Just because they are true, and the careless, disinterested members of the Church of Jesus Christ ought to know that the dark places of the earth, even in Australia, are still full of the habitations of cruelty. There is no hope for the Australian aborigines except through the purifying power of the Gospel of Christ. In the "far-flung fields" the work is still going on, but in order to cope with the tremendous problem there must be more missionaries, more Spirit-led intercession, and more Spirit-prompted, systematic, sacrificial giving.

## CHAPTER XII.

## GLEANINGS OF THE GREAT HARVEST.

The records of the work of the Mission through the succeeding years show many remarkable instances of the power of God in the lives of the aborigines. The reports from station after station tell of the conversion of men and women whose past lives have been one long story of degradation and defeat. For some years very encouraging work was carried on at Erambie, near Cowra, N.S.W., and one very striking report tells of the conversion of eight prominent characters at the Mission. Several of these converts demonstrated by their changed lives the power of Christ to save and keep. The missionary at that station also reports very encouraging work at Goolagong, twenty-six miles from Cowra. From Dinbee Willea, New Angledool, very encouraging reports were received of great spiritual blessing in a very difficult work. The writer well remembers his first visit to the big camp of natives in this far north-western district, of the squalid conditions, and evident low standard of morality; and never can he forget how eagerly they gathered for a Gospel service, and how deeply they were moved by the message they then heard for the first time. What a change to read in later reports of a band of converted men and women gathering consistently for public worship, and actively engaged in winning others for Christ.

We must speak in the highest terms of the splendid service of Mr. and Mrs. Jago. These devoted missionaries laboured loyally both in New





South Wales and in Western Australia. In the latter State, both Morgans and Sunday Island benefited by this consecrated service. At a later period, Mr. and Mrs. Jago spent several years at the Bomaderry Home, and here, too, they are lovingly remembered by all who were associated with that work.

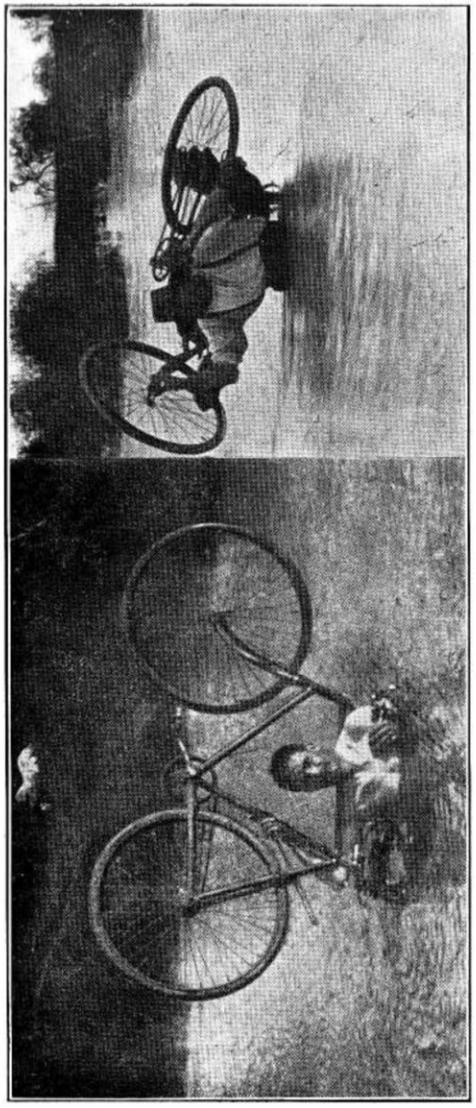
We have previously mentioned the devotion of Mr. and Mrs. Playford to the cause of the aborigines. Over an extended period, Mr. Playford was Vice-President of the Central Council. He was one who did not seek the limelight, but laboured in a quiet and steadfast spirit, demonstrating his practical Christianity in countless acts of loving service. We are glad to be able to publish with this chapter an excellent block of Mr. and Mrs. Playford, and also one of Mr. and Mrs. Jago.

We have before us the portion of a dairy written by Miss Lock during her stay at Katanning. This illustrates the "many-sidedness" of a missionary's life. Several quotations are here given:—"Most of my time was taken up with two little sick children, but between medicine time and feeding time I gave the adults' school for two or three hours." "To-day I got all the children to meet at my room at half-past two; the girls were dressed in white, and the boys wore white coats. Then I got them to march in twos up to town to the Church of England, where Mr. Webb gave them a Gospel address on Jesus crucified." "To-day when I got home from work, I received a telegram asking me to go to Wagin, where a native woman had just died. I got a trap and pair of ponies for the forty-mile journey. A dark woman and her husband, and a little girl I am looking after, went with me. We started at half-past seven, and travelled until one o'clock on Sunday morning, when we stopped to give the horses a rest. We made a big fire, put our rugs on some bushes, and had a cup of tea. Then we had four hours' rest, and started on our journey again at 4.30 a.m., arriv-

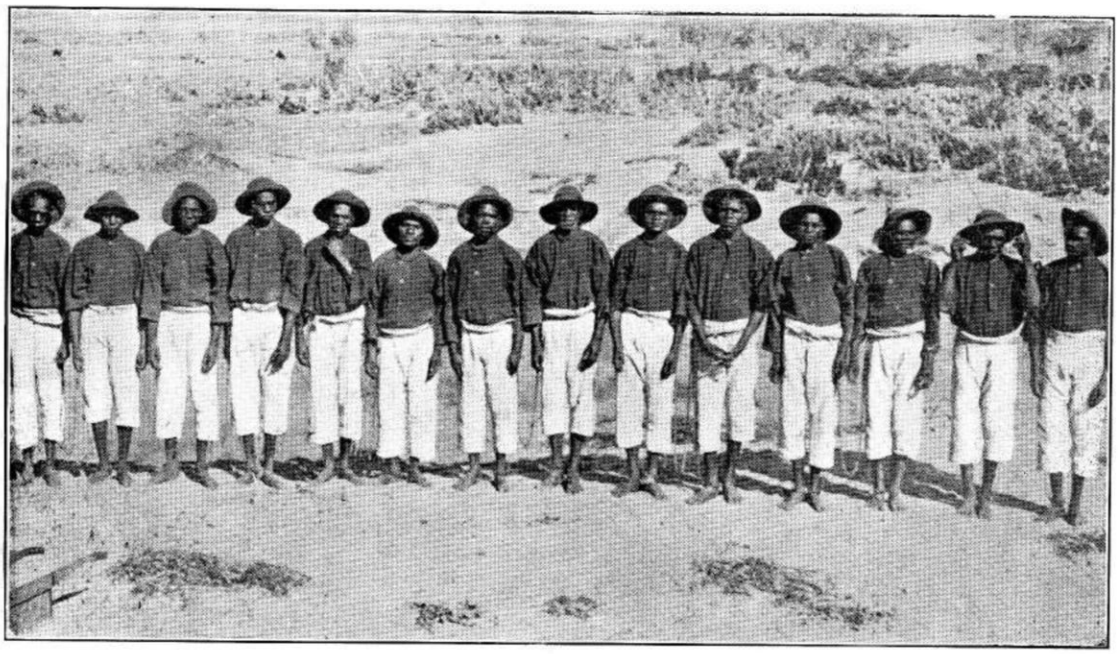
ing at Wagin at 7.30. After comforting the bereaved, I visited the police station to make burial arrangements. One little girl and two boys are left motherless. We tried to get them, but did not succeed." "At 12.30 to-day, we started our journey to Wagergarut, ten miles distant, to find some dark people. There were forty at the spot. They saw the little dark girl who was with me, clinging to my skirt, and one of them said, 'You must love us people to have that little one running after you. It seems so funny that a white woman should care for us.' Later we were invited to another camp by one who said, 'We would like to hear of Jesus.' My driver started the three-mile journey, arriving there at midnight. We got to sleep at 2 a.m., rose at 7 a.m., and had a service in the kitchen, there being twenty-five present. They listened attentively, and then one of them got up and said, 'Now we'll take up a collection.' They did so, and handed me 2/3 for my expenses. They begged me to come again, saying, 'We do want to learn religion.' Next came breakfast of home-made bread, butter, jam, kangaroo, and a cup of tea. We got to Woodnellin at half-past seven, and camped for the night." "We started our journey to-day at 4 a.m., and, arriving at Katanning, found a little boy had died at the mission. He was buried without a minister, and no one seemed to care." "Little baby very ill to-day. They came for me, and I stayed with them all night. At 2.30 a.m. the child passed away in my arms. I got home at 5 a.m., had two hours' rest, and made arrangements for burial. Miss Fultner came and sang, 'Safe in the arms of Jesus.'" The next quotation is very brief. It reads as follows: "Pulled out eight teeth for a little girl, a dentist having left the forceps."

Another record tells of a visit of Miss Fowler to a camp of aborigines on the bank of the Darling River, New South Wales. We summarise the story as follows:—"There are two families of dark folk





Missionaries on the March.



**Native Prisoners, who work in chains.**
(Photo by E. J. Telfer, near Carnarvon).

**Bomaderry and the Bairns.**

"Ken."





here. They have not moved to the reserve because Tyson, a full-blood aboriginal, who is said to be 100 years old, was too ill to be moved." "Since my return, Tyson has passed away, and has been buried according to native custom. He could not speak much English, but could understand a little at a time what I said to him. He lay in his mia mia of old blankets with a fire in front, and rain or shine, he would not be moved. In one tent we found a full-blood, named Louie, both herself and her tent being nice and clean. She had profited by missionary influence. In another rude shelter, Charlie and Mary, husband and wife, were lying very ill by the fire. Mary is said to be over 100 years of age. Her first words were, 'O my gal, I'm glad to see you.' As we watched the old couple and spoke to them, we felt sad indeed to think they were ending their days under such conditions. At another camp we held a meeting, and some of the children sang for us, shyly but very sweetly, a number of hymns they had been taught. I had to hurry away, but oh! how I felt I would like to gather up these little ones and bring them to our Bomaderry Home, that they might be trained for something better."

Miss Bertha Telfer, writing from La Grange Bay, beyond Broome, North-West Australia, told in thrilling language of her work in that remote district. "There were only about twenty aborigines at Derby, and the police told me of the crowds of natives at La Grange Bay, and of their need, so I determined to come and see for myself. It was a very difficult place to reach, as I had to stay a fortnight in Broome waiting for a boat. I took the opportunity of visiting the gaol, where they always have a crowd of native prisoners. It would make your heart ache, as it did mine, to see the aborigines all lying on the hard floor of the iron-barred cage, with leg irons on, and chained to one another. On Sunday I took my little organ into the prison yard, went round

to every cell, and invited all the prisoners to the service. The gaoler kindly let them out, and they gathered round. They seemed most of all to enjoy the music and the singing. There were at that service, besides white men, Chinese, Japanese and Malays. The aborigines were not allowed out, but crowded as near as their chains would permit. They listened attentively to all I had to say, and, when it was over, asked for more singing, more music, and more talk.

"It took me three days and nights to get to La Grange Bay from Broome. It was a tiny sailing schooner, and everybody on board was intoxicated, except myself, of course. They landed me at a place called Cape Bossett, and the man who was to drive me to La Grange Bay was not able to get away till next day, and there I had to camp, alone on that desolate shore. I had brought food from Broome, so had plenty to eat. In the morning I set off for the twelve-mile journey to La Grange. It was a deep sand track, and the journey took six hours. There are only four white people at La Grange—the postmaster, the linesman, the policeman, and Mr. Price, an old man in charge of the relief station. He doles the Government rations to the old and helpless natives, and he seemed to think that I had come to do him out of his job. I am the first missionary that has ever been seen in this part, and I am looked upon as a great curiosity. I have listened to heart-breaking stories of the cruelty perpetrated upon some of the dark people, who have had their little ones torn from them in order that someone else might get gain. The natives have no redress, and nobody else cares. This has gone on for a long time, but I shall see that there is no more work done like that while I am here. The postmaster was very kind to me. The white men around here have apparently put God out of all their thoughts. There are no Christians. One man said I might camp on his property, provided it





was not near his well. I got some natives to help me, and we put up a temporary mission house. It is 20ft. by 20ft., built of bushes, and plenty of fresh air gets through the crevices. I wish you could have seen the natives building under my direction the first house they ever built. One of the natives, whose name is Timothy, made me a table, on which I am now writing; he also made the chair upon which I am sitting. I wish you could see your poor missionary now, living in this sweltering heat, eaten by mosquitoes and sand flies. There is a great work to be done here. The natives have absolutely no knowledge of God; they are degraded and diseased. Do you think there will be any missionaries to spare for this needy part during this year? Yours in His happy service."

In a later communication, Miss Telfer (the writer's big sister) tells more about her work and its difficulties:—"La Grange Bay is, I believe, the place where the Lord would have me labour at present. The natives are to be counted in thousands, scattered over a wide area of country. The greatest difficulty will be to get them together, for they have no abiding city. They are all absolutely heathen, and have no idea of God. We have a post office, but only two mails during the year, in November and in May. A white woman is indeed a curiosity. They just gather round and stare at me, and, while they stare, I preach to them of Christ. It is lovely to be in a place like this, and how the Lord can provide, even in the desert! I often wonder in what fresh way He is going to manifest His loving favour. Walking along the beach a few days ago, watching the natives catch fish, a woman brought me a lot of whiting. She could not understand my words of thanks, but was greatly pleased at my acceptance of her gift. I wish you could see my house—it is built of boughs, is nice and cool, and guaranteed not to keep out the rain. An old man camps not far

away with his two wives, and the three seem to think it is their special mission to 'Look out longa white missus.' They do all they can for me, and in return I feed them, and talk to them of Christ. Oh, how they listen! I am camping here on suffrance, but I know that if God wants me here He will overcome all opposition and supply all need. This is the hardest position I have ever been in, but His grace is sufficient, I know."

In July, 1920, Mr. and Mrs. Hubert Preston were accepted as missionaries. Mr. Preston was appointed to make a tour of the northern rivers, Mrs. Preston in the meantime being retained at La Perouse. In his pioneering work, Mr. Preston spent some time visiting the stations on the Macleay River, and at the end of August returned to Sydney, recommending the re-establishment of a missionary on Fattorina Island. The mission house had got into disrepair, but the same was renovated forthwith, and it was decided by the Council that Mr. and Mrs. Preston should be stationed on the island. The decision of the Council was never carried into effect, as on the 10th October Mr. Preston was accidentally drowned in the Macleay River under tragic circumstances. He had spent some weeks in renovating the mission house in which he and his wife proposed to live. Matters had sufficiently matured to justify Mrs. Preston joining her husband, and it was decided that on Monday, October 11th, Mrs. Preston should leave Sydney for the new sphere of labour. Letters full of joyous expectancy of successful service for Christ on the island had reached her, and buoyed up with the bright picture presented, the young wife counted the days when she would meet her husband amongst the native people. Quite a number of Councillors and fellow-workers had arranged to meet at the Sydney station to bid her God-speed and a happy re-union.

But God permitted otherwise. The train which





was to have conveyed the happy wife to reunite with a loving husband, carried a brave, broken-hearted widow to follow the remains of her beloved to the tomb. Kempsey was reached early the next morning, and they found the local friends waiting to show every possible kindness to the bereaved. It was impossible to ascertain all the details of the tragedy, but they were able to gather the following particulars. Mr. Preston was about to cross from the island to the mainland. His Bible, bicycle and a parcel were in the boat. No one witnessed the accident, but it is surmised that, in attempting to get on board the boat, or pushing the boat off, he overbalanced and fell into the river, and, being unable to swim, was drowned. His watch had stopped at 4.30 p.m., and about five hours later his body was recovered. He was buried in the West Kempsey cemetery, near to another grave which bore the inscription: "Flora Pain, missionary to the Aborigines." Thus another life was laid down in a great cause.

The current issue of the "Aborigines' Advocate" contained the following impressive appeal:—"What does our worker's Home-call mean? Has the work just renewed at Fattorina Island to close down? Or is this a renewed call to some hesitating follower of Jesus to go and preach the Gospel on this vacant station? Will one of our readers respond, 'Here am I, send me'?"

As a temporary supply, Mr. and Mrs. Jago were withdrawn from Angledool, and sent to hold the fort at the island; and then the response to the appeal came from an unexpected quarter. Mrs. Preston herself—widow of a few short months—offered to go forward and take up the work she had hoped to do in company with her beloved partner, whom God had called to higher service. After some hesitation and much prayer, the Council accepted her offer, and this brave young servant of Christ went forth to the task,

"strong in the strength which God supplies, through His eternal Son." Her co-worker was Miss M. C. Belshaw, who had been stationed for some time at La Perouse. The greatest kindness was shown to our workers by Rev. W. H. Butler, Methodist minister at Gladstone. As the missionaries neared the island, the strain on Mrs. Preston was very great, but God gave of His all-sufficient strength. One of the aborigines met them with his boat, and all the natives on the station crowded to the water's edge, and overpowered the missionaries with the warmth of their welcome and the strength of their silent sympathy. Everything was in order. The native women had scrubbed out the church and mission house, and fresh flowers were on the tables. The boys had been cutting wood, chopping down the weeds, and making a new path to the mission house.

On the first Sunday the missionaries visited an old aboriginal who had been with Mr. Preston at "The Rocks." He was very ill, and they talked to him of Christ, and, at his request, prayed with him. Then Mrs. Preston sang to him, "What a Friend we have in Jesus," and the big tears rolled down his dark, wrinkled face as he listened to the song. That evening he passed away, but Mrs. Preston had a deep assurance that the sufferer had gone to be with Christ. She realised, too, the joy of thus beginning her labour of love on Fattorina Island. She had bravely stepped into the breach made in the ranks by the death of her husband, and God abundantly honoured her faith and consecrated courage.



## CHAPTER XIII.

## SOUTH AUSTRALIAN BEGINNINGS.

We have previously mentioned having visited groups of aborigines near Quorn, and other small companies in various localities between Hawker and Oodnadatta. The writer also had an opportunity as far back as the year 1900 of holding a Gospel meeting with a few aborigines between Port Augusta and Port Germain. In the year 1919, Miss V. E. Turner, who had been doing valuable work as a missionary in New South Wales, returned to Adelaide, and from that date until 1924 was the Mission's representative in South Australia. In April of that year Miss Lock began her work in Oodnadatta. She had spent some little time at Marree, but found there were not enough natives to warrant settling there. She found, however, a needy native child, and this little one she took under her care. This was Rita, so well known at the Colebrook Home. Miss Lock, accompanied by Rita, went on to Oodnadatta, at that time the terminus of the northern railway. Camel teams travelled periodically to Alice Springs, three hundred miles further north. Quite a large number of aborigines worked on the teams, and there was constantly a number of families at Oodnadatta. In addition to these semi-civilised natives, there were many bush natives, who came to the locality for corroborees, sometimes staying for several nights. Thus there were two distinct types, for many of the bush natives could not speak English. Some months later Miss Harris (now Mrs. Wade) came over from New South Wales to help

Miss Lock, and later still they were joined by Miss Hyde. It was soon found that there was a great need for a children's home. Rita was already with the missionaries, and other children came until there were six. As yet there was no Mission House, and the children were accommodated in an old shed close to where the missionaries had temporary quarters. This place was most unsuitable, being exposed to public gaze, and without any comforts or conveniences.

In the meantime, Miss Turner had made several attempts to form a Council in Adelaide, for some time without success. Then she and Mrs. Matthews started a monthly prayer meeting, and that gathering together of two, who met to pray in the name of Christ, was the beginning of the South Australian Council. In October, 1924, Mr. T. E. Colebrook visited Adelaide as a delegate to the Christian Endeavour Convention. During his visit the effort to form a Council was renewed. It was exceedingly difficult to secure the interest of a sufficient number of Christian men and women for this purpose. A meeting was called, and a commencement made. The following officers were elected:—President, Mr. Jennison; Secretary, Miss Turner; and Treasurer, Mr. W. L. Carter. At the next meeting Mr. A. E. Gerard was nominated, and several others also came into the work. Mr. Gerard proved a faithful and constant worker, and through all the years until the time of writing he has been an ardent champion of the cause, filling the office of president for a number of years. Other presidents have been Rev. H. R. Heard and Pastor J. Wiltshire.

The President was sent by the Council to visit Oodnadatta, the object being to assist the missionaries in finding a better place to accommodate the children. He was deeply impressed with the urgent need of the little ones, and the Council made it a special matter of prayer that the Lord would





provide the money for a Children's Home. At that time the Mission was in urgent need of money for many purposes, and a day was set apart to pray definitely for one thousand pounds to meet the urgent needs in the various States. Councillors and missionaries with one accord gave themselves to prayer, and within a fortnight "Hallelujahs" were echoing far and wide, for a thousand pounds was received in one gift. Many urgent needs were thus supplied, not the least among them being a comfortable house in Oodnadatta. Missionaries and children then went to live in the new Home, and before long there were twelve little dark children in residence. Miss Lock had by this time left Oodnadatta, and Miss Hyde was appointed Matron of the Home, Miss Harris being in charge of the outside work amongst the natives.

With the building of the railway line from Oodnadatta to Alice Springs, many of the natives removed, either going to other camps or returning to the bush. Then the Children's Home was removed to Quorn, and concerning this work we must write more fully in another chapter. Several trips were made from Alice Springs westward in the endeavour to reach the scattered natives in that lonely region. One trip was made by Miss Lock and Miss Harris in 1925 to get a little half-caste boy for the Home. They found that there were many natives living on the cattle stations, and these sorely needed the Gospel. Wherever possible the missionaries gathered them together and gave them the message. The following year, Miss Harris and Miss Folland journeyed one hundred and eighty miles westward, and came within sight of the Everand Ranges. It was then that Miss Harris got the vision that has tarried with her all through the years, of the natives living out there in that wild and desolate region, and so sorely needing the light of the Gospel. Again the next year Miss Hyde went almost as far into the

wilds to get two half-caste children, and she, too, has never forgotten the tragic pictures then imprinted upon her mind. In some cases there were poor little half-caste children who were not wanted either by their native mothers or their degraded white fathers.

In 1927 the first camel expedition went out. The purpose of this enterprise was to reach the natives living far beyond the settled areas, and to ascertain if mission work of a permanent nature could be undertaken so far afield. Mr. W. Wade and Mr. R. Williams went forward into this desolate and dangerous land, in a very real sense taking their lives in their hands, and trusting the Lord for guidance and support every step of the way. The region they were to traverse was noted for the shortage of water, and it was necessary to carry large water tanks to tide them over the long stretches of drought-stricken country between the rock holes. They had a good team of camels, and a good supply of faith and grit, and when the dust storms came they had more grit still, and their faith did not waver. They traversed the Musgrave, Mann, Peterman and Tomkinson Ranges, and went forty miles beyond the West Australian border. On the return journey they travelled by way of the Deering Hills and the Everand Ranges. On all this prolonged and perilous journey they did not find any large group of aborigines, but there were numbers of small companies of the wild bush natives camping by the water holes. The second long missionary journey was taken by Mr. and Mrs. Wade. This, by the way, was the way in which these devoted missionaries spent their honeymoon. Of the difficulties and the hardships they encountered, no adequate description could ever be written. This cultured young woman gladly went into the desolate wilds of a strange and inhospitable country for the sake of the Christ to Whom she had consecrated her life. This time Mr. James Page was





a member of the party, and he then gained much practical knowledge of the natives, which he turned to good account in his deputation work amongst the churches in the various States of the Commonwealth. The journey occupied six months, and they covered much of the territory visited during the former expedition. They also took an extensive detour further into Central Australia, and formed contact with numbers of wild natives who had never before heard the Gospel.

A few years later Mr. Wade and Mr. H. Green took a similar trip from Oodnadatta in a north-westerly direction. They travelled out to where Miss Lock was working amongst the natives three hundred miles north of Alice Springs. On this journey, too, the Gospel was preached to many small groups of aborigines. Other missionaries who had worked at Oodnadatta are Mr. and Mrs. Sasche, Mr. and Mrs. Eaton, and Miss Rutter.

Another station that must be mentioned here is Swan Reach, on the Murray River. This was the first station actually opened by the South Australian Council. It was discovered that in this locality there was a large camp of natives in very needy circumstances. Enquiries were made, and it was decided to send forward a missionary. Mrs. Matthews offered, and prayer was made that funds would be provided to meet all the needs of this work. The abundant answer came, and a fortnight later a small cottage was rented for a Mission House, and sufficient furniture was provided. For some weeks Mrs. Matthews worked there alone, and then she was assisted for some time by Miss Folland. The Swan Reach people were the remnant of the old Manunka tribe. They were camped on Crown land not far from the town. Some years previously the children had attended the public school, but, owing to the hostility of some of the townspeople, this privilege had been denied them, and at the time Mrs.

Matthews commenced her missionary work at Swan Reach they were running about like wild things, without any attempt at training. Their mental and spiritual education was entirely neglected, and they were living under circumstances that made morality well nigh impossible. For some time the services were held under a tree, but later on the native men became enthused with the desire to build a place of worship. They opened and flattened out four hundred petrol tins, and with these built a commodious and comfortable church. In that crude building there were many conversions, and these natives were trained in Christian living and service by the devoted missionaries. This building was eventually destroyed by a flood, and a new church was built and dedicated to the service of the Lord. Amongst the missionaries who rendered splendid service at this station are Miss Rutter, Miss Addie, Mr. and Mrs. Sasche, Mr. Page, Miss Amery and Miss Tyler; also several others since this chapter was written. There have been many difficulties and discouragements in the work, but it is still being carried on, and God's Word is being faithfully proclaimed to the natives in this southern settlement.

It was found that the best work could not be done for the aboriginal children at Oodnadatta, mainly owing to the proximity to the Home of the native camp. In addition to this, the growing work demanded larger premises, with a much better equipment than the crude buildings at Oodnadatta provided. After much thought and prayer, it was decided that the Home should be established in a centre far removed from the native camps. The site selected was a small house with seven acres of land near Quorn, close to the junction of the Great Northern Railway with the Transcontinental Line. The new building was designated the "Colebrook Home," in recognition of the splendid service rendered by Mr. T. E. Colebrook, then President of the Mission.





In May, 1927, Miss Ruby Hyde left Oodnadatta with twelve children, travelling four hundred miles by train to Quorn. The white residents of the town and district were keenly interested in the new arrivals, and were friendly both to the native children and to the work in general. The Matron, Miss Hyde, had a trying time during the early days of the new Home, as within a few weeks every one of the children developed whooping cough. Other missionaries were appointed to assist, and the work went steadily ahead, the members of the State Council in Adelaide giving every possible assistance.

As the years passed, it became more and more apparent that a larger and better building would be necessary if the demands of the growing work were to be met. Much prayer was offered, and many projects were put forward, but for a long time there seemed to be no means available by which the Mission could make the necessary advance. Persistent prayer, however, again prevailed, and the way was made plain to purchase a fine concrete house with seventy acres of land at a reasonable distance from Quorn. The new Home is most suitable for the work, and many difficulties have been removed.

A word of explanation is necessary about the children who are receiving such splendid attention. It is not the aim of those controlling the work of the Mission in South Australia to take the full blood children, although these would be taken and tenderly cared for if they needed help. The view is held that the full blood children are better left with their own people, with missionaries to teach and train them. It has been proved that the aborigines are capable of being trained to live according to the true Christian ideals of family life, and where this is possible nothing can be gained by separating the children from their native parents. It is with the half-caste children that the Quorn Home is doing such excellent work. These unwanted little ones

were so much "drifting wreckage" throughout the great northern country. The increasing number of these unfortunate children wherever our so-called white civilisation has come in contact with the natives is causing much concern. Many of these waifs are sent to the Home by the police, under instruction from the Government. In some cases their white fathers or the aboriginal mothers bring them to be cared for. The Mission never forcibly takes a child from its native mother, and every inmate has been rescued from the possibility of demoralisation or premature death. There have been some very distressing cases, where little ones have come to the Home ill-nourished, miserable and unwanted. A glad welcome awaits them all, and the Matron and her staff continually thank God for the opportunity of helping the helpless half-caste children.

What is the Mission doing for them? They are warmed and fed, and provided with clean clothing, cosy beds, and healthy surroundings. All the influences of the Home are pure and elevating, and the children soon lose the "pinched and hunted look," and become happy and contented. Dominating all is the Christian training they receive. The Lord Jesus Christ is known and loved at the Home, and many who have been rescued from camps of sin have become earnest and sincere Christians. The native children attend the Quorn public school, where they show themselves as intelligent as any of their white companions. When they leave school they are still cared for, and we are hoping to solve the problem of their future by teaching the older boys some useful trade. A start has been made at Nepabunna, where some of them have been taught bootmaking and wood-turning, but there is a call for prayer, and an appeal to God's people to help us to give them a training that will fit them to become good citizens, and thus prevent them from returning to the indolent life of the camps. The girls are kept





in the Home until suitable domestic positions are found for them where they will be still safeguarded while they earn their own living.

The work is supported by unsolicited freewill offerings, given in answer to prayer; but the South Australian Government supplies the children with a ration of flour, tea and sugar. No appeals are made for funds to support the Home. Several Christian Endeavour societies have undertaken to supply certain children with clothing, at an estimated cost of 3/- per week for each child. Also two friends of the Mission have "adopted" two of the little ones, and count it a privilege to pay the above amount for each every week.

## CHAPTER XIV.

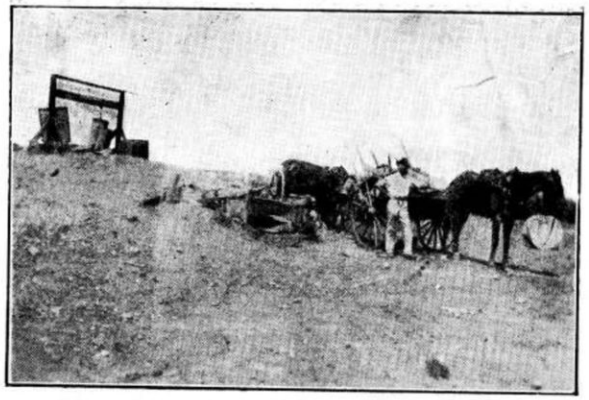
## PROPOSED WORK IN VICTORIA.

The Mission's Magazine, under the date of April, 1921, records the formation of a State Council in Victoria, with Mr. T. Graham as President, Mr. W. L. Wright as Vice-President, and Mrs. McKenzie-Hatton as Secretary. Much interest was thereby created in the work of the Mission in various centres in Victoria. A policy of progressive deputation work was decided upon, and meetings were held in various centres. Several months later the secretarial work was undertaken by Mr. H. Rotherham, and much valuable work was done in the way of spreading interest in the work of the Mission amongst the Victorian churches. The "Australian Aborigines' Advocate," published in October, 1922, outlines a proposal to undertake work at the Lake Tyers Aboriginal Station in Gippsland. It is stated that the Aborigines' Protection Board had granted permission to the Victorian Council to send missionaries to the above station. Four of the members of the Council visited the station, and stayed for several days, spending as much time as possible interviewing the natives and making a general inspection and survey of the mission property. Travelling from Melbourne, first by train, then by motor-launch, the party arrived on October 6th at Lake Tyers House. To this lonely spot the mailman comes three times weekly in his motor-boat. Lake Tyers is probably the most beautiful of all the lakes in south-eastern Victoria; the coast-line is very irregular, and the foliage on the high banks overlooking the lake is

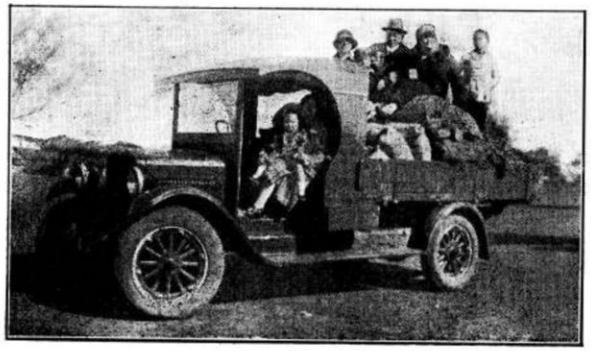
Mr. and Mrs. Playford.

Mr. and Mrs. Jago.

Us Margaret Blackfella.



Mr. Schenk's arrival at the well, Mt. Margaret.



The motor truck at Mt. Margaret.





very beautiful. The lake is usually calm, on account of its sheltered situation, and the climate is mild in winter and cool in summer. The Aboriginal Mission Station is situated on one of the headlands at the southern end of the lake, and covers an area of 4000 acres, mostly densely wooded. About 500 acres could be cultivated, but much of the land would require fertilisation. There is a small orchard of about 100 trees on the property, and the natives are described as a lovable people, who readily respond to any kindness shown to them. At the time of this visit, ample work was available for those who desired it, for which they received payment. It was reported that there were 200 natives on the station, one-third of whom were full-bloods, and it was thought by the officials in charge that from 350 to 400 aborigines would probably be gathered there. On the station were erected forty-five three-roomed houses. There were also residences for the manager and the sub-manager, a church, a store, and a dispensary. The State school was attended by 45 scholars, graded up to the sixth class. One building had recently been set apart for a maternity hospital. At the rear of the church was the cemetery, where more than 200 natives had been buried. A recreation ground was provided, and a house for missionaries had been erected. It was anticipated that it would be possible to station missionaries at Lake Tyers forthwith. The manager gladly consented to the proposal of the visiting Council members to conduct a Sunday afternoon service. The church was well filled, and at least 166 natives were present. The manager took the first part of the service, and then handed the meeting over to the visitors, who spoke first to the children and then to the adults. The scene was very impressive. The men sat on one side of the aisle, and the women on the other. Their reverence and behaviour was all that could be desired. Gospel hymns were very

heartily sung, led by a native choir. The message was the simple, soul-saving truth of the Gospel. During the meeting a young woman was seen to leave the church; the reason for this was afterwards ascertained. After the service many of the homes were visited, and the natives interviewed. Two of the visitors were met by a young man, who told them that the young woman who had left the meeting was his wife. She was under deep conviction, and arrived home in tears. The message brought back to her memories of the past. On enquiry they found that the young man had himself heard part of the message, and he, too, was under conviction. He did not yield, but invited them to the house to see his wife. They read Isaiah 53, and the way of salvation was explained, and before they left had the joy of kneeling with the young couple as they poured out their hearts in confession and accepted the Lord as a personal Saviour. It was evident that a definite work of grace was done in their hearts by the Holy Spirit. The evening service was conducted by the Church of England clergyman from the Lakes Entrance. The church was again crowded, and about 25 of the aborigines, unable to get into the building, met under the trees and listened in the darkness for over an hour to the Gospel message. After the meeting the visitors found in one of the cottages a man very ill with pneumonia and pleurisy. A small band of natives gathered in the room, and asked that the Word of Life might again be given to them and their sick friend. At the close of this little cottage meeting three of the natives decided for Christ. The following day the visitors returned to Melbourne, with high hopes of a great opportunity for work at Lake Tyers.

On the 8th January, 1923, a largely attended missionary meeting, under the auspices of the Australian Aborigines' Mission, was held in the Spring Street Mission Hall, East Prahran, for the purpose





of setting apart Mr. and Mrs. Oliver Burgess for work at Lake Tyers. Mr. T. Graham occupied the chair, and outlined the negotiations with the Aborigines' Protection Boards, and the circumstances which led to the appointment of Mr. and Mrs. Burgess. A number of lantern slides were shown, depicting the station and the natives. Mr. and Mrs. Burgess had previously served as missionaries in China, and looked forward with hopefulness and joy to entering into the work amongst the Australian aborigines. A report written in May, 1923, tells of good work done by these workers at Lake Tyers, and many of the natives won for Christ.

A further report from the Victorian Council in August of the same year gives an account of the continuance of this good work through a very trying period. Most of the aborigines on the station were stricken down with a severe form of influenza, but the missionaries battled bravely on, ministering to the people in their suffering, and helping them to a better understanding of the practical side of Christian living. The names of Mr. and Mrs. Burgess appear in the official list of missionaries until May, 1924.

The Victorian Council faithfully supported the work of the Mission at Lake Tyers during the residence there of the missionaries, but later it was decided by the Government Department controlling the aborigines that the spiritual work at this station should be left to the Church of England, so that there was no further opportunity for the Mission to labour amongst the remnant of the native people in Victoria.

## CHAPTER XV.

## MOUNT MARGARET.

Mt. Margaret, near Morgans, West Australia, is inseparably connected with the name of Mr. R. Schenk, who laid the foundation of the work of the Mission in this important centre early in 1921. The Mission's official paper, published on 25th March of that year, has this striking paragraph:—"Go Forward! Mr. Schenk, recently accepted as a fully accredited missionary, left for West Australia on the 19th instant to open up further work in that State in connection with the Australian Aborigines' Mission. We commend our brother and his work to our praying friends, asking that he be remembered at the Throne of Grace." A later issue has this item of news:—"Missionary Rod Schenk has gone West, and is launching out in that State. Laverton is his destination. The undertaking is one that will require self-denial and courage."

A few months later the Sydney Council received a message that the missionary had pioneered the district, and had applied for a lease of land about 20 miles from Laverton on the dry mulga plains. He described his first contact with the natives. They were first suspicious, then friendly, and were evidently afraid that the new message would upset their tribal customs. One morning Mr. Schenk found two aborigines badly speared because of the breach of some tribal rite. This gave a golden opportunity to show practical sympathy by treating the inflamed wounds with antiseptics, and the sad hearts with the soothing balm of the Gospel message. Slowly he won the confidence of the native men, and was invited to attend their corroborees.





"One corroboree," he wrote, "was particularly interesting. No woman, not even a native woman, is allowed to see it. The men here are expert in doing their corroboree shivers. Many of their tribal customs are good. Before a 'devil-devil' corroboree one man has to touch the others on the shoulder. Once I arrived late, and had to do this before I could sit down and watch." The natives became keenly interested in a roll of Bible pictures used by the missionary, but suddenly this attitude changed when they saw a picture of "The raising of the widow's son." They were very superstitious about the dead, and were afraid they would meet the spirit of the departed one. In the Laverton district the whites and the natives feared each other, and the former were surprised that the missionary dared to go near the camps at night. One night Mr. Schenk did have a narrow escape from being speared, because, unwittingly, he did not answer a sentry call before entering camp. They lived in perpetual fear of the "Darlos" (a northern tribe), and one night they thought they saw one approaching, and the men rushed out with flaming eyes and lifted spears. But it was a false alarm. They had frequent fights amongst themselves, and one day the missionary stopped what might have been a fatal brawl by suddenly embracing the most ferocious warrior. The young men of the tribe were astonished, and screamed out, "You nothing touch em; they spearem you." "But," wrote Mr. Schenk, "a real hug works wonders." They soon learned that the missionary was their friend, and yet they were steeped in superstition and sin. As he watched the men fervently fondle the "devil-devil" sticks used in their masonic corroborees, the missionary earnestly prayed that God would soon incline their hearts by His Holy Spirit to love the Lord Jesus Christ with the same fervour and devotion.

In telling the story of Mount Margaret, we must acknowledge our indebtedness to the concise little book recently published, "The First Ten Years of Mount Margaret Mission." From this publication we are taking the liberty to quote extracts, and some incidents recorded are those referred to here. Mr. Schenk recalls the day of his arrival, with an old horse drawing a dilapidated cart which contained personal belongings and a small supply of food. As time went by, there were wonderful changes and startling developments in the work. Mrs. Schenk co-operated heartily with her husband in this self-sacrificial work. "Abandoned buildings on adjacent deserted mining camps were purchased, dismantled, and re-erected on the Mission lease. Old tanks were re-conditioned, and a water service laid on. The school building, loaned by the Government, was moved in sections and re-built, once more re-echoing to the voices of happy children. The cart gave place to a motor truck; the old horse found several companions, and a flock of goats appeared magically on the scene. To-day the place looks like a little well-ordered township."

Every effort was made to secure facilities for the effective carrying on of the work. A mission house was built, dormitories and work-rooms were provided, and soon a bake-house was under construction. The money for all these improvements was provided in voluntary contributions sent in answer to prayer, and at no time was monetary support given by the Government. The women were carefully trained in the making of baskets, bags, mats, fans, and many other useful articles of raffia work and silk—all this under the capable direction of the missionary's wife. The men were also trained in many useful occupations, and their active employment in the manufacture of many utilities was a considerable factor in character building. The profit from any work done by the native people was in





every instance spent on the people themselves, and never upon the Mission. The industrial work was always but a means to an end, and that end, which is ever in view, and always dominant, is the bringing of the aborigines to a saving knowledge of the Lord Jesus Christ. Great changes were seen in the lives of many of the native people as they forsook their superstitions, and savage practices, and yielded their lives to the control of Christ. The efficacy of the cleansing blood, and the power of God's wonderful grace, were demonstrated again and again in the changed lives of the native people.

For some time, Mr. and Mrs. Schenk were assisted by Mr. and Mrs. Jago, and later by Mr. and Mrs. Will Collier. Mr. Reichenbach was also added to the staff. He brought with him a folding organ, a gift for the work. The music caused a great stir amongst the natives, who exclaimed, "Doolgoo ululah, weelah wongara," which, being interpreted, is, "Singing good, feel sweet inside." The school, started by this brother, gave a valuable opportunity for instructing the people in the knowledge of the Word of God.

Mrs. Schenk's first pupil in raffia work was Kungel, the king's son, 12 years of age. In some cases difficulty was experienced in inducing the women to start learning, as their husbands threatened to beat them if they washed the mud off their hair, and in some cases Mrs. Schenk had to hide them during this unorthodox occupation of washing away the accumulated dirt of years. In May, 1927, the mission had a surprise visit from the Protector of Aborigines, who evidently was deeply impressed with the good work being done by the missionaries, as soon afterwards, a number of children and other natives were sent to the station. More accommodation was necessary, but in due time this came in answer to prayer. In October of the same year we read that the missionaries expected two hundred

and fifty additional natives, including a number of children, at the station.

At one period there was a keen agitation amongst some of the white people in the vicinity to have the mission moved, but God over-ruled, and the work was carried on with even greater success than before. In February, 1930, Mr. Hugh Watt and Miss Marion Sandland arrived from Melbourne to assist in the growing work, and toward the end of the year the mission had a visit from Dr. Elkin, of the Australian National Research Council. Dr. Elkin is a keen anthropologist, and a sturdy champion in the cause of the aborigines, and his visit was greatly appreciated.

Another aspect of the work at Morgans was the founding of the "Graham Home" for Children. For some time, Miss Marion Sandland has filled the position as Matron, and in March, 1931, it was reported that there were forty children under her care, mostly between six and twelve years of age. We quote one instance of a boy who had been through the Home. His first place of employment after leaving school was with a squatter, where he earned 10/- per week. His employer said of him, "Norman is a splendid musterer, and a good little worker. He is teaching them all the Bible down there, and they think he knows the New Testament off by heart." This made the hearts of the missionaries glad, as they recalled how Norman had received his training in the Children's Home. In addition to this, expeditions have been sent into the Warburton Ranges to form contact with the untouched native tribes who wander in the interior. One expedition started from Mount Margaret on the 7th June, 1933, with Mr. William Wade in charge, Mr. Jackson as assistant, and two natives. Throughout the long and strenuous journey these workers were able to reach many natives who had never before heard the good news of





salvation. It was a joy indeed to have the privilege of being the first to tell them of Christ. After their return, plans were made for a further expedition, carrying boring equipment and other essentials for the establishment of a Mission centre in the Warburtons. Space will not here permit to describe in detail the great transformation that has taken place at Mount Margaret since the commencement of the Mission; and for a fuller detail of the work, and its recent developments and successes, we would refer our readers to the book we have already mentioned, "The First Ten Years of the Mount Margaret Mission," edited by Mr. H. P. Smith, of Melbourne. One aspect of the work, however, we desire to emphasise. There are many native children now living at Morgans who have been rescued from lives of sin and shame. Many little girls would have become the child-wives of old men, and others would have been forced into a fate too terrible to describe. These little ones have been rescued, fed and clothed, educated, and, best of all, brought to know, love and serve the Lord Jesus Christ. Who can estimate the value of this splendid service of seeking and saving the children of our native people?

During the year 1927 the Mission passed through a time of difficulty and testing, which led ultimately to a temporary division in the ranks. We cannot now record the history of this period, but it will be sufficient to state that early in 1928 a separate organisation was formed in Melbourne. In the beginning of 1929, after much prayer and conference, an amalgamation of forces was satisfactorily effected.

The Mission, in future, was to be known as the United Aborigines' Mission, and the monthly publication was designated "The United Aborigines' Messenger." The headquarters of the Mission was transferred from Sydney to Melbourne, in which city the Federal Council was located, while State

Councils were established in Sydney, Adelaide, and Perth, with representatives also in Queensland and Tasmania.

The first issue of "The United Aborigines' Messenger" appeared on May 1st, 1929, and at once it became manifest that the union of forces that had been effected would be productive of much good in the strengthening and extension of the work. We publish elsewhere a photograph of the six delegates who were responsible for formulating the new constitution, which was to guide the affairs of the Mission.

We were fortunate in securing the services of Mr. W. L. Wright as the first Secretary of the Federal Council. The position held by Mr. Wright in various Christian and missionary organisations in Victoria, coupled with his well-known work at the Spring Street Mission, was a guarantee of the sympathy and support of the Christian public.

The new constitution, though admittedly voluminous, was adopted by the Councils in every State, and a new impetus was given to the work. A number of new missionaries were accepted, and sent forth to work in the various fields, and reports from different stations indicated that definite spiritual results had accrued from what we believe to have been a Spirit-led union.



## CHAPTER XVI.

## "ARISE AND BUILD."

With hearts full of gratitude to God for His guidance and help in bringing about this unity in the ranks of the workers, we were able to face the future with a new hopefulness. We met together for praise and prayer, and, as we sought for a message of encouragement from the Inspired Word, there came to us the utterance of that practical, but prayerful, preacher, Nehemiah: "The God of Heaven, He will prosper us, therefore we, His servants, will arise and build." Neh. 2: 20.

In many places the walls were down, the work delayed, and the workers discouraged. We felt that there must be a forward movement for a stronger fellowship and a better service. In the first Federal Secretary of the United Mission, we had a brother rich in knowledge of the Word of God, and wise in counsel. His helpful studies on Scriptural topics, given from time to time for the benefit of the workers, had been most fruitful, and in dealing with difficult problems connected with the growing work of the Mission, his sane judgment, resulting from a wide experience in Christian work, was most helpful.

In the first issue of the "United Aborigines' Messenger," interest is focussed upon the valuable work of the Children's Homes. Bomaderry is truthfully depicted as a venture of faith. The buildings had been greatly improved, and from many distant parts of New South Wales helpless, hopeless, and motherless little ones had been brought to this kindly

shelter. The consecrated Sisters had been constant in their devotion to the native children in the Home. Up to date (May 1st, 1929), one hundred and fifteen children had passed through the institution, the majority of them coming in as babies or infants.

The work of the Colebrook Home in South Australia was also reviewed. Beneath the roof of this, another kindly shelter, many little outcasts, despised by the whites, and neglected by the aborigines themselves, have found a safe refuge and a happy home. All native children are welcomed. "Whence came they?" queries the writer of an article in the first issue of the "Messenger." "From dirty native camps; from Godless white men's homes; from wandering in the bush; from the hut of the Afghan; from the imminent peril of death at the hands of the natives; from the worst peril of ruination by the whites. And now, gathered into a Home where love is the key-word, and where Christ Jesus is honoured and loved by all, these little ones have learned to laugh and sing and play, to love and to pray. We have 18 in residence, and the Home is full. There are hundreds of others just as needy, and if God's people knew of the need, and responded to it, we should be able to enlarge our premises and save others.

Let us introduce to you a few of these Quorn native children. Three years ago, a group of natives, with two missionaries, stood by the grave in which a native woman had just been laid to rest. One old lubra held the dead woman's tiny baby in her arms, and, when the grave was closed, she placed the little bundle in the arms of one of the missionaries, thus giving it into her care. This little one was taken to the Home at Quorn. Mona, as she was called, became the pet of the Home; but at the age of two and a half years she began to ask that God would send another little one to fill her pram, her cot, and her baby clothes. Morning, noon, and night,





she would ask Sister Hyde to pray this special prayer, and, if the prayer were omitted, she would not be pacified until the omission was remedied. In due course the prayer was answered, and a tiny black baby, Stephen, rescued from death in a native camp, was sent to the Home. He was such a poor, miserable little child of two months, bearing in his tiny face and thin limbs the evidence of under-feeding, but to the native children in the Home he was perfect—God's answer to their prayers, and little Mona, not yet three years old, lovingly stroked the pinched face, saying, "My baby, Jesus sent him to me," and he became known in the Home as Mona's baby. Mona was naughty one day, and had to be punished. Looking up defiantly at the Sister through her tears, she said, "Alright! Now I'll take my baby back to Oodnadatta." "Very well," came the quiet reply, "you may go now." But repentance came quickly, and two loving little arms were flung around the Sister's neck as she said, "No, Sister, I'll let you keep my Stephen here."

A quiet, earnest little girl is Ruth, who came into the Home unable to speak a word of English, ignorant of any semblance of civilisation, and steeped in native superstition. She was found wandering in the bush with an old black man, probably a relative, but nothing is known of her former life. She had never worn any clothing, and knew nothing of bathing. Now you may see little Ruth, always ready, with a sweet smile, to help in the Home, or to dress the babies. We were telling her the story of Christ, when she asked, "Sister, will black people go to Heaven?" "Oh, yes," was the reply; "everyone who loves Jesus will go to Heaven, no matter what colour they are." For a moment she gazed out of the window as though seeing a vision of her own people in their dire extremity, and then, very earnestly, she asked, "But, Sister, such lots of them don't know about Jesus. Will all the black people

who don't know Jesus go to Heaven?" Dear little Ruth, with such deep yearnings over her beloved tribes. Is this little child more concerned about them than we Christian people, who have so long neglected them?

In Western Australia, at the Graham Home, a splendid work for God was being done. Neglected little ones were gathered in. Their suffering bodies were restored, and their infant minds were filled with the sweet and wholesome truths of the Word of God. They were educated and trained for Christian service.

From widely separated Mission station throughout Australia letters were received from missionaries and other workers telling of their gratitude to God for the new impetus that had been given to the work, and declaring their determination to loyally continue their labours for Christ and the native people.

One very real evidence that the fusion of forces was Divinely directed was the amazing advance made into the previously untouched territory, where many tribes of aborigines were without any knowledge of Christ. Some of these were entirely in their primitive state, untainted by the degradation and disease that so frequently march hand in hand with the advance of so-called white civilisation. Others had been damaged and demoralised by degraded whites on the outposts of settlement. They were utterly ignorant of Divine things, steeped in superstition, and "God was not in all their thoughts." One old native, when questioned as to what he knew of God, replied: "Good word for boss when he gets mad; big fellow swear." Into these dark places of this "Sunny Continent," our missionaries penetrated with Gospel light.

There appeared in the "Messenger" of June, 1929, an article under these striking headlines: "One Long Record of Answered Prayer during our 1700 Miles Journey through Inland Australia in search





of those other sheep for whom Christ died." Mr. and Mrs. Will. Wade were stationed in Central Australia, where they ministered faithfully to a limited number of resident aborigines, and also formed contact with other bush natives who paid occasional visits. For a long time the burden of the wild tribes in the distant ranges west of Oodnadatta had lain heavily upon their hearts. Something must be done. They prayed, continued praying, and finally prayed through. They advanced on their knees, supported by an army of praying friends. At last the answer came. The long-closed door stood open, and two eager missionaries went forth with their team of camels into the great unknown land of desert and mountain. What did these missionaries find? Prepared hearts, acceptance with the people, the language of love understood by all, and all in answer to prayer. As time drew near for a second itinerating journey to be undertaken, great obstacles beset the pathway. "One by one," writes the missionary, "we saw these difficulties disappear as we prayed. The Lord graciously brought us together to be of one mind, so that together we might have our heart's desire in ministering to the needs of these neglected, needy people. The drought conditions made the position very difficult. Rain was sorely needed before the journey could be undertaken. Our camels had been left at a cattle station 150 miles away. How to get our six months' supplies as well as ourselves out there was another subject for prayer. Just at the right time the need was met, and a friend drove us in his motor truck to where our camels were waiting. The only delay on the journey from Oodnadatta was a gracious fall of rain. The station owner remarked with surprise that our camels had kept together during the six months without being shepherded. This was most unusual, but we knew why. The explanation is in one word—'Prayer.' On our arrival at the station, we discovered that one

of the camels had been claimed and taken away by a white man. We sorely needed him for our team, so, while we repaired our saddles and made a new one, we prayed. The new saddle was made in faith that we would get the camel to put under it. Four weeks passed, and everything was ready for the journey, but the prodigal camel had not returned. Hearing that the man who had taken it was six miles away, Mr. Wade walked across, and everybody was surprised that without much argument the camel was restored. Mr. Wade returned rejoicing, but another shock awaited us, for, on arrival at the station where we camped, the animal suddenly took fright and bolted off into the darkness. Nothing could be done that night except pray. Next morning he was found with the nose line firmly caught in a tree. Soon after this we set off on our journey with six camels, and we needed at least eight to carry our loads and give us two animals to ride. We also had three young camels running with their mothers, and the Lord showed us that we could have these young camels to use if only we had the grit and the grace and the gumption to break them in. This was somewhat of a task for those who were inexperienced, but after several attempts, a few mistakes, and a good deal of fun, it was accomplished, and all through the rest of the journey the youngsters carried good loads and behaved splendidly."

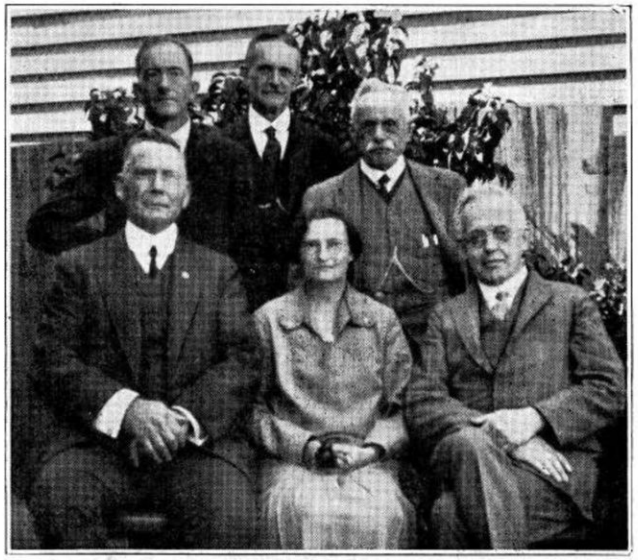
These brave missionaries continued on over the trackless desert, but the Lord was their Guide. They were conscious of being borne along and directed by the Divine Hand. Often when travelling through long dry stages where no water could be found for the camels, their needs were provided for by the discovery of patches of a plant called "para keelia," which is both food and water for them. The missionaries did not travel on Sundays, and though at times it might have been thought necessary, owing

Little girls saved from becoming child wives.

Prospective Husbands.

**Mr. and Mrs. Wade.**





**Standing** (Left to Right): Mr. J. Jago, Mr. G. L. Aitken, Mr. H. Rotherham.

**Seated:** Rev. E. J. Telfer, Miss V. E. Turner, Mr. T. Graham.

Mr. W. L. Wright.





to the lack of water, God always answered prayer in guiding them to a waterhole just at the right time. For six weeks they travelled without seeing a living soul. This called for much grace and patience, especially so as the last ten days were spent in a waterless area in the Peterman Ranges, and the camels had to do without water all that time. A long, tiring and fruitless journey had been taken, and so far not a native had they seen, but just as thoughts of discouragement came crowding in upon the mind, the answer to many prayers came. Suddenly they sighted a group of natives in the distance, and before long came up with them, and found, to their joy, that amongst them were a number of children they had met on the previous pioneer journey. What a sight it was to see this group of eager, naked, native children looking with confidence into the faces of the missionaries and singing the Gospel choruses they had learned two years before. How wonderful to think that during that long time, without missionary or teacher, the rocks of the Peterman Ranges were echoing with the chorus, "Hallelujah to the Lamb, Who died on Mount Calvary." For several weeks the missionaries were in constant touch with some of the wandering tribes, yet they felt the powers of darkness, and sometimes it seemed as if the great enemy of souls resented intrusion into his domain. Many times the restless, warlike spirit of the wild natives seemed to be quietened and stilled by God Himself. There were times when they were very uncertain of the way to take, and every corner seemed to be wits-end corner, but the Lord still guided them with unerring hand. How many times they were led to water and to the natives in answer to prayer, it would be impossible to recount. Daily strength was given, good health maintained, and they knew that a measure of light was dawning upon some of the darkened souls with whom they had come in contact. They understood the meaning

of that Wordless Book which is written in the Language of Love. They seemed to know instinctively —doubtless in answer to prayer—that the missionaries had come to do them good. A photograph taken on this journey shows a large group of natives watching Mr. Wade withdrawing a spear from a man's leg and dressing the wound. The sick were ministered to; the old neglected people received the ministry of Christian kindness, and, best of all, the story of the Cross, with its message of a full and a free salvation, was told to many for the first time.

The account of these great journeys into the Interior would be incomplete without special mention of Mr. James Page. After a period of training in the Croydon Bible Institute, N.S.W., Mr. Page entered the work of the Mission, and was associated with Mr. and Mrs. Wade in the 1700 miles trip of which we have been telling. On the 29th of May, 1929, Mr. Page was inducted as a fully-accredited missionary at a meeting in Adelaide. He told the large congregation assembled on that occasion of some remarkable experiences amongst the aborigines. In the long journey from Oodnadatta to a point forty miles beyond the Western Australian border, he had found the uncivilised aborigines to be, on the whole, of fine physique, a healthy, lovable people, and most certainly a people worth preserving. Throughout the trip the missionaries gave the Gospel message to many companies of aborigines, and took numerous opportunities to help the sick and injured. He considered it necessary that many of the degrading tribal customs should be abandoned, but they had found that, in many cases, when the truth of the Gospel penetrated the aboriginal mind, the superstition and cruel tribal laws were automatically disregarded. This long journey took the missionaries through the Everard, Musgrave, Mann, Peterman and Tomkinson Ranges, and the northern portion of the Great South Australian





Aboriginal Reserve. They discovered only two reliable permanent water supplies on the track, these being at Opperina and Ernabella Springs, in the Musgrave Ranges. For the most part, they depended on rock holes and native soaks. After passing the last touch with civilisation at Morilyana, they were four months without seeing a white person. During the whole of the trip they made contact with about 500 natives, and of that number probably 350 were wild, untouched aborigines. Amongst the natives who were untouched by civilisation there was no sickness, except a few bad sores, due to neglected burns, or an occasional broken limb. There was positively no venereal disease whatever, and on the whole the morals of these natives were of a high order. Conversation was carried on by a limited number of words in their language, together with signs, and the native men were always ready to show them where to obtain water and food for their camels. The men in these tribes are described as being tall, broad-shouldered, muscular and thin-legged. They were keen-eyed, and very fleet of foot, their only weapon being a barbed spear, which they threw with marvellous precision. They hunted all day, and if the hunt proved successful they had one great meal in the evening, consisting probably of kangaroo, wallaby, emu, or rabbit. They also collected berries, and dug for edible roots. The berries and seeds were crushed between two stones and made into a kind of damper. In localities where food was readily obtained, the children rapidly developed the hunting instinct, and at five or six years of age became, in some cases, independent of their parents for food supplies. The aborigines appeared to be of a generous disposition, and readily offered portions of their catch to the missionaries. Any food given to them, they would distribute amongst the group. One tribe, about forty miles across the West Australian border. who had never seen whites

previously, were even more generous and kindly disposed than those who had come into contact with whites. The Gospel message was introduced by pictures, and, like most other natives, these tribes were intensely curious. In some cases they were very amused at seeing the white people. They laughed and nudged each other, and felt them all over to make sure that they were real. Mrs. Wade was a centre of attraction with the women, who marvelled at her long hair and skirts. Mr. Page investigated some of their strict totem codes, which absolutely forbade the inter-marrying of close blood relations. There appeared to be no signs of cannibalism in these districts, although it was discovered that the natives often killed the weakly or deformed children lest they should be an incubus. The largest family they discovered boasted five children. The children were quick at learning, and very readily memorised choruses and hymns, their instinct for time and tune being truly remarkable.

During his time spent in the out-back, Mr. Page gained much practical knowledge of the aborigines in their primitive condition, and when, at a later date, he was set apart for deputation work in the different States, his lectures were listened to with great interest and profit.

While this pioneer work was going on in the heart of the continent, the workers in the far north of Western Australia had heard the call from the untouched Kimberley country. After much prayer and preparation, Mr. Tom Street, who, with his wife and other missionaries, had been doing valuable work on Sunday Island, ventured forth into the great North-West Land. Accompanied by two native helpers, Goodarra and Stumpagee, this earnest, consecrated young missionary left Derby in the effort to form contact with the nomadic people in this unexplored and almost unapproachable country. A note in the current issue of the "Messenger" reads:





"Brother Tom Street has once again plunged into the great silence of the northern bush; just in time, for, following the rains, the grass in that part of the country grows rapidly, sometimes reaching a height of seven feet." Months later there came a message from the heart of this land of rugged mountains and deep valleys, "The Lord hath done great things for us whereof we are glad," the letter began. Travelling northward from Derby, the missionary and his native helpers had reached Mount House, and then to a place of inappropriate designation, "Grace's Knob."

From Grace's Knob the missionaries continued their journey to another abandoned station named Mount Barnett, a beautiful spot, and suitable in every way for the establishment of a mission station amongst the natives. After spending a couple of days there, in order to rest their animals, as there were no natives in the immediate vicinity at the time, they travelled on to Gibb River Station, which is the last cattle station north-east of Derby, the distance in a direct line being about 240 miles. Here the missionaries found quite a number of aborigines of the type that have come in a greater or lesser degree in contact with white settlers. So far they had seen very few of the wild bush natives. Their next objective was the Drysdale River, which they planned to visit with the hope of exploring much of the intervening country, where big tribes of aborigines were believed to be camping. Under the date of June 19th, 1929, Mr. Street wrote as follows.—"Will you pray for us as we go out into the unknown, that we may be brought into contact with those who have never heard, and that the seed sown may enter into hearts prepared by the Lord. Will you pray that we may be guided as to a suitable place to stay. If work is to be started up here, one will need to be better equipped with fresh horses, for all stores would have to be brought up by pack horses. Game

seems to be scarce in these parts, and to stay here it would, as far as I can see, be necessary to have a few cattle, not only for our own use, but so that one could attract the natives around the place. It would certainly take a good deal of money to establish a mission station in the North Kimberley, but, praise God, He to Whom belongeth all the silver and gold is well able to supply all that is needed. It is about 60 miles from here to the spot where Kingsford Smith and his Southern Cross were lost. The world gives liberally to what it considers a worthy cause (what about the response of the Church to the most neglected cause on God's earth?) Was there ever a cause more worthy than the salvation of the aborigines? Will you help us by prayer? We do need your help. There is an open door, but many adversaries. Prayer will bring victory. You may not hear from me for some time, for once we get into the outback it may be a long, long while before we find means of communication. The Lord has promised to be our constant Companion, and, praise His name, He is. He has promised to lead, and He does. Blessed be the name of the Lord."

One of the native helpers, Goodarra, who accompanied Mr. Street, wrote to Mr. W. Collier as follows:—"I am writing to you from Mt. House Station. I will write a little letter. It is a long time since I left Derby. I hope you will be glad to see my letter, and I hope God will help and bless you wherever you go. God be with you. We have had a lot of rain. The grass is growing. It is lovely to see God's beautiful flowers. We have had lots of ducks and kangaroos. The melons are growing in the garden, and Mr. Street is digging in the garden and planting seeds. We always remember you in our prayers. Will you pray for us as we take the story of Jesus and His love to the poor people out here who have never heard of our Heavenly Father? I have learnt to play hymns on a mouth organ. I





like this country very much. The Lord has been with us, and has taken us into the wild country till we have got to a place where He wanted us to stay."

Mr. Collier gives a very interesting and informative account of a trip from Sunday Island round to Brue Reef, from which we extract the following (Brue Reef can only be approached in fine weather —about twice a year):—"For the past couple of days everyone has been busy putting catamarans in repair, splicing ropes to their harpoons, and making general arrangements for the trip, while I am attending to a few odd jobs on the boat, and looking over the running gear to make sure that everything is in good order, in case it should be tested and found wanting. Very often on a trip like this our lives may depend on the state of the gear, especially if we strike any rough weather. We timed to leave about 11 o'clock to catch a part of the flood-tide, as this gives us a good start. After calling out to the boys to shake themselves lest we should miss the tide, we prepare to board our little craft. The native boys grabbed the remaining flour and other necessities that must keep us in food for a fortnight. The boat is already floated, and as I appeared over the hill with a blanket under one arm, and carrying a few personal belongings in a sugar bag, I can hear the boys calling one to the other, 'Master coming.' Half the crew are aboard busily stowing their stuff below, while others are loading catamarans on the deck for working various islands en route. The last bit of firewood is stowed away, and then the familiar clank of the anchor is heard as the boys heave it up, the sails are set, and as the anchor leaves the bottom of the sea the jib is run up and we are off. As we move softly from the island, the deck is scrubbed, and the provisions are stowed away. By this time the cook announces, 'Billy boiling now,' and to my query, 'What are you going to cook for this crowd?' (there are 28 all told), he looks a little

helpless and says, 'Damper, I s'pose.' For the next half-hour he is busy rolling out dough and cooking it in a camp oven. Our first stop is at the Tide Rip Islands, which are reached well after dark; the distance we have travelled has not been great, but there has been no wind. Here several natives disembark to gather trocas to be picked up on the return journey. Water is always a problem on these small boats, and when we have only about 200 gallons on board, it is necessary to conserve it as much as possible. The Tide Rip Islands are true to name, as the tide tears in and out with such fury as to make it one of the biggest hair-raisers in the mouth of the Sound; and when we consider that the tide here has a rise and fall of about 30 feet raging in and out amongst great jagged, menacing rocks, whirlpools and rips, it is certainly calculated to give anyone a fright. Leaving again at midnight, which is high water, and with a gentle south-west wind blowing, we make fair headway, and, having the tide with us, we reach Bedford Islands just at daylight. We drop another lot of natives here, also at Cleft Island just alongside. The wind by this time has dropped off, and we arrive at Caffarelli just on dark. We leave another lot of men here, as it is the last place at which we can anchor before sailing for the reef. These and many other islands form the Buccaneer Archipelago—well known for the wonderful iron ore deposits at Yampi Sound, supposed to be the largest iron deposits in the world. They are practically pure iron. We still have nine men on the boat. It is necessary to leave here also at midnight in order to be able to approach the Reef in daylight. It will presently be seen how dangerous the approach is, as the Reef is only uncovered at low water. We hear the same familiar clank of the windlass echoed back from the hills as the long length of chain is hauled in. Although so close to the shore, the lead shows twelve fathoms. With





little wind, we make poor progress, and the big ocean swell is making the boat roll considerably. There is a continual bumping of the booms, and the banging and flapping of the sails and gear. Yet there is something extremely beautiful in being out on the ocean at night in these wild regions. The setting of the morning star is followed quickly by the first faint flush of dawn. Then one of the boys, with a shout, draws attention to a low black line away on the horizon. It looks menacing and dangerous in the half light, especially as the huge seas swell up with clock-work regularity, and appear as racing mountains approaching us. They rise in a crest, curl over, and end in a roar in a mass of foam.

Breakfast over, we approach as close to the reef as possible, and, after putting some of the natives ashore, we take the boat to an anchorage. This is by no means an easy task, as the water is deep, and there is a lot of foul ground to avoid. After cruising around for some time the lead shows 19 fathoms, and the boy standing by the anchor 'lets go,' and the chain goes out with a rattle that shakes the boat and makes it tremble all over. Forty-five fathoms of chain is run out, and we are safe as long as the chain holds. Bear in mind that the chain often breaks, but seldom the anchor, hence the reference in Hebrews—'An anchor that will not break or drag,' I believe is the literal rendering. By the time the reef is covered up the boys return, and the awning is spread to keep off the burning rays of the tropical sun, and as there is nothing in sight but a vast expanse of watery waste, and we are all utterly weary, we take a short nap to make up for sleep previously lost. About 3 p.m. the reef begins to dry, and all hands go ashore except the cook. The reef is still drying rapidly, and in the scorching heat of the sun the most wonderful and fascinating sights meet our eyes. There are huge holes, filled with multi-coloured fish of all descriptions, some being a

deep sky-blue, others red, some pink, and many others of every other conceivable colour. Their beauty as seen in their natural state cannot be described; one can only gaze and wonder. The coral growths are equally wonderful, for every colour is there. While some of the coral is as delicate as the finest lace, some takes the form of flowers, and yet other kinds extend up like small trees, sending out hundreds of branches, amongst which the fish circle, and turn, and circle again, waiting for the return of the tide. Hundreds of different crabs, and shell fish meet the eye, while much of the reef is built up of millions of coral cells, and is quite porous. As the big ocean swell rolls in, it gurgles and groans in the most uncanny manner, while the water in the holes quite a long way from the edge of the reef is seen to rise as if by magic. As we worked over the reef, we saw some heavy wire cable—all that is left of a big schooner that was wrecked here a few years ago. Fortunately the schooner went on top of the reef, so that when the rocks went through her bottom she sank, but the crew were able to cling to the masts and rigging, and at low tide walk on the reef. They were then able to use the lifeboat to obtain help, and all were saved. Had they struck the edge of the reef, they would have gone straight down into the deep water, for the sides are perpendicular.

It is dark when we get back to the boat, and after supper we gather round for family worship, after which all hands turn in, but generally to sleep with one eye open. At 4.30 the next morning, we were drinking our coffee, and at the first streak of dawn all hands went ashore. Our visit here lasted three days, and then we set sail for home, picking up the companies of natives left on various islands." "The Lord hath done great things for us, whereof we are glad."

On a trip like this there is very close contact





with the various natives amongst whom the missionary is working, and opportunities are given for personal dealing and influencing the men for Christ which would not otherwise occur. Besides this, the missionaries are gaining a wide experience of these unfrequented regions of tropical Australia where such wonderful opportunities for aggressive work are opening up before us.

## CHAPTER XVII.

## STIRRING STORIES.

From lonely and widely separated mission stations throughout Australia we receive from time to time interesting sidelights on the intimate work of the missionaries among the native people.

In May, 1933, this unique story was told by one of the missionaries. We repeat it as an illustration of the keen spiritual susceptibility of the aborigines, and the capability of the native mind to appreciate the importance of the supernatural. "One day, an old lubra, called Annie, was brought in a dray for 30 miles to the mission station. She was sick, and had come to me for medicine. They tipped her roughly out of the dray, and I made her a camp where she could rest. I gave her medicine, and then told her about the Lord Jesus. In these districts the natives call the Supreme Being by the name of 'Marmon,' and so, after I had talked to her for some time, and was preparing to leave her, she said, 'Don't go; tell me more about goodfella Marmon.' Next day I went again, giving her medicine, and telling her more about Christ. There were several children ill with pneumonia at the time, and I was too busy to see her for several days, so she came to see me, helped along by two other native women. In my room there is a picture of the Crucifixion. 'There is Marmon,' said old Annie; 'too much prickle on head,' and she began to cry. The next day she came again, but was too ill to come any more. One morning her husband came running down to me, and, bursting into the room, he cried,





'Come quick-fella, Missus; Annie wants to see you.' I ran to Annie's camp, and there I saw her with a transfigured face, full of joy and happiness, and her home beautifully clean and tidy. She had placed a box by her bed for the missionary. 'Sit down on box,' she said; 'you big-fella yabba along me, now me yabba along you. Last night I lie along my bed. Marmon, He come down and get me, and take me right up to Him big-fella church. Him no sorry-fella up there, Him glad-fella. Him all shiny-fella, like big sun. Marmon come sit beside me. 'Annie, you like em this big-fella church?' 'Yes, yes.' 'This church belonga you and your people. You go back and preach to them and tell them about Me.' I said, 'More better I stop here now.' He said, 'No, you go back and preach for ten days, then come back here.' So now I have to tell my people about Marmon for ten days, and then He take me to His big-fella church."

The following seems hard to realise, and yet it is literally true that for nine days Annie took every opportunity to tell her people about the Saviour. Everyone who came near her camp heard the tidings of a Home prepared for all who would accept salvation. Then she said to the missionary, "Sister, promise me you go all over my country, tell my people about Marmon." The promise was given. On the tenth day, Annie gathered around her camp a large company of the native people, and once again told them about Marmon. "Sorry-fella he die on the Cross, glad-fella He up in the sky," she said, and just as the sun was setting she went to meet Marmon in the 'big-fella church.'"

One worker writes of some of the difficulty and incidental excitement connected with transporting goods from the Transcontinental railway to the mission station at Ooldea. With the approach of Christmas time (1933), there was at the siding a miscellaneous accumulation of parcels and articles

of all sorts. How to get this assortment of goods out to the station over four miles of sand-hills was a problem. There was only one camel available, and for some reason she took exception to the heavy boxes. Finally, however, she was loaded up, and they all started out, everyone with a parcel or bag of some description, and, after hours of weary toiling through the sand in the scorching sun, came to a spot about a mile from home. Here, under the welcome shade of a tree, the camel evidently thought the time opportune to lie down and have a rest. Down she got, but alas, the heavy load overbalanced her, and she fell sprawling amongst the parcels and boxes. They were afraid at first that her neck was broken, and oh, the noise she made! There was only one way to release her, and this was done without delay. They cut the ropes and let her free from the load. It was found to be utterly impossible to replace all the articles, so half the load was left by the tree to be picked up later on. Next morning we had a great time cooking, washing and cleaning, and indeed it was a happy Christmas for these poor native children of the desert, who had dwelt there so long without any knowledge of the Babe of Bethlehem.

A few months later, Miss Lock wrote of the terrible heat-wave that had passed over the interior, causing much sickness and fever both to missionary and native people. She writes of having to rise early in the morning to prepare breakfast for 60 natives, and after that she gave them various commodities, such as cotton, ointments, castor-oil, etc., in larger or smaller quantities, according to their various needs. She had three native girls in training for domestic service. She named them Lorna, Pansy, and Dorothy. Interruptions of all sorts were inevitable, so that it was not strange that in the midst of her task of mixing a damper she had to run and get a horse at the well before he finished drinking;





the horse, by the way, had been absent without leave for an indefinite period, and this was their only chance of recapturing him.

Then came another innovation. A strange-looking affair had been transported from the station, and there was great speculation amongst the natives as to what the new "jigger" might be. It was explained that it was a wheat-crusher for making porridge-meal. After some excitement and experimenting, the new machine was assembled and erected, and it was not long before they had a bag of wheat crushed. Some of the poor old women had been saying, "We cannot chew the wheat, we got no teeth," so now they will be satisfied.

The next great excitement was when a big bath was put off the train. The people at the siding were wondering who it belonged to, and when they found it belonged to the missionary they were envious. No such luxury had ever appeared in Ooldea before. No doubt it would seem strange to some city dwellers, with every convenience and comfort, to see the primitive methods they adopt in these outback places. For instance, the bathroom at Ooldea was an old galvanised tank turned upside down, and the missionary describes it as being "quite nice." Fortunately, it was a rather large tank, so there was room for the new bath. The missionary wrote: "Now we are going to make a wash-stand and use one of the separator bowls for the wash-basin."

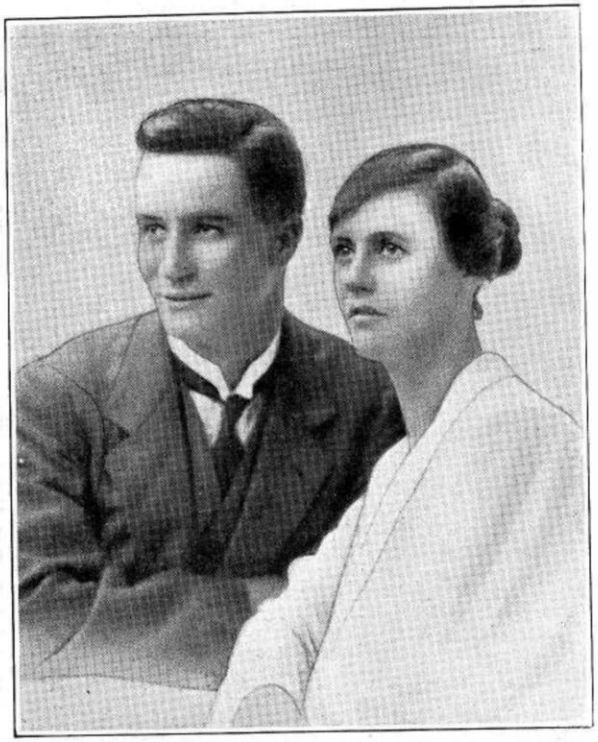
The next improvement was the building of a little laundry, with conveniences for washing. "But," writes the missionary, "it was too funny for anything. Some of the women did not know how to wash, and they put the children in, clothes and all, and washed the whole bundle together. One old native woman, putting on a superior air, came up and said, 'Don't you women know how to wash your kids' clothes?' and, driving them all away, she collected all the clothes and washed them, letting the children go

free. It was rather a trial at first to get some of the children to have their bath, but others tried to make them ashamed of their heathen ways by saying, 'You no savvy, you spinifex natives.' " Their clothes need a lot of mending, and the missionary organised a band of young native girls to undertake this work.

The natives at Ooldea quite well understood the Scripture references to salt and bitter wells, and to sweet and living waters. The Ooldea Soak, situated among a lot of sandhills, has been used by the natives as a watering and resting place. When the East-West railway line was being put down, the Railway Department made it a pumping station. There are a number of wells, some salt, and some bitter. The natives used to bring their sick folk to the bitter water, which had healing properties. At that time there were great lakes of this salt and bitter water on the plains, but the seven years' drought dried them all up, and now it is only after a heavy rain that any water can be found, except in the wells. When the missionary came to this spot to make a home for the natives, they seemed to be well pleased, and some of the men set to work to erect buildings. They took a great interest in the missionary's plans, and, considering the few tools they had, certainly worked wonders. At this time, the missionary had four rooms, a ration room, a bush church, and the aforesaid bathroom. The missionary wrote: "I think I am getting too comfortable, after having used a kerosene tin for five or six years, to have a real bathroom, but the Lord is good to me to incline His children to give me this little comfort now I am not so young to stand the roughing."

The story reached us in July, 1933, of the passing of an old aboriginal veteran, the last of the old men of Nepabunna. Sydney was a patriarch of his people, the sole survivor of those who knew the old customs, and whose body bore the scars of many

Mr. and Mrs. Street.



Mr. and Mrs. Collier.

Mr. and Mrs. L. J. White.

A Native Family.





tribal wars. His story contains the following incident:—"In the very early morning, perhaps ninety years ago, a company of aborigines belonging to a hostile tribe, attacked and killed Sydney's father and elder brother. This, in accordance with native tradition and custom, created a great thirst for revenge in the little boy's heart, and from that morning, through all his boyhood and youth, Sydney hoped and planned to avenge the blood of his father. Every year after he reached manhood, he went alone into the mountain country inhabited by the hostile natives, and left behind him a trail of death amongst the members of the enemy tribe. His head and body were scarred with many a deep wound he had received in those terrible days of treachery and bloodshed, for Sydney was a marked man, and the relatives of those he had slain searched far and wide for their mortal enemy. After many years, most of the men of both tribes were either killed in battle with other tribes, or shot by white men, and Sydney's opportunity for revenge ceased. After this long life of hatred, bitterness and revenge, the old man heard of One Who taught the higher rule of life contained in the Sermon on the Mount. The story of the Man of Sorrows touched him deeply, and the hard, revengeful spirit became gentle and sympathetic. Those who saw the passing of this sincere, grand old warrior could scarce restrain their tears as they thought of all he had been through in his long, hard life."

The story of quite a different kind is told by an elderly visitor to Bomaderry Children's Home. It was a cold, raw day in the middle of winter, and all the surroundings tended to make one miserable and depressed. Some of the party were shivering with the cold, and others had wet feet after the walk through the long grass. How cheerless everything was. The clothes wouldn't dry, and the fire wouldn't burn; and the dull clouds held back the warmth of

the sun. As the visitors neared the Home, they were suddenly startled out of their depression by the sound of a glad and cheerful song, coming in full-throated melody from the girls and boys of Bomaderry—

"Cheer up, cheer up, the sun will shine again on you,
Cheer up, cheer up, the promises of God are true."

Depression was dispelled, gloom was gone, and the visitors found themselves rejoicing in the thought that many of these little ones, whose tuneful voices echoed through the forest on that bitter morning, had been rescued from worse than death, and were now being lovingly cared for by the kind sisters at the Home.

In May, 1933, we have recorded the building of the church at Swan Reach. Mr. W. Wade, to whom the work of supervising building operations was entrusted, encountered many initial difficulties. After waiting a month to get the timber, he found that what had been supplied was insufficient, and some of it unsuitable. The posts were too small, and many of them too crooked for use. At last enough timber was gathered, and the work commenced. The building is made of pine logs placed vertically and plastered with clay mortar. It took considerable ingenuity to fit together the rough, twisted timber, but at last the building was finished and roofed with iron. To the missionaries this building was a parable of another building, a spiritual house, not made with hands; the building together of men and women with twisted lives, and crooked characters, into a building which would be a temple of God. The twists and the crooks were being straightened out by the power of the Gospel, and only the missionaries realised to the full the wonder of these lives, transformed by the power of Christ. Again in the school we see the building going on. Only a few scholars—is it worth while? A thousand times, Yes. Their characters are being formed, and many





of these girls and boys are being re-born with a spiritual birth, and their minds are being stored with the eternal truth of the Word of God. It is an inspiration to see these children in the school, all so eager to do their best.

The new church at Swan Reach was opened with great rejoicing, a number of visitors from Adelaide being present. Even though built of rough logs, the building was a grand cathedral in comparison with the previous structure of petrol tins. The old bell, which was used at Munuka Mission forty years before, now sent out its tones of welcome, and the native people flocked to the opening services. The official opening was carried out by the oldest native woman at the mission station. She performed her part with characteristic native dignity. The services were most inspiring, and in the evening quite a number made a definite decision for Christ.

Some time later, news came from Morgans, Western Australia, of the starting of the camel expedition into the interior. The mission natives themselves sometimes bring in those who have never heard the Gospel. On one occasion about 30 were brought in, some of them travelling on foot for over 400 miles. What a privilege to be the first to tell them of the love of Christ, Who came to seek and to save the lost. It is grand to observe the rapt attention with which they listen. We read that at this station the missionaries had the joy of baptising eight additional native converts. We also read of the celebration of a Christian wedding, where, instead of the customary jocular toasts, the bridegroom gave a stirring testimony after the wedding breakfast. He had never testified before, but he told in forceful words of how he was once a very evil man, stealing from white men's camps, and indulging in all kinds of sin. He did not know it was wrong, he said, until he came to the mission and

heard of Jesus. Then the Holy Spirit convicted him of sin, and he gave his heart to the Lord, and began to walk in the Happy Land way.

There is something very touching about the death of an old native. Somehow they seem to be in such close touch with the other world. Their big, luminous eyes, and the soulful expression on their faces, seem to indicate a deep yearning for a higher and better life beyond the grave. Old Harry Starlight passed away in the Katanning Hospital. Mr. Hedley Wright, the missionary, describes him as a fast friend among the natives of the West. He was always kind, respectful and thoughtful. "When we first came to Gnowangerup," writes the missionary, "we visited a camp of natives fifty miles distant. It had been raining, and the grass and bushes were drenched with water. Dear old Harry acted as guide, taking us from camp to camp. Walking in front with a stick, he swept the grass and knocked the water from the bushes to make a drier path for us to walk.

Grandfather Kickett, an old full-blood native of the south-west, was well known throughout the district as a capable, industrious man. At one time he had his own farm, but that had long since passed into other hands. The local white people say that Grandfather Kickett must have been nearly one hundred years old. At this great age, he found Christ as his Saviour. He was too deaf to understand much that the missionary said, but he took it in bit by bit, and we believe the light dawned on his benighted mind in answer to prayer. After the missionaries had visited him for many months, he one day asked them to pray, and then exclaimed, "I want that Jesus for my Saviour." He put his hand on his heart and said, "I feel it in here." It was soon evident that Jesus was real to him, and the other native Christians had a new topic of conversation, viz., that Grandfather Kickett, a hundred years old, had





been born over again, and the good news they told from camp to camp must have blended with the rejoicing amongst the angels in the other world.

From a station in South Australia comes another story of a constant war waged between light and darkness. The minds of the old natives are clouded and dark with the superstitions and accumulated beliefs of many centuries of heathenism. Old Nick and his wife, Julia, were well-known identities at the mission. The custom observed amongst the aborigines for generations past demanded that the possessions of a wife should be burnt in the dwelling of her deceased husband. Following the custom of his forefathers, Old Nick died. The older natives on the settlement insisted that Julia's possessions should be burnt with the old man's hut. Among these possessions was a valuable dress the missionary had given her. She had no intention of submitting to the old rites. They might be alright for others, but she declared they were no good to her. She defied those who sought to destroy her possessions, saying, "What's the good of praying to God to help us and send us clothes, when you silly black fellows burn them?" Julia won her case and kept the dress, but that and her Government blanket was all that was left to her. With these meagre possessions she pitched her camp and faced life alone.

"We have some unruly ruffians in the camp," wrote Mr. R. Williams in 1934, "who badly need discipline. Some people advocate physical violence, but I doubt if it would be right to become implicated in brawls. I find it necessary, however, to be present at quarrels to prevent murder. There are several would-be murderers in the camp to-night, who have been stopped in their rage from acts of great violence. One man rushed headlong into the struggle with an axe, and I was only just in time to rush in and swing the axe my way. I have a gun

here, which I snatched from the hand of a man who had already committed murder, and seems ever ready to repeat the achievement."

Mr. L. H. J. White, coming into the Mission in April, 1930, has seen service at La Perouse, Wellington and Bellbrook, and has proved a good Secretary to the Council, being appointed temporarily in March, 1934, and continuously since September, 1936. With Mrs. White he has done excellent work, though the latter's health has not been good for some time; it is hoped, however, that medical treatment which she has been undergoing will prove of permanent value, and enable them to continue their service for many years.

Lena Bungary has proved a loyal helper, and her outstanding Christian character, together with many an act of self-denial, has indicated her love for the workers among her people, whilst she has also borne splendid witness in public and in private, in Sydney metropolitan area, to the Faith she has embraced.

Mr. Henry Bush has been intimately associated with the work of the Mission since the day of small beginnings at La Perouse. Through all the years he has unstintedly given of his best to assist the cause. His business experience and his literary gifts were always at the disposal of the Mission. He has served as a prominent member of the Council for many years, and filled several offices, including Chairman of the Executive, Treasurer, and Editor of the Mission magazine. This brother has ever been a true friend of the missionaries, and it has always been his desire that more practical support should be sent to the workers in the field, who are bearing the brunt of the battle. As a prominent member of the Christian Endeavour movement, he has done much to interest Endeavourers in the work amongst the aborigines.

Few people living in comfortable homes rea-





lise the conditions under which many of the aborigines are forced to live. Mr. Eaton thus describes his visitation amongst the native camps at Oodnadatta: "They have the idea that they can never rise to become noble or good, but that the rubbish heap is the place for them all. Going around to visit them with medicines, I have to get into their wurlies to attend to them. These places are just ovens, most of them only about three feet high, and no bush on them, but just sheets of old iron, and the burning sun pouring down on them all day." The writer of this article has seen again and again a mother with the babe a few hours old, lying under a single sheet of bark on a mouldy wet blanket, with cockroaches and centipedes and other vermin crawling about her bed. Without the care of doctor or nurse, she has brought her offspring into the world, and sometimes is on the verge of starvation herself as she seeks to nourish her child. We have seen at least twenty aborigines, men, women, boys and girls, sleeping under a filthy shelter less than eight feet square, and on one occasion, while on a missionary journey, received a cordial invitation to share their hospitality. Needless to say, the invitation was not accepted. But as I lay by my camp fire, out under the stars, a mile away from the said camp, I prayed to God that He would stir the Christian people of Australia to a sense of their responsibility with regard to these aborigines. The callousness of so-called Christians cannot be understood or explained.

Wholly set up and printed in Australia by Fraser & Morphet Pty. Ltd., Registered Office, 3 and 5 Eastbourne Street, Windsor, Melbourne, Victoria, for the Rev. E. J. Telfer, 140 Elizabeth Street, Sydney, New South Wales.